

O6SYSTEM

SECOND EDITION



D6 SYSTEM

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D6 System 2e: Developed by Alan Bahr, based on work by Greg Costikyan and the West End Games Team, as well as those who worked on it over the years. We owe them so many thanks for such a great system.

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Previous Material: D6 System Material published by West End Games contains more contributors and collaborators than we could ever acknowledge. As such, there are more creative forces behind D6 System than we could list (a whole book could be written on the history of D6 System material), but specifically, this work derives heavily from work found in the following books: *Ghostbusters*; *Star Wars Roleplaying Game – Revised*; *D6 Adventure*, *D6 Fantasy*, *D6 Space*; *The Zorro Roleplaying Game* (2020), as well as other influences from across the D6 System line throughout the decades.

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Foreword

The D6 System is hands down the best gaming system for action adventure. Come at me, bro—convince me otherwise. It's a bold statement, I agree, but the game can stand ten toes down, chin up, and scream it to the universe! No other game system has remained tried and tested for as long as the D6 System.

Let me back up and set my gaming clock back to zero.

I started gaming in the spring of 1981 with the Moldvay Basic D&D set. I didn't realize it then, but I would have to wait six more years to get what I wanted from gaming. I played like everyone else, but I wanted a game that would allow me to emulate the action-adventure fiction I was reading and experiencing. That hunger inside my soul could not be sated with the technology I had at my disposal then, but I waited and bided my time. I knew some game designer messiah and their apostles would deliver me and my tribe into the promised land.



In the summer of 1987, I walked into my local comic shop, Page After Page Comics, and saw a copy of the new West End Games Star Wars players and Gamemaster guides. You must understand that Star Wars wasn't as big a deal as it is now. The last movie in the franchise came out four years earlier, and the popularity was waning. Dan, my good friend, was with me and not impressed by the game, but it spoke volumes. You see, Dan loved D&D, but I loved roleplaying games. I loved big games and the little ones that fell between the cracks. In the small amount of time between my first foray into gaming and up until then, I played everything from Dungeons and Dragons to Call of Cthulhu, Stormbringer, Aftermath, Robotech, Danger International, Champions, and even Dragon Raid (a deep cut, I know). I could not get enough of playing games and eventually kit bashing my own. I love gaming.

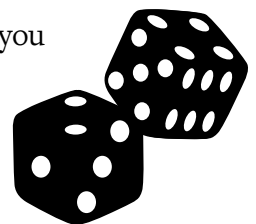
In the year the D6 system hit the market, other games were vying for shelf space. Talislanta, Cyborg Commando, Ars Magica, and Teenagers From Outer Space – all competed with the first Star Wars game for attention. One of those games even had a D6 version released recently; go figure.

Since its inception, the D6 System has inspired many later systems. As of this writing, the D6 System has become a sort of *ur* game with its DNA in many popular games today. It is Exploding Dice, Meta Points, and Dice Pools. Before the D6 System none of these ideas ever played as elegantly together.

The D6 system evolved with me in my formative gaming years, and was codified into what we know as The D6 System in the mid-1990s with the Star Wars Second Edition, Revised and Expanded version. The overhaul and additions made the game a bit more robust, and it grew a “Dad Bod” as it bulked up its rules, but it still contained all the verve and energy of the original. Since the Revised edition, I've used the system for everything from superheroes to sci-fi, fantasy, and spy thrillers. It's a go-to when you have an idea and need a system to run it with. It's a system that many games spring from, and the first I know of combining Dice Pools, Meta Currencies, and Narrative Control – remember, this was in the late 1980s and early 1990s. While other games and systems tried to outdo D&D or “fix” a perceived fault of a rule, the D6 System was busy emulating genres and making gameplay dynamic, intuitive, and fun.

I'll repeat it for anyone just joining us: The D6 System is hands down the best gaming system for action adventures.

If this is your first time playing a D6 System game – Welcome; I know you will have a lovely time and get into the swing of things with your first handful of dice. If you are like me, an old hat, welcome home, pull up a chair, and grab your character. We are all in for a wild ride.



A dramatic illustration of a dark, scaly dragon with large wings, breathing a powerful stream of fire. The dragon is positioned in the upper left, angled towards the right. The background is a fiery, red and orange sky with streaks of light and smoke. The overall mood is intense and epic.

Introduction

Welcome to the D6 System: Second Edition! You hold in your hands one of the great rulesets of tabletop roleplaying game history. The D6 System from West End Games has a long, historic, and impactful legacy, one defined by creativity and genre support.

Powering famous worlds and stories like *Star Wars* and *Ghostbusters*, as well as original creations and the early wide-spread OGL era, the D6 System has been a mainstay in the tabletop games industry; and one fondly remembered by more than a few fans.

Gallant Knight Games is proud to be able to contribute a little to the wonderful canon of the D6 System with D6 System: Second Edition (D62e).

The Goal of D6 System: Second Edition

We feel it's very important for the team at Gallant Knight Games to make clear our goal with D6 System: Second Edition. It's a valued and beloved game system, and laying out our goals in our approach matters a lot. It will help you understand what we were trying to do, and why we made certain decisions.

First, our goal was not to reinvent, re-engineer, or tear down and rebuild the game into something new. We *want* the game to feel like the classic experiences you had with the D6 System. That matters a lot to us. The core D6 System is a very elegant and timeless ruleset, one that stands up very well to this day, and there's little reason to alter the basic ideas.

We see our job as one of a refinement, consolidation, and making small tweaks. We want to clarify, clean up, refine, and remove friction points. There's a long history of D6 System games and they all had a variety of permutations. These pieces don't always fit together well, and that creates some friction in the conversation about D6 when it comes to recommendations, homebrew, rules, and more. We want to compile the conversations surrounding West End Games D6 Products into a *lingua franca* that can be used by old fans and new.

We can't fix every friction point between these systems, and frankly we don't want to. Rules friction makes games interesting, because it forces gamemasters to make decisions that turn a common ruleset into something unique at their table. That's one of the magical pieces of the D6 System — how easy it is to use!

There's a very long history of D6 System games. It's a venerable system and thus it would be an impossible task to manage, collate, and account for every permutation, variable, or historical difference in its various iterations. We've done our best to gather the biggest, best, and most popular ones (along with a few personal favorites of the team) into this book, but there's no way we can account for everything.

Likewise, we aren't aiming to support previous published versions of the ruleset. Instead, we're doing our best to use those previous versions to build the new foundation going forward.

Finally, the biggest goal is this: a new, modern looking, reading, and feeling version of D6 System. For a long time D6 System has been out of print or only available in OGL forms. We want to put a modular, multi-genre version of this wonderful ruleset back into the gaming space where folks can find it online, in web stores, in digital forms, on large and small marketplaces, and in local game stores. We want to see new fans discover D6 System, and by doing a new core rulebook that honors and upholds the best parts of the three decade history of D6 System, we can help do that.

We see ourselves as one stretch of the long road of D6 System, and we can't wait to see where the road takes the community and fandom.

What is a Roleplaying Game?

A roleplaying game is very much like improvisational acting or interactive storytelling but with rules that allow for the random chance that exists in the real world. It's a bit like telling stories with your friends, and adding some rules to help you iron out the points where "they said/I said" would become a problem or create conflict. Roleplaying is a social activity, where you will talk, act out, and put yourself in new, interesting, and unexpected places on an emotional and mental level as you work with your trusted friends to tell a story you all believe in!

Generally, one person is the gamemaster (often called GM). Their job is to set up the plots, help pace the story, and narrate and resolve the actions of everyone who exists (that isn't already being played by another player). They might run the villains you encounter, the obstacles that crop up, and the challenges you face.

The gamemaster should try to adhere to the following principles:

- Guide the story.
- Present interesting challenges.
- Be a fan of the players.
- Ask them questions, fill the setting with their answers.
- Be fair, but flexible.
- Be as consistent as possible.

Everyone else at the table (who we refer to as "players") takes on the roles of the heroes, the protagonists, and the centerpieces of the story unfolding upon the pages of your table. As a player, you might battle villains, save the star empires from nefarious schemes and evil warlords, travel the hellish deserts of Apocryphan, or protect the oppressed and harmed.

Players should try to adhere to the following principles:

- Narrate what your character does.
- Make checks when things are narratively risky and interesting.
- Make sure everyone shines.
- Fill the setting with your ideas.
- Take risks. Overcome failure.

Playing a roleplaying game is equal pieces acting, storytelling, and gameplay. The gamemaster will provide a framework of a story, and the players undertake actions that help define the story, drive it forward, and keep things moving so everyone has fun.

When there might be a concern about how the game plays or the heroes need to resolve something, the rules tell the gamemaster and players how to determine what happens. Aside from specific rules in supplements or other books (that are exclusively related to those books), nearly all the rules you need are here in this book, with one key exception: the ones that you make at your table.

The rules written here are the baselines, the foundations, and they will guide the overarching themes of the story. However, your imagination is far more powerful than any rules we can write in this book, and as such the gamemaster and players are encouraged to rework, redefine, add, subtract, otherwise modify these rules.

Your job is to take those rules and use them (sometimes by breaking them) to tell your stories. The gamemaster serves as the final arbiter of rules (someone has to be able to make a decision), but they will always try to remember that the fun you all have at the table is the goal of playing this game.

We've said this before, but we'll say it a lot (because it is the core concept of what we're doing here): it's best to think of D6 System: Second Edition as a toolkit, one where you grab the tools you need out of this book and build the ideal version of this ruleset to make what you want happen.

In the end, this game is designed to be "finished" at your table. Whatever we put on these pages, what you do at the table makes it your own, and that's by design.

Playing in Good Faith

Roleplaying games are a group activity. Having fun as a group is the only way to “win” at a roleplaying game. To that end, these rules were made to be broken, hacked, and mutilated.

Stories should be exciting; heart-pounding thrills should abound, and if a rule gets in the way you should change it or just flat-out ignore it! A game like this is a framework for your group to build on and alter as they need, with the ultimate goal to be to maximize your enjoyment of the story you tell with your friends.

But being respectful and kind to your group is the most important factor. It’s sad to lose friends over elements of playing pretend at the table. Be gracious and give leeway to learn, grow and enjoy each other’s company. No one is perfect, but communicating openly and honestly (a theme we’ll repeat) solves almost every problem that can crop up at the tabletop.

The goal is to have fun, but that fun is only as good as the fun had by the entire group.

The fun of one person should never come at the expense of the fun, safety, or comfort of anyone else in the group.

We call this **playing in good faith**.

Let’s cover some basics.

First, not every tool we’re going to discuss needs to be used. Your group is unique to you, and your interactions are too. You should find the right solution for your group and table, regardless of what we say here. These are simply best practices and suggestions. Like everything in this book, they’re a toolkit. The better you know each other personally outside of the game, the less likely these tools are to be relevant.

Second, these tools serve to protect the gamemaster as much as the players. They aren’t only for players, and should be utilized by the gamemaster as readily (perhaps even more so) than the players.

The goal of any of these tools comes down to one essential principle: communication.

Honest, open trusting communication builds trust and allows a group to share an experience in good faith, and enjoy each other’s company and laughter.

Session Zero

A common tabletop roleplaying term is “session zero.” Session zero takes place before the game starts. The group makes characters and discusses the story they want to tell. This is a good chance for the gamemaster to float the ideas of the story they intend to tell (in broad strokes), and head off any potential concerns before the game even starts.

An excellent shorthand to use is video game or movie rating scales, as well as references in common media to establish a baseline of tone and expectations. Everyone tells stories differently, and working to establish a strong common foundation between you and your players is essential to a successful campaign.

After-Session Check-In

After a session is over, having the gamemaster lead a check-in helps to keep communication flowing.

Asking the players what worked, what didn't, and what the gamemaster can do to maximize fun for everyone is an essential task.

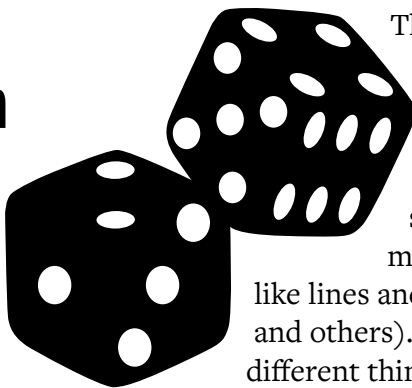
This ensures that any misunderstandings, concerns, or conversations can be addressed after the session. However, sometimes folks need to have some space to think and form a response. Therefore, we recommend the gamemaster maintain

open and clear lines of communication between sessions as well.

Open and Clear Lines of Communication

The gamemaster should maintain an easy way for players to communicate privately regarding any issues that come up. This allows players to communicate any feedback to the gamemaster directly. No one benefits from feeling like they were attacked or called out for their roleplaying, and a private conversation often goes a long way towards resolving any issues.

At-The-Table Tools



There are many methods and tools for handling any safety concerns at the tabletop as you play. A quick internet search will provide you many of them (things

like lines and veils, the x-card, and others). Each group requires different things from their table, and we leave it to you to do your research and learn what might best work for you and your table.

All players are responsible for ensuring everyone has the most fun possible at their game. Shirking this responsibility is one of the great harms you can conduct against your fellow players, and it only serves to harm the community rather than build it up.

What Do I Need to Play This Game?

To play this game, you will need the following: this book, character sheets, pencils, a lot of six-sided dice (ten per player to start with, at least one in a different color), a player to be the gamemaster, your imagination, and 2 to 5 friends to be the players!

The gamemaster (or GM) is the guiding force in the story and will present information about the game setting, obstacles the players and their characters will overcome, and take on the role of the people your characters meet.

The rest of the group is simply called “the players,” and takes on the role of the major characters in the story that they and the GM will create together.

These stories are called “sessions,” and they will form a narrative called a “campaign.” A campaign is anywhere from 3 to 12 sessions (sometimes even more), and forms a continuous narrative arc. We’ll get more into that later.

How Do I Use This Book?

Throughout this book, you will find a structured in a series of escalating rules modules, each being used to introduce alternative rules or modifications to the baseline rules. Additionally, throughout the book there are other sidebars and optional rules. These optional rules are designed to allow you to genre-bend and modify the game to fit various themes in a “plug-and-play” fashion. The additional and optional modules help you to fine-tune your campaign to fit the genre you’ve chosen to play in!

Modules are housed under specific, sometimes genre-related sections of the book, but each module can be used with those from other sections. That means, even if magic is housed under Fantasy, there’s no reason you can’t use it in superheroes or science fiction! If a module does not work with another module we’ll call it out, and we’ll try to make sure we make any rough edges clear.

While these rules are designed with genres in mind, they can be used as each GM wants in their game to create an utterly unique experience! One of the best parts about D62e is the game’s ease of modification and home-creation.

Like any tabletop roleplaying game, the more rules you add to the game, the more likely an unusual edge case is going to come up. Dice mechanics are no match for the sheer power of imagination and creativity players can espouse, and as such the GM must be prepared to make a few rulings now and then to ease game play.

That is OK. The best part of tabletop roleplaying games is how each group makes them familiar but unique at their table. The only real trick is to communicate as the GM, and make sure everyone remains on the same page!

All of this means that the D62e system is wildly cinematic and heroic, and it lends itself very well to dramatic, action-packed campaigns with lots of set pieces, cool fights, and dramatically tense social conflicts.

If you want to run a standard or modern-world sort of game, simply don't use any optional rules under the genre-packs and stick to modules in the Core Rules sections.

The book is laid out as follows:

• **Core Rules**

These are the basic rules that all D62e games need to function. They are the least complex distillation of the game.

- Module: Additional Attributes
- Module: Alternative Initiative
- Module: Alternate Wild Die
- Module: Chases
- Module: Hero Points
- Module: Environments
- Module: Equipment by Genre/Era
- Module: Experience Points
- Module: Hyper-lethal Combat
- Module: Pips
- Module: Milestone Character Advancement
- Module: Narrative Advancement
- Module: Skill Specializations & Advanced Skills
- Module: No Dodge Defense
- Module: Perks, Flaws & Talents
- Module: Troubles & Assets
- Module: General Foes and Bestiary
- Module: Templates

• **Fantasy**

- Module: Fantasy Skills
- Module: Magic Points Casting
- Module: Freeform Skill-Based Magic
- Module: Active & Responsive Combat
- Module: Fantasy Bestiary
- Module: Fantasy Templates

• **Science Fiction**

- Module: Science Fiction Skills
- Module: Starships & Starship Combat
- Module: Driving & Vehicles
- Module: Psionics
- Module: Cyberpunk
- Module: Science Fiction Bestiary
- Module: Vehicle Templates
- Module: Science Fiction Templates

• **Superheroes**

- Module: Superheroic Skills
- Module: Superpowers
- Module: Gadgets & Gear
- Module: Hideouts & Strongholds
- Module: Nemesis, Companions, and Sidekicks
- Module: Superheroic Templates

Campaign Prep

At the back of the book, you'll find a **Campaign Worksheet**. This page is designed for the gamemaster to use to communicate what optional rules in this game are being used. While the sheet is intended for campaigns, it is suitable for conventions, one-shots, or other styles of game play with the D6 System: Second Edition.

Ideally, before the campaign and before characters are made, the gamemaster will fill in this sheet, and pass a copy to each player for reference. This checklist will make sure everyone understands what rules can (and can't) be used throughout the game!

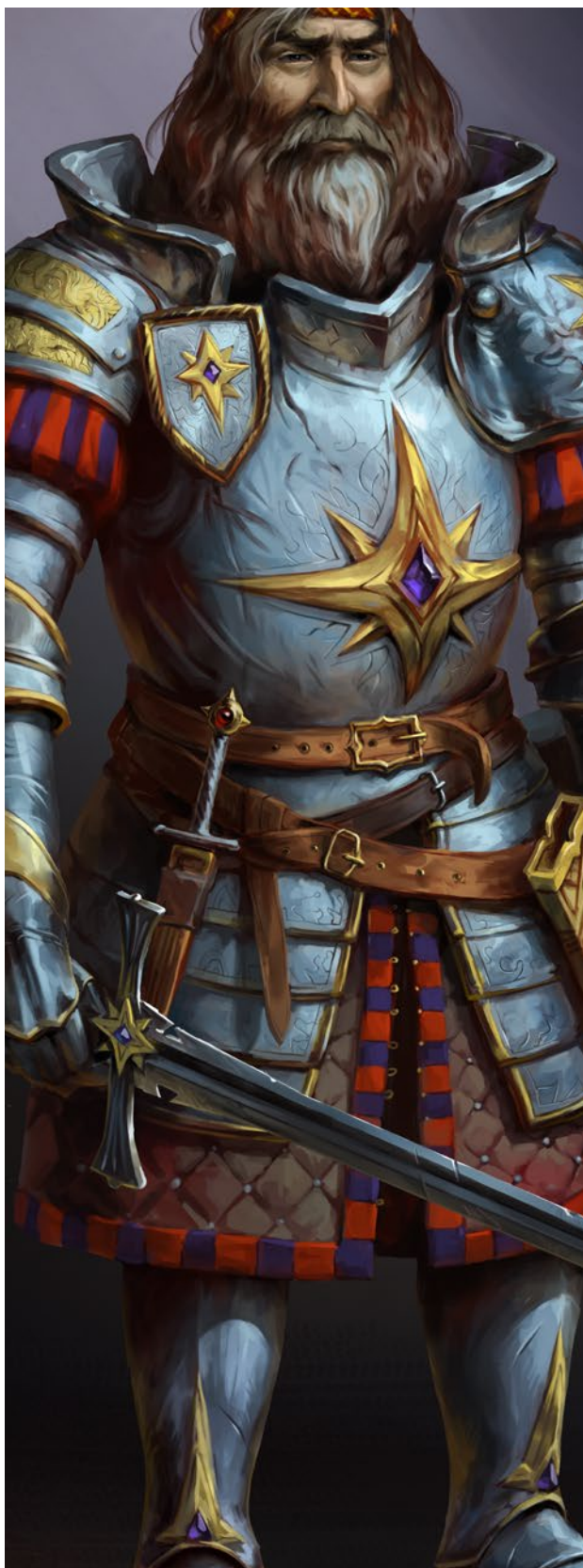
It also serves as a brief overview of what the campaign might entail! Knowing the modules can help set the tone and expectations. The worksheet helps to keep everyone on the same page, so there's less confusion and complication.

You can find downloadable versions of this sheet (that include material for expansion books) on the Gallant Knight Games website (www.gallantknightgames.com).





Character Creation



There are two ways to create your character: **templates** and **a la carte**.

The first is to select a template. Each **template** has a partially completed character that you can modify and improve. Templates are a great way to play quickly, learn your character, or simply jump in at a convention, one-off, or introductory session.

If you decide to make a character using a template, simply add 7D of skills to the template, and you're set! It's that easy!

In a **la carte** character creation, you will receive a certain amount of dice to spend on attributes, skills, and other upgrades (as determined by modules and the GM).

These dice are put into your appropriate character elements and, excluding a few limits (minimum and maximum dice), these increases can be done however you see fit. Various skill levels (which impact how many dice you start with for these spends) are communicated by both modules and general rules.

The game presents a module of flaws and perks (see [page 101](#) for information on that module). These flaws, perks, and talents can also alter where and how your dice are spent (or perhaps give you more or less dice to spend). These can take the place of various abilities, talents, or built-in changes to your character.

Each genre pack contains at least a one-page reference for how the genre pack modifies these a la carte spends, but they naturally tend to require less detail than templates, as the player is making a bulk of the decisions (again, within the communicated limits).

A la carte is also how one might create their own “templates” for players at their table, though this book doesn’t contain a full template creation section on its own. Instead, we focus on explaining how to use the a la carte + other modules to create templates for yourself.

At the start of a campaign, your Gamemaster should communicate which method they prefer. Both methods will create characters of the same power level, so the Gamemaster can mix and match inside their campaign.

You can find a list of standard templates on [page 138](#).

You’ll need a character sheet! You can find downloadable character sheets on www.gallantknightgames.com (there’s a variety), as well as a blank sheet at the back of this book.

Customizing the Character

To build a fully custom character, the first thing we’ll need to do is establish some core ideas about the character.

It’s helpful if you answer these questions before assigning your dice. These questions have no mechanical bearing, but knowing the answers can help you make decisions.

1. What is your character’s physical appearance? Age, weight, hair color, style of dress, height, or anything else?
2. What makes them stand out? What skills can they bring to bear to overcome difficulties and opposition?
3. What makes them interesting and fallible? What might cause them to fail, make mistakes, and make things harder on themselves?
4. What jobs or professions have they held in the past? Why those jobs? Were they good at them?

Once you’ve thought through those questions, you can start to assign dice to create your character!

Attributes

Each character has four attributes and 12D to spend between them. There are some restrictions you have to follow here:

- First, each Attribute must have at least 1D assigned to that attribute.
- Secondly, no Attribute may go higher than 5D at the end of this step (though they can go higher later in the campaign – this cap only applies during character creation).

Dice are assigned on a one-for-one basis during character creation.

For example, Alan is making a character, who is a scholarly type. He assigns 2D to Brawn, 3D to Agility, 3D to Perception, and 4D to Knowledge.

If your GM is using additional attributes (see [page 62](#)), you need more dice for your attributes. Add +3D for each additional attribute (over four) to the total amount of dice you can spend on attributes during character creation.

Skills

Now that your attributes are assigned, you'll need to assign Die Codes to the Skills! Each skill starts at 0D. Simply write 1D or 2D next to any skill you want your character to have, up to a maximum total of 7D. Each skill has a maximum rating of 2D during character creation.

If your gamemaster is using any optional skill modules, add +2D to your total skill dice pool for each module they add.

The modules for additional skills can be found on [page 62](#) (under the "Optional Attributes" module).

The modules for specializations and advanced skills can be found on [page 96](#).

If there is a skill you want that doesn't exist, you should work with the GM to create it. The skills provided on the character sheet are the general skills that exist in almost every game, but the skill list can be as flexible as you want!

Hero Points

Hero Points are a core element of the D6 System: Second Edition. Ask your gamemaster what hero point module you'll be using ([pages 75-76](#)). All Characters start with 1 Hero Point, so enter a "1" in the Hero Point section on the

character sheet (see Hero Points on [page 28](#)).

Defense Number

Each Character has two Defense Numbers. These numbers are easily calculated and represents how hard a character is to hit in combat (either Melee or Ranged.)

The two defenses are:

- **Dodge.** Dodge is used to avoid Ranged Attacks, surprises, or traps.
- **Parry:** Parry is used to block melee attacks, get out of the way, or avoid being struck in close combat.

Each defense is calculated similarly:

- Dodge = 5 x Number of Dice assigned to Perception. So a Perception of 2D would give a Dodge Defense of 10.
- Parry = 5 x Number of Dice Assigned to Agility. So an Agility of 3D would give a Parry Defense of 15.

The multiplier of 5 might feel high to some folks! Let us explain why we landed on that multiple. First, multiples of five are more accessible to a wider audience. It's something that seems to be more mathematically ingrained in us.

Secondly, starting characters (as defaults) generally are going to roll 4 to 5 dice in die codes, and various modules might provide tools (like hero points or pips) that enhance those rolls.

An average result might be about 13-18 on 4-5 dice (or higher). The numbers were chosen to keep combat interesting. However, if you feel that attacks miss more than they hit, you can lower the multiplier to x4 (or even x3), though we recommend going no lower than x3.

We don't recommend increasing the multiplier past x5.

Equipment

Each character starts with equipment that fits their background and the narrative. The Gamemaster has the final say, but should work with the players to ensure everything makes sense and works out.

You can find genre appropriate equipment in their respective sections, as well as a collection of modern and historical equipment on [page 80](#).

Character Attachments & Relationships

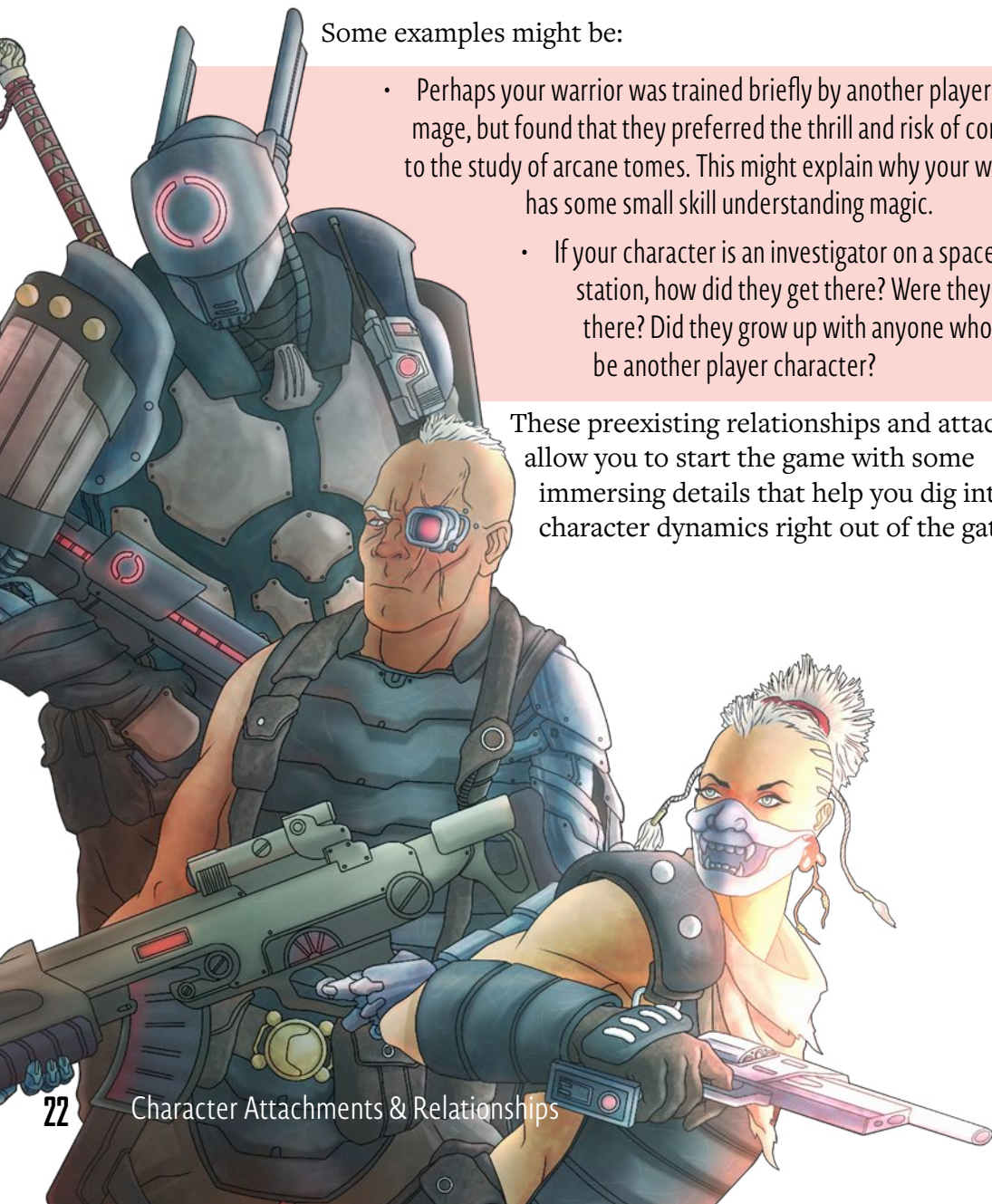
During character creation, it can be beneficial for players to talk about how their characters might know each other and what history they share. With the information the gamemaster has provided about the campaign, the characters can tie small details together.

You can answer questions about your histories together, reputations you might have heard about the others, or interactions that have shaped how each of you view the other. Remember that the goal is to play together, so answer only for yourself. The campaign will be better if everyone is bought into the overall vision, where the characters come from, and where they are going!

Some examples might be:

- Perhaps your warrior was trained briefly by another player's mage, but found that they preferred the thrill and risk of combat to the study of arcane tomes. This might explain why your warrior has some small skill understanding magic.
- If your character is an investigator on a space station, how did they get there? Were they born there? Did they grow up with anyone who might be another player character?

These preexisting relationships and attachments allow you to start the game with some immersing details that help you dig into fun character dynamics right out of the gate!



Playing the Game



Playing the Game

Attributes and Skills

Every character has attributes and skills. Each attribute and skill has a die code. Each time you use an attribute or skill, you roll dice; the attribute or skill's code determines how many dice you use and how you calculate the total roll (see [page 24](#)).

Attributes and skills are defined during character creation (see [page 18](#)) and increased during advancement (see [pages 86-92](#)). If you want to modify your attributes and skills during the session, you can use hero points (see [page 28](#)) to change how rolls happen (though the actual value of your attributes and skills won't change).

Die Codes & Basics

D6 System: Second Edition uses the concept of *die codes* to communicate how proficient a character is.

Whenever a character attempts to do something risky in the game, you'll roll dice (six-sided dice - called d6s). The higher the result of your total roll (all the rolled dice added together), the more successful the character is at that task!

How many dice you roll is determined by your die code. Each *skill* and *attribute* has a die code. When you have to roll a skill or attribute, you can simply look at that code and it will tell you how many dice you must roll.

A typical die code consists of a *number* (like 3), followed by a *D* (this means dice). So 3D is three six-sided dice, 4D is four six-sided die, and so on. Basically, if we say #D, we mean that many six-sided dice.

When you determine your die code, you'll take the rating of your attribute (1 through 10), and the rating of your skill (0 through 10) and add them together to form the #D part of the die code. For example, a 2 in Agility, and a 2 in Acrobatics, would result in 4D. You'd roll 4 six-sided dice and total them to

TYPES OF DIE CODES:

There are two types of primary die codes in D62e:

- Attribute die code: #D where the # is equal to your rating in that attribute.
- Skill die code: #D where the # is equal to the rating in the skill + the rating in the attribute being used with that skill (see [page 36](#) on how to use skills).
 - When we say a skill die code, you should presume that this is the total skill die code with the appropriate attribute included.
 - If you do not have a rating in that skill (a 0), you use the **default die code**, which is simply the appropriate attribute die code.

Other types of die codes might come up (equipment often has its own "die code" that is a pool of dice used with that equipment), but we'll call them out when they appear.

Some die codes have bonuses. There are two types of bonuses for die codes: *pips*, written as +#, and modifiers, written as +#D. Modifiers simply add extra dice to your total die code, whereas pips are small bonuses added to the final score. You can find out more about pips in the Pip module on [page 94](#).

determine the result of the action (the die code score when compared to the difficulty number).

So, a die code of 3D+1 would mean that the player would roll 3 six-sided dice, add them together, and then add 1 to the total. If the dice came up with results of 2, 3, and 5, your result would be 11 (2+3+5+1).

The final result (in this case, the 11) is called *the score*. Scores are compared to the difficulty of the task to see if the score *exceeds* the difficulty.

Doubling Down

When an action fails, the character can *double down*. When a character doubles down, they narrate how they retry their efforts, and the gamemaster will work to help them find a narratively suitable reason they can try again.

Some actions cannot be tried again (such as combat actions), but generally, the gamemaster should work to allow players the narrative freedom to double down.

The character then rerolls their entire Die Code.

- If the action fails on the retry they gain a *complication*, but no Hero Point is awarded it (see [page 27](#)).
- If the action is successful, follow the normal rules for success.

Opposed Rolls

Sometimes you use an attribute or skill against someone who's using the same attribute or skill of their own to resist you. For example, if you use your Brawn to arm-wrestle someone, they might use their Brawn to arm-wrestle back.

In this case, you both roll your dice — and the higher roll wins.

If the rolls are tied, the player character wins over a non-player character. If both are player characters and the rolls are tied, the highest wild die result wins! If it's *still a tie*? Well...we trust you to figure it out.

What happens if one side has an advantage? In this case, the gamemaster assigns one side a modifier. The modifier is added to their roll, so their chance of winning increases.

Difficulty Numbers

A majority of the time, you aren't trying to beat anyone else directly. For example, if you try to fix a broken wagon axle, there's no one "opposing" you.

In this case, the gamemaster assigns a difficulty number to the task. If your roll is greater than the difficulty number, you succeed. If it's equal to the difficulty or lower, you fail.

How does the gamemaster decide what the difficulty number is? The skill rules (see [page 36](#)) tell gamemaster how. You can read them if you want or rely on your gamemaster to tell you the numbers.

In other D6 System games, sometimes success is determined by **equal to or greater than** results, rather than greater than.

Just for clarity: in D62e we take the approach of a result *greater than* the Difficulty Number is a successful result. This makes it easier to handle opposed rolls, where one result *must* be higher than the other to be successful, though there is a series of tie break mechanics there as well.

The Wild Die

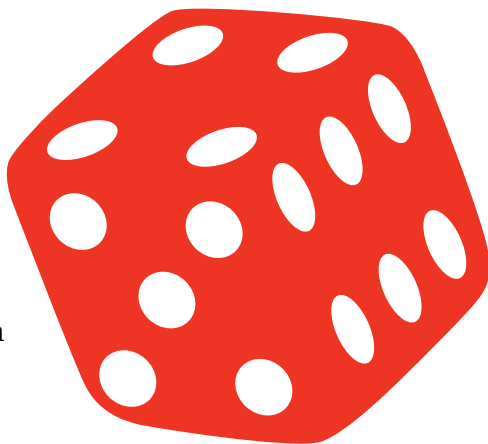
The Wild Die represents the randomness inherent in life. The Wild Die is always one of the dice in your Die Codes and you should represent it with a d6 of a different color or size.

So, in our previous example of 3D6, you'd roll 2 normal dice and the Wild Die, then sum them up for the total result. You must always include the Wild Die, so if you only have one die, it must be the Wild Die.

If the Wild Die comes up with a result of 2, 3, 4, or 5, just treat it as a normal die, adding it to your total as normal.

If the Wild Die comes up with a result of 6, you **gain** an *Advantage*.

If the Wild Die comes up with a 1, you **suffer** a *Complication*.



Advantages

Advantages are narrative implications that the player *can* insert whenever the Wild Die rolls a 6. A player is never required to insert an Advantage if they do not want to.

When an Advantage occurs, the player has the following options:

- If the action would be successful, and an Advantage Occurred.
 1. The player can gain an *Exceptional Success* and gain one Hero Point.
 - An Exceptional Success allows the Hero to complete the task in a truly quick, dramatic, fashion. This might include an environmental advantage (like enemies getting tangled in a horse cart during a foot chase), or simply dealing double damage in combat.
 - The player should work with the Gamemaster to create a narrative appropriate exceptional success, but creativity should be rewarded.
 2. The player can instead have an Ordinary Success but gain 2 Hero Points.
- If the action would not be successful, and an Advantage occurred.
 1. The player may add the result of 6 on the Wild Die, and then roll the Wild Die again. As long as you roll a 6, you keep adding the 6 and you keep rolling. If you roll anything else, you add that number to the total and stop rolling. The player can then gain 1 Hero Point.
 - Additional 6s rolled on the Wild Die will not result in extra Advantages.

Complications

Complications are narrative implications that the gamemaster *can* insert whenever the Wild Die rolls a 1. The GM is never required to insert a Complication if they don't want to.

When a Complication occurs, the gamemaster has three options:

- If the action would be successful, but a Complication occurred.
 1. The Gamemaster can either introduce a complication that makes the action a partial success, rewarding the hero with 1 Hero Point.
 - For example, a leap across a roof ends with the hero tangled in a drying line, or hanging from a roof edge,
 2. or cause the action to fail but reward the character with 2 Hero Points.
 - The leap simply fails, tumbling the hero to the street below.
- If the action would have failed and a Complication occurred.
 3. The Gamemaster rewards the player with 1 Hero Point, and then introduces a complication that will accentuate the failure.
 - For example: A hero lost in the desert also realizes their canteen has been leaking and now they're running low on water.

Hero Points

In other D6 games hero points might have multiple variants, different names, or implementations.

What follows below is the default for Hero Points in D62e.

After character creation, characters acquire Hero Points from Complications and Advantages. These Hero Points can be spent in several ways:

1. To double the Die Code of a single roll.
2. Reroll a failed roll without doubling down.
3. To avoid being Stunned in combat.

Hero Points carry over between sessions and can be stored by characters. No more than one Hero Point can be spent on a roll.

You will find modules for other uses of hero points, specifically on [pages 75-76](#) and [page 207](#).

How Long Does It Take?

Under most circumstances, using a skill or attribute takes one combat round (five seconds). However, some skills —repairing an axle, for instance — take longer to use. Unless your gamemaster tells you differently, assume you can use a skill in one combat round.

Preparing

If you want to make sure that you use a skill or attribute successfully, you can take an extra round preparing.

You do nothing for one round, and in the next, you make your skill roll. In this case, your skill code is increased by 1D. Example: Your Shooting skill is 3D. You spend an extra round aiming. You roll 4D when you fire.

Running

If you run in the same combat round that you use a skill, your skill code is reduced by 1D.

Example: Your Shooting skill is 3D. You dash across the hall, firing your pistol at a guard. You roll 2D when you fire!

Wounds

If you are wounded when you use a skill, your skill code is reduced by 1D.

Example: Your character is wounded from a previous fight with guards. Normally their Shooting skill is 3D. However, because they are wounded, when they fire, you roll 2D.

Using More Than One Skill

It's important to note that you can use more than one skill or attribute in a single combat round, although not in a single action segment. You have to decide which skills you will use during the combat round at the beginning of the round and tell the gamemaster what you'll do. Every skill use after the first one costs you 1D. If you use two skills, all skill codes are reduced by 1D; if you use skills three times, all codes are reduced by 2D; if you use skills four times, codes are reduced by 3D; and so on. These reductions apply to all skill uses in that combat round. That is, if you use skills twice, both uses are reduced by 1D, etc.

Obviously, if you try to do too many things, none of them will work.

You can only spend a round preparing (and get an extra die) when you use one skill. If you spend one round preparing, then decide you want to use two or more skills in the next round, you lose the benefit of preparation, and don't get the extra 1D.

Multiple Die Code Modifications

If you are wounded and you attempt to use a skill, the 1D reduction and the 1D increase cancel each other out, and you just use your unmodified skill code. Similarly, the increases and reductions for wounds, running, and multiple actions are added together when more than one applies.

Combat

Combat is fought in combat rounds, each of which represents about five seconds of “real” time. In a roleplaying game, combat is not fought on a board.

- The gamemaster describes your surroundings and opponents. Then, they go around the table, and ask each player what their character is doing this combat round.
- When they come to you, you must tell the gamemaster what skills you’re using, and how many times you’re using them — “I’m firing once at the soldier on the left and moving over there to take cover.”
- Next, the gamemaster tells you what your opponents are doing.
- Then, actions are resolved.
- You continue playing combat rounds until one side or the other is defeated or gives up.

Action Segments

At the beginning of the combat round, each player must declare what their character is doing — whether he’s moving, and if so where; and what skills he’s using. Combat rounds are divided into action segments.

During each action segment, each character may use skills or an attribute, and move.

Movement, skills, and attribute use occur in the order declared, one per action segment. A character cannot “pass” a segment; actions are resolved until the character has run out of declared actions to perform.

There is no hard limit on how many action segments a character can take as part of a combat round. However, each action segment after the first applies a -1D penalty on any die codes used during that combat round.

Initiative

Normally, it doesn’t matter exactly when during an action segment a particular character gets to act. Everyone just moves, or shoots, or uses some other skill. The only time it matters is when someone uses a skill that will affect another character’s skill use.

When two characters are doing things that affect each other, make skill or attribute rolls for both. If a character is moving, make an Agility roll instead (since there’s no skill code for movement).



The high roller goes first. Then, the character with the next highest roll goes, and so on. The same roll is used to determine whether the character's skill or attribute use succeeds.

If rolls are tied, and one of the tied characters is a player character, the player character gets to go first. If they're both non-player characters or both player characters, re-roll.

This particular initiative system requires the GM to be comfortable making decisions and ad hoc calls on the fly during the game.

If you want something that's a bit more structured, you can find alternative initiative systems on [page 69](#).

Movement

Each combat round, you can hold still, walk, or run. Walking and running aren't skills; they're something everyone can do.

Walking or running is an action and takes a segment. If you hold still or walk, you can turn by any amount — right or left.

If you walk, you can move up to five meters in any direction. “Five meters” sounds precise, but since combat is fought in the imagination rather than on a board or map, you must rely on the GM's judgment. If they tell you that you can get someplace or reach a character in one round by walking, that's the case. If they tell you that you must run to get there in one round, or that it will take several rounds, their judgment is final.

If you run, you can move up to ten meters in any direction (twice as far as walking). In a combat round where a character runs, any skill rolls made are reduced by 1D (see above).

Some groups like using miniatures and maps. That's absolutely doable with D62e! You just have to decide how “fast” movement is. We generally recommend you allow 5 squares (generally 1”) or hexes on a map for an average human character. We treat each 1” square or hex as a “meter.”

If a character has a high Agility (4+), you might want to give them +1 square of movement, though that's up to you.

Prone

You can always fall prone, without any penalty, at the end of your movement. Falling prone is part of movement, not a separate action. Prone characters can only move by crawling, and may move up to two meters per round. When a crawling character makes a skill roll, their die code is reduced by 1D (just like a running character).

Getting up from a prone position is an action; you can turn and use skills in the same round, but you can't move. Prone characters are harder to hit in combat.

A prone character has a maximum Dodge and Parry score of 10 against melee attacks and adds +10 to their Dodge score against Ranged attacks. When successfully struck by an attack, a character can always choose to drop prone.

Attacking & Damage

Characters will often attack each other, either through Melee or Shooting. To attack a target, you simply make a Skill roll and compare the result to their appropriate Defense Difficulty Number.

When making a Shooting attack, compare the result to Dodge. When making a Melee attack, compare the result to Parry.

If you roll higher than the difficulty number for your attack, you hit your target.

Each weapon has a damage code. You can find weapons sorted by era on [page 80](#).

When you hit a target, roll your weapon's damage dice!

Then, the gamemaster rolls **Brawn** dice for your target. How badly you injure the target depends on the two rolls:

- **Brawn Roll greater than Damage Roll:** Staggered.
- **Brawn Roll equal to or less than Damage Roll:** Wounded.
- **Brawn Roll equal to or less than Damage Roll, and Damage Roll invoked a Complication:** Mortally Wounded.

Example: Your damage roll is 12. If the target's Brawn roll is:

- **13 or more**, they're stunned.
- **12 or less**, they're wounded.
- **12 or less, and the Wild Die for the Brawn Roll showed a '1'**, they're Mortally Wounded.

A staggered character suffers a -1D penalty on all die codes rolled. Staggered goes away at the start of the next round. This penalty does not apply to Brawn rolls made to resist damage. If a staggered character is staggered a second time while staggered, they are instead stunned.

A stunned character can't do anything for the rest of the combat round. Stunned goes away at the start of the next round.

A wounded character falls prone and can't do anything for the rest of this round. Any time they roll a skill or attribute check, their die code is reduced by 1D. Like the staggered penalty, this -1D does not apply to Brawn rolls made to resist damage. A wounded character who is wounded again is "incapacitated." Wounded goes away after a character has received medical treatment or rested for 24 hours.

An incapacitated character falls prone and is unconscious. They can't do anything at all until healed. An incapacitated character who is wounded again is “mortally wounded.” Incapacitated goes away after 24 hours, or after receiving medical treatment.

A mortally wounded character falls prone and is unconscious. they can't do anything until healed. Worse yet, at the end of every combat round, they must roll 2D. If the total of the roll is less than the number of rounds since they were mortally wounded, they die. Mortally wounded only goes away after medical treatment.

At the end of the round in which a character became mortally wounded roll 2D; if the roll is less than a “1” (which is impossible), they die. The next round, they die on anything less than a “2” (also impossible); the third round, on anything less than a “3”; the fourth, on anything less than a “4”; and so on. In other words, they are going to die eventually — and soon — unless someone gets the dying character to a doctor.

Important: Making a **Brawn** roll when hit is not considered an action or a regular attribute use; you never modify the **Brawn** code for running, wounds, taking an extra round, or multiple skill use.

Armor

Armor provides a bonus to Brawn rolls made to avoid damage. You simply add the armor rating as bonus dice when rolling the Brawn roll to avoid damage.



Attributes & Skills

D62e features four attributes that govern your character. These attributes are almost always rolled in conjunction with skills that you are using to accomplish tasks and challenges.



Agility

Agility is the attribute that governs physical finesse, dexterity, nimbleness, and more. It's how you avoid getting hit in melee combat, how easily you take to feats of acrobatics, swing your sword, or fire your gun.

Highly agile characters are quick, sometimes even overly twitchy, and seem loaded like a coiled desert snake, ready to strike.



Brawn

Brawn is the attribute that governs physical force, strength, fortitude, and might. It's how hard you can hit, how much you can lift, how long you can run or hold your breath, and how imposing you can be when you use your physicality to make a point.

Highly brawny characters are often muscular or have large statures, often even seeming muscle bound and bulky.



Knowledge

Knowledge is the attribute that governs your learning, intellect, and mental skillsets. It's how you learn languages, recall scientific or historical information, train to use medicine, or display your educational prowess.

Highly knowledgeable characters often know multiple languages and sciences and seem to be a wealth of information. They can be know-it-alls at times but are useful to have around.



Perception

Perception is the attribute that governs tasks and skills related to awareness, insight, and situations. It's how you know where to place your foot to avoid twigs while sneaking in a forest, how you can locate clues from a murder scene, or ride your horse while avoiding obstacles.

Highly perceptive characters are often very aware of their surroundings and are almost never surprised, but can appear paranoid or overly interested.

Rolling Skills Instead of Attributes

Normally, you use skills instead of attributes. Whenever a character tries to do something, use the skill rules (below) to decide which skill he's using. But sometimes, a character tries to do something which isn't covered by any of the skills in the game. For instance, there's no juggling skill. The gamemaster has two options.

First, you can pick the closest skill and just have them roll that. This is cinematic, but it also means a character with a high skill might be inordinately good at things that don't make a lot of narrative sense (by virtue of just being likely to succeed).

If you're concerned about that, you can just use attribute rolls. In this case, you use the attribute which governs what the character is doing. If a character's Brawn is the determining factor, use their Brawn; if their Knowledge is what's important, use their Knowledge. When a character juggles, Agility is what's important, so you use their Agility.

To look at it another way, skills are specialized attributes. If you have no training in shooting, you use your innate Agility when you try to fire a ranged weapon. When you start learning more about firearms, you specialize, and develop a separate skill.

In fact, the skills listed on the character templates are not the only skills that can exist in the game. There's a blank provided under each attribute for players to write in the name of another skill. If a player wants to specialize in something which none of the skills covers, let them do so; have them write the skill name on the blank space provided and write the skill code next to it. For example, if a player wants to learn how to juggle better, let them do so — have them write "Juggling" under "Agility."

It sometimes happens that a character wishes to do something that seems to fall equally under two or more different skills or attributes. This is rare, but it does happen. In this case, let the character use whichever skill or attribute is higher. After all, your job is to keep the story going — not to frustrate your players.

Determining Difficulty Numbers

Exactly how do you determine difficulty numbers? The Gamemaster assigns all risky actions a Difficulty Number (DN) based on how hard they are!

Rules for each skill are provided below. When a rule describes a specific task, it provides a difficulty number for that task. In addition, each skill rule describes the skill's general purpose; a character is using the skill whenever they do something that falls under its general purpose. In this case, you must decide on the difficulty number. Just ask yourself "How easy is it?" and use the guidelines in the adjacent chart:

Difficulty Number (DN)	How Hard?
5	Very Easy
10	Easy
15	Average
20	Difficult
25	Very Difficult
30	Extremely Difficult
35	Near Impossible
40	Mythical

Using Skills and Timing

Most skills take one round to use (Shooting, for example). Of course, a character can use more than one skill in a round, at a cost (see [page 29](#)).

Some skills take longer than a round to use. For example, a gambler doesn't finish their game in five seconds — playing takes a little while, maybe a couple of minutes or so. A character using a gambling skill would only make a skill roll every few minutes to see how the current game went.

Each skill description says how long using the skill takes. If a skill takes more than one round to use, the user cannot spend an extra round to get an extra 1D; that rule only applies to one-round skills.

In the end, all of these are guidelines, and the gamemaster can adjust as they see fit.



Agility Skills

Acrobatics

Acrobatics is the skill you use when you are trying to perform feats of dexterous physicality. It's used for climbing a wall or rope, jumping over rooftops or obstacles, balancing on a ledge, or similar tasks that require precision physical work.

Acrobatics generally only takes one round to use, though climbing a longer rope or high wall might take multiple rounds and multiple uses of Acrobatics to accomplish your tasks.

As some suggested guidelines, with Acrobatics you can:

- Climb a number of meters equal to your Acrobatics Die Code in one round.
- Jump a number of meters equal to your Acrobatics Die Code with a running jump (or half that with a standing jump).
- Walk a number of meters on a tightrope equal to your Acrobatics Die Code in one round.
- Perform other tasks as the Gamemaster and player agree upon!

Melee

Melee is the skill for hand-to-hand combat! It governs brawling with fists, improvised weapons in a bar fight, and the use of swords, axes, and more. It's essential for pugilists, fencers, and oftentimes soldiers or adventurers who find themselves in tight situations.

Melee generally only takes one round to use.

Melee attacks are rolled against the target's Parry.

Shooting

Shooting governs the use of ranged weapons that are not thrown. This includes bows, firearms, crossbows, and other tools that don't rely on the strength of the wielder. It's an essential skill for soldiers and heroes who wish to engage in combat.

Shooting generally only takes one round to use.

Shooting is always rolled against a target's Dodge score when used to make an attack. If used for showing off (such as target shooting or other tasks) the Difficulty Number will be based on the distance and size of the target.

Sleight of Hand

Sleight of Hand represents nimbleness of fingers, like picking a pocket, hiding small objects, picking a lock, or performing very precise hand movements to unlock an ancient puzzle box.

Sleight of Hand generally only takes one round, though some tasks might take a few more rounds at the Gamemaster's discretion.



Brawn Skills

Athletics

Athletics represents raw physical strength, endurance, and stamina. It's a skill used when lifting, pushing, restraining, or physical activities that rely more on strength than dexterity (such as swimming.)

Athletics generally only takes one round, though some tasks might take a few more rounds if the Gamemaster feels it's appropriate.

As a rough guideline, a character can generally lift 100 lbs. per die code of Athletics with a successful Difficulty 10 roll.



Intimidation

Intimidation is using your physical mass, might, and appearance to cause fear in others. It can be looming over a tied-up foe, flexing, or breaking something to show your strength and cause them to flee, or other such tasks.

Intimidation only takes one round to use.

Stamina

Stamina is used when holding your breath, running long distances, dealing with force marches, resisting poison, pain or disease.

Stamina is generally used in response to a situation and doesn't take an action most of the time.

A character can hold their breath for roughly a minute for each rank of Stamina they have.

Throwing

Throwing represents how far a character can hurl an item, be it an axe, a ball, or other items such as letters or a bag of ill-gotten rewards.

Throwing generally takes an action. How far a character can throw is based on how heavy the item is and how far they are trying to throw it. Generally, a character can throw an item 1 meter per die code of throwing when the item is 15 kilograms or less.



Knowledge Skills

Languages

Languages is used to decipher obscure dialects, learn new languages or deal with the intricacies of the myriad of tongues in the world around them. A character always knows their native language, and each point of Languages grants a conversational talent in a new language or dialect.

Languages generally takes an action to use.

Medicine

Medicine is used to diagnose diseases, heal the hurt, and create poultices and salves. Medicine can represent university learning, local traditions and custom, or any variety of possibilities.

Medicine can be used to remove stunned, wounded, or mortally wounded damage from characters (see [page 33](#).)

- Difficulty 10 to remove stunned
- Difficulty 15 to remove wounded or incapacitated
- Difficulty 20 to remove mortally wounded

Medicine generally takes an action to use.

Scholar

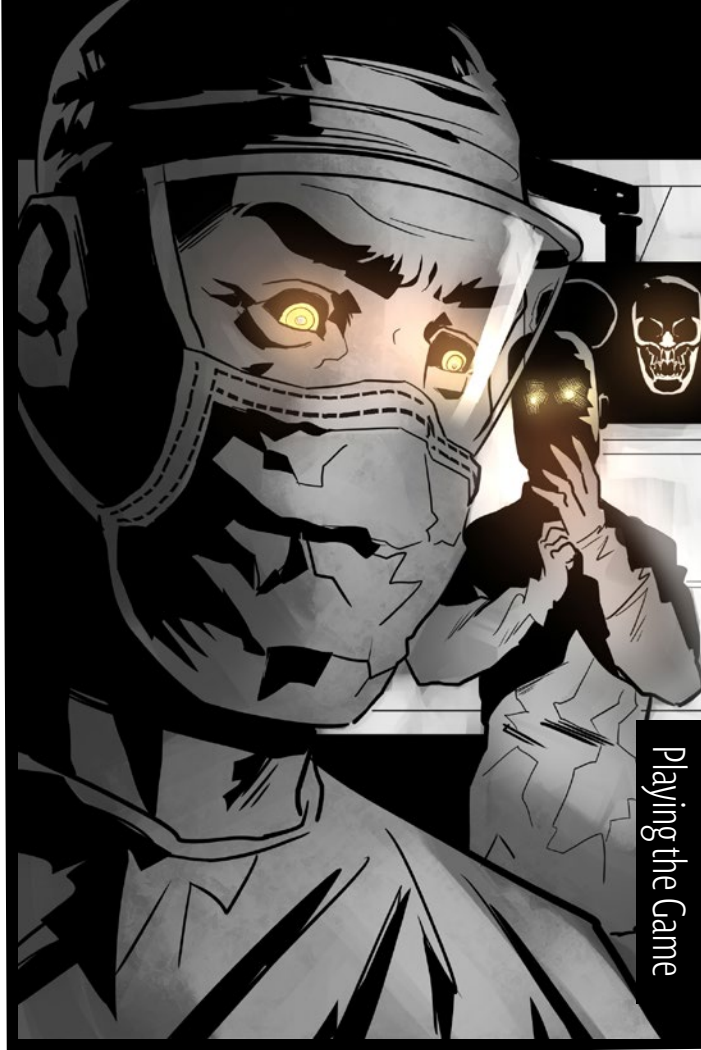
Scholar represents academic pursuits outside the sciences. It covers topics such as art, history, philosophy, religion, and other such fields of study. Think of it as “the humanities” to the sciences that the science skill covers.

Scholar takes an action to use.

Sciences

Sciences represents scientific pursuits such as biology, chemistry, geology, the study of natural life and fauna, and other technical pursuits. It includes technology chemistry, astronomy, engineering, and more.

Sciences takes an action to use.



If the campaign is using the Mechanical and Technical skill modules ([pages 64 and 65](#)) the Science skill can become diluted if the gamemaster is not careful.



Perception Skills

Driving

Driving covers a wide variety of talents and topics, including riding a horse, driving a car or carriage, piloting a boat or craft, and similar tasks. Driving is a broad skill and reflects a generalized overview of transportation.

Driving generally takes an action to use.

Investigation

Investigation is used for gathering information, researching, analyzing data, or creating a pattern from data. It's based on your ability to identify the valuable and essential information.

Investigation usually takes an action, but larger scenes, locations, or hard to find details might change that.

Stealth

Stealth is your ability to remain unnoticed. Your ability to notice where to step, to read and identify the patterns of guards, and to identify good hiding spaces goes a lot further than your dexterity or movement abilities.

Stealth generally takes an action and is opposed by Investigation.

Survival

Survival is used to find your way in the wilderness, calm or manage animals, and know what foods are poisonous or healthy. You can use it to treat injured animals and plant crops.

Survival generally takes an action.

Solo Adventure: A Knight Errant



This solo adventure uses the superhero module and base D62e rules. A playable hero and all relevant NPCs are provided at the end of this section. If desired, you can use your own heroes for this adventure, altering details to suit their identity and powers.

We recommend you print out the pages that contain the attributes of your hero ([page 57](#)), and any reference pages you think you'll need.

This adventure is designed to walk you through and teach you about the mechanics of the D6 System: Second Edition.

Starting Out

You are Tristan Knight, also known as the young, costumed hero Stalwart. You gained your superhuman abilities from a mysterious figure who appeared to you after a near-fatal accident. Since then, you discovered you can fly, are highly resistant to damage, and possess superhuman strength and endurance. You can also generate a costume for yourself, though like your powers, its origins remain a mystery to you. In your civilian identity, you are a sophomore at King State University in Grail City, a bustling metropolis on Lake Superior that seems to be a magnet for superhuman threats and strange happenings.

When the adventure starts you are investigating a lead given to you by Morgan Ambrose, a federal agent for MERLIN (Metahuman Emergency Response Logistics and Intelligence Network), a monitoring organization dedicated to dealing with coordinating response to superhuman threats and dangerous paranormal phenomena. While you're not sure you completely trust Merlin or Ambrose, she has yet to steer you wrong and many of her leads allow you to stop various threats to the public.

You're outside the location Agent Ambrose sent you to check. It's around nine at night and from the outside it seems like a normal warehouse in the city's industrial district. You don't see anyone working though there are a few lights on inside.

- Approach in your civilian identity. Go to 1.
- Check things out as Stalwart. Go to 2.

1

You approach as everyday college student Tristan Knight, trying to look lost. You occasionally check your phone as if seeking information or directions, just in case someone is watching. You approach the front doors of the warehouse and are about to knock when the door opens. A large man nearly fills the doorway. He sizes you up briefly and then says "No trespassing. Beat it."

You start to explain but he doesn't listen, instead giving you a half-hearted shove that still sends you reeling backwards.

"I said beat it, kid. Private property." Then he closes the door in your face. You hear the heavy metal door lock.

- Retreat and observe the warehouse from a distance. Go to 3.
- Retreat, change into Stalwart, and check things out. Go to 2.
- Look for a way to sneak in. Go to 4.

2

You find a spot nearby with no onlookers or cameras to change. Strange energies well up inside you, transforming your clothing into your costume. You have to admit it's better than looking for a phone booth in this day and age.

You fly over the warehouse, looking out for anything amiss. For a time you see nothing, but then you spot a number of vehicles coming down the otherwise empty street, including a large cargo van. The vehicles enter the warehouse parking lot, stop, and several armed individuals get out. A moment later you see one of the garage-style doors of the warehouse open and several burly men exit the building to greet the new arrivals. As you watch, one of the gunmen shouts something and the back of the van opens and a tall slender figure in a green and silver costume exits.

You know this guy. It's Mr. Malefactor, a wanted costumed crook.

- Move in and take Malefactor down, he's a wanted menace! Go to Fight A.
- Wait and see what Malefactor wants. Go to 8.

3

You stay out of sight and watch a while, becoming bored as you stare at the bland exterior of the large warehouse. About the time you're ready to give up and change your approach, several vehicles appear on the street. They approach the warehouse and pull into its parking lot. As you watch, several armed individuals exit. They sweep the area quickly and moments later one of the large garage-style doors on the side of the warehouse open up and several large dangerous looking men come out. The two groups are friendly but cautious. Eventually one of the gunmen gestures to one of their vehicles, a large cargo van. As you observe, the back of the van opens and a slim tall figure in a silver and green costume exits. You've seen him before, at least on the news. It's Mr. Malefactor, a known superpowered criminal active in the city. If he's here, something shady is going on.

- Go to 8.

4

You look around the outside of the warehouse, seeking another way in. Eventually you see a window partially ajar about thirty feet up. Nothing a normal college kid could reach, but you're far from ordinary.

- Fly up to the window. Go to 5
- Reconsider, pull back, and watch the warehouse awhile. Got to 3.

5

The warehouse is dim. Only some of the lights are on, but it's enough to see a half dozen big dangerous looking guys. They are chatting and milling about. You get the distinct impression they're waiting for someone or something. They aren't breaking any laws you can see, but you've got a bad feeling about this.

- Wait and observe. Go to 6.
- Slip quietly through the window and try to sneak closer. Make a Difficulty 15 Stealth test. If you succeed, find an excellent hiding spot nearby and go to 7. If not, you bump the window and it slams shut with an echoing clang. You retreat briefly, waiting as the tough guys inside investigate. Got to 3.

6

You can see much from the window, but they certainly can't see you. After a time, you spot a movement out of the corner of your eye. Several vehicles are arriving. You move deeper into the shadows so they can't see you as they approach. Several armed individuals exit the vehicles and go a quick sweep of the area. Fortunately, they barely look up and you remain undetected.

One of the arrived vehicles is a cargo van and as you watch a slender tall man in a green and silver costume exits. You recognize him from news reports—Mr. Malefactor, a local costumed criminal.

- Go to 8

7

You stay hidden as the big guys socialize and move about the warehouse. They seem to be waiting for a "shipment" and from some of their anecdotes and interactions you get the impression these guys aren't in a legitimate line of work.

After several minutes, one of the big guys gets a call. He takes it, says a few words and then loudly informs his companions “they’re outside.” One of the men hits a button near one of the walls and a large garage style door opens. From your hiding spot you can see several armed men and several vehicles, including a large van. As you watch, the back of the van opens and a tall, slim man in a green and silver costume steps out. You recognize him—it’s Mr. Malefactor, a local costumed criminal. This can’t be good.

- You’re not sure what’s up but you know Malefactor is wanted and you’ve got the drop on him and his goons. Seize the moment and attack. Start Fight A.
- Wait and see what Mr. Malefactor wants here. Go to 8

8

Malefactor exudes arrogance and menace as he approaches the warehouse. One of the goons from the warehouse, a sunglasses-wearing tough who acts like he’s in charge, approaches the villain.

“Mr. Malefactor, sir. It’s a pleasure to meet you.”

“Yes, I’m sure it is,” the villain says, “Do you have my shipment?”

The goon nods and his smile widens. “Yes sir. Six crates of four, as ordered. Are you ready to transfer funds to the account my employer provided?”

Malefactor pauses for a moment, as if he’s considering some other option. Then he looks over his shoulder at one of his men, a shaven-headed Asian man. The man takes a cellphone from his jacket pocket, unlocks it, and types something. He then nods to Malefactor who turns back to look at the goon.

“Done. Load them up.”

The goon nods and soon six larger crates are carried out by pairs of the warehouse heavies. They move to load the crates into the trucks, but Malefactor stops them.

“I want to see the merchandise.”

The goon looks uncertain. This was clearly not part of his instructions. However, he quickly decides not to anger the supervillain. He directs his fellows to place one of the crates in front of Malefactor. You see the villain’s eyes flash with some sort of green energy and the lid of the crate lifts into the air. You can’t see what’s inside from your hiding spot, but you might be able to fly to a better vantage point while everyone is focused elsewhere.

- If you want to try and get a better look, go to 9.
- If you don’t want to risk being discovered, go to 10.

9

You try to maneuver yourself to get a better look at the contents of the crates without alerting Mr. Malefactor, his minions, or the goons from the warehouse. This might be tricky: make a Stealth Test with a TN 20.

- If you succeed, go to 14
- If you fail, the villains spot you and Malefactor orders them all to attack. Go to Fight B.
- On second thought, you'll just stay where you are, go to 10.

10

You stay put and watch. Whatever is in the crates seems to satisfy Malefactor, who uses his psychokinetic energy powers to replace the lid before directing the goons to load the crates.

"If these work as promised, I'll be back for the rest." Malefactor says before ordering his men to finish securing the crates and get ready to leave.

You realize from the villain's statement there is more of whatever he's buying in the warehouse. If you let Mr. Malefactor leave and follow him, the goons and the remaining shipment could be gone when you return. If you stay and take on the goons, who knows what the villain will do with the mysterious shipment? Of course you could attack right now, taking on Malefactor, his men, and the warehouse goons, but even with the element of surprise that's a lot of armed and dangerous criminals to fight.

Whatever you do, it's time to decide. Mr. Malefactor and his minions are getting ready to leave.

- If you let Mr. Malefactor leave and stay at the warehouse, Go to 11.
- If you leave the warehouse and follow Mr. Malefactor. Go to 12.
- If you decide to try and take everyone out now, Go to Fight B.

11

You watch as Malefactor and his minions leave with their part of the shipment. You note the license plates on the vehicles and hope you'll be able to have Agent Ambrose help track them down before you regret letting them get away.

However, now you only have a few unpowered goons to deal with. How you do it is up to you.

- You can attack the goons now, using surprise to your advantage. Go to Fight C.
- Wait awhile and see if anything else happens. Go to 13.

12

You can fly faster than vehicles, so keeping up with them is no trouble. You're pretty sure you aren't spotted as you soar above the convoy. After nearly half an hour, the vehicles arrive at an abandoned cement factory. You think you've located Malefactor's hideout. However, if you've been spotted? Things are about to get really complicated.

- Make a Difficulty 15 Stealth test.
- If you succeed, go to 15.
- If you fail, go to Fight D.

13

You watch and wait. The goons in the warehouse talk amongst themselves for a time. They discuss how the shipment they delivered to Malefactor is going to cause a lot of trouble on the streets. They seem to find this idea amusing. After a time one of the goons gets a call. After a brief discussion he directs his companions to get ready to pack up the remaining crates for another delivery. Most of the goons head outside, giving you a chance to examine the crates if you want. Alternatively, you can ambush the goons, catching them by surprise and taking them out.

- If you attack the goons, go to Fight C
- If you want to examine the crates, make a Difficulty 10 Investigation test.
- If you succeed, go to 16.
- If you fail, go to 17.

14

You manage to find a hiding place with a great view of this obviously shady deal. You watch as Mr. Malefactor pops the top of one of the crates with his psychokinetic powers. Inside are several high-tech weapons—some sort of energy blaster. With firepower like this, Malefactor and his gang would be even more dangerous.

Time to put a stop to this, Go to Fight B.

- If you let Mr. Malefactor leave and stay at the warehouse, Go to 11.
- If you leave the warehouse and follow Mr. Malefactor. Go to 12.

15

Mr. Malefactor's hideout is an old, abandoned factory. Numerous guards patrol the area. If you want to try and take the villain out, you've got the element of surprise. However, it will be a tough fight. Alternatively, you can contact MERLIN and get backup to deal with Malefactor and his goons.

- If you want to go get help, go to Ending A.
- If you decide to handle it yourself, go to Fight E.

16

You manage to carefully open the remaining crates without alerting anyone. Inside are several high-tech looking weapons—some sort of energy weapon. In the wrong hands, these weapons could cause significant damage to the city and its population. You can't let these guys take them. Its time to take out the remaining goons and then call in the authorities to help track down the remaining crates.

- Go to Fight C.

17

You manage to open one of the remaining crates, but you make more noise than you'd like. You have enough time to see the crate contains several high-tech weapons—some sort of energy weapon. You're considering what sort of damage these things could do in the wrong hands when you hear a shout from behind you.

"Hey, we've got a cape in here!" One of the goons shouts before opening fire.

- Go to Fight F

Fight A

You charge into combat, catching your opponents by surprise. This advantage won't last though—make the most of it while you can!

Run this combat as normal, with Stalwart on one side and his opponents on the other. There are 6 Warehouse Goons, 6 Malefactor's Minions, and Mr. Malefactor to deal with.

However, you've got the element of surprise. Take your first turn without your opponents acting.

Further, your sudden appearance spooks the Warehouse Goons. Make an Intimidation test with TN 15. If successful, they flee. You won't have to fight them.

- If you lose, Go to Ending B.
- If you win, Go to Ending C.

Fight B

You manage to take out two of the goons before the bad guys even know you're there. However, Malefactor reacts quickly, flinging a blast of psychokinetic energy your way. You dodge the blast, but it briefly stops your assault.

Mr. Malefactor sneers as you face his goons and him down.

"Sure, you don't want to run home to mom, kid?" Malefactor says, his eyes glowing with green energy.

Before you can reply, he signals his goons to attack. The fight is on.

Run this combat as normal, with Stalwart on one side and his opponents on the other. There are 6 Malefactor's Minions, 4 Warehouse Goons, and Mr. Malefactor to deal with.

- If you lose, Go to Ending B
- If you win, Go to Ending C.

Fight C

You get the drop on the goons, who thought the excitement was over after Mr. Malefactor departed. You grab one and slam him into another, taking both out. Four more to go.

Run this combat as normal, with Stalwart on one side and his opponents on the other. There are only 4 Warehouse Goons still active and Stalwart goes first due to surprise.

- If you lose, Go to Ending B
- If you win, Go to Ending D

Fight D

The goons saw you coming. Worse, they've had time to bust out some advanced hardware. They open fire as you approach the abandoned factory the villain is using as a hideout. The only good news is it seems Mr. Malefactor has left his minions to deal with you while he gets away. You consider trying to catch him, but the first barrage from Malefactor's goons discourages you. Time to take these jokers out.

Run this combat as normal. There are 8 Malefactor's Minions and all are armed with experimental energy weapons which are treated as laser pistols (see [page 59](#)).

- If you lose, Go to Ending B
- If you win, Go to Ending E

Fight E

No one saw you coming, giving you a chance to even the odds by picking off Malefactor's minions before they detect you.

To accomplish this, make a Stealth test starting at TN 5. For each success and for every 10 you beat the TN by, you take out one minion. After each test, increase the TN by 5. Once you fail, you're spotted and the fight begins.

After you are detected, run the combat at normal. There are 12 Malefactor's Minions minus however many you took out before the fight starts. Half are armed with experimental energy weapons which are treated as laser pistols (see [page 59](#)). Malefactor responds to your attack and joins the combat on turn 3.

- If you lose, Go to Ending B
- If you win, Go to Ending F

Fight F

The first goon got the drop on you, but fortunately there's only a half dozen of these guys left. If your luck and powers hold out, no problem.

One of the goons gets a free attack on you to start the battle. Afterwards, run the fight as normal, with a total of 6 Warehouse Goons--5 plus the one who attacked you.

- If you lose, Go to Ending B
- If you win, Go to Ending D

Ending A

You decide this is too much for you to handle alone. Contacting Agent Ambrose at MERLIN, you explain everything you know about Mr. Malefactor, the deal at the warehouse, and the villain's hideout. Ambrose thanks you for the information and praised your discretion.

Unfortunately, your adventure ends here. Despite Ambrose's recommendation, MERLIN decides to not include you when they raid the warehouse and Malefactor's hideout. They do manage to recover most of the cargo, a shipment of stolen, experimental, and dangerous energy weapons. However, Malefactor escapes and several agents are injured.

You can't help but wonder if you could have handled this better on your own.

Ending B

You feel your vision start to cloud and consciousness slip away. For a moment, you wonder if this is how it ends. Then nothing.

You wake up hours later in the hospital. Everything hurts, but you're alive. Your costume is gone, but your mask is still in place. After the medical staff checks you out, you're visited by Morgan Ambrose of MERLIN. She informs you the authorities were alerted by your battle and arrived just in time to see you fall. Your enemies fled, leaving you behind.

"Well, you've got guts. I can't debate that." Ambrose says. "However, maybe next time call for backup. You're lucky you're still around."

Funny, you don't feel lucky.

Ending C

Your assault was impulsive, but it got the job done. You use an empty storage container near the warehouse as an improvised holding cell, putting the unconscious Malefactor, his minions, and the goons from the warehouse inside before bending the door to jam it shut. The authorities may have to cut them out to arrest them, but they aren't going anywhere for a while.

The fight over, you take the time to investigate the crates Mr. Malefactor was buying from the goons. Each contains several high-tech looking weapons—some sort of energy rifle. You're not sure what these things can do, but you feel better knowing they're off the streets.

Task done, you call agent Morgan Ambrose, your contact at MERLIN. You explain the situation and tell her where to find Malefactor and the weapons. She says she'll investigate things and let you know when she tracks down whoever is dealing in such advanced armaments.

You consider sticking around to help the authorities and maybe smile for a few press photos, but your phone buzzes ominously. If you don't get moving, you're going to be late for your next class. Such is the life of Stalwart, Hero of Grail City.

Ending D

Without Mr. Malefactor and his minions to deal with, the fight is short and one-sided. The goons never had a chance, though they tried. You toss them into an empty office in the warehouse and barricade the door with some heavy crates. Even if they regain consciousness before the authorities arrive, they aren't going anywhere.

The goons secured, you investigate the remaining crates Malefactor didn't purchase. Each contains several high-tech looking weapons—some sort of energy rifle. You're not sure what these things can do, but you feel relieved these are off the street and worried about what Malefactor and his gang will do with the rest of them.

Your phone buzzes, the signal you need to ditch your costume and head to your next class at King State. Before you take off, you call Agent Morgan Ambrose at MERLIN. You inform her of the goons, the weapons, and give her all the information you have on Malefactor. She thanks you for the tip and promises to track the villain down. She says she will request you are brought in to help round up the villain and confiscate the remaining weapons, but that's a fight for another day.

Congratulations, you made Grail City a bit safer, though you're also reminded many threats remain for heroes like you.

Ending E

The energy weapons make Malefactor's minions more dangerous than usual, but you manage to take them out. The battle caused a lot of collateral damage, and you hear sirens in the distance. A quick recon of the area confirms what you suspected; Mr. Malefactor has fled. You also find at least a few crates from the arms deal missing. You definitely stopped the bad guys and cost the villain his hideout, but he's still on the streets with at least some of those energy blasters. Still, a win, but a bittersweet one.

You don't want to stick around to answer a lot of questions from the authorities and press, but you take the time to call Agent Ambrose at MERLIN. You give her a rundown of the situation and confirm you'll meet later to share more details. However, for now you need to get to your next class.

So ends another chapter in the never-ending battle against corruption and evil for heroes like you.

Ending F

While it was touch and go for a few moments, you end the battle standing over the unconscious forms of Mr. Malefactor and several of his minions. You drop the bad guys in an empty industrial vat in the villain's factory hideout, using your great strength to seal the top with a large piece of heavy scrap. It won't hold forever, but it should keep anyone who awakes busy until the authorities arrive.

You contact Agent Ambrose at MERLIN, letting her know about the villain, his hideout, and the weapons deal. You leave the crates for the authorities, each containing several nasty looking high-tech rifles—some sort of energy weapon intended to make Malefactor's gang even more dangerous. Ambrose congratulates you on getting the villain and the weapons off the streets. She tells you not to worry about the goons at the warehouse, she's sending a team to arrest them and seize the rest of the weapons.

A moment after you hang up with Ambrose, your phone buzzes ominously. Crap, you're going to be late for class. Despite this, you did good today. Grail City is safer for your actions.

Cast

The following characters are needed to complete this adventure.

Stalwart

Tristan Knight gained his superhuman abilities after a mysterious bearded man appeared to you after you barely survived a fatal car accident. The strange figure somehow healed your wounds, insisting you were destined for “great deeds and stalwart acts of heroism.” A short time later you realized you now possesses incredible abilities including the power of flight, superhuman strength, stamina, and durability, and the ability to fire powerful blasts of pure force. Inspired by the strange man’s words and seeking to use your powers for good, you became Stalwart, the newest protector of Grail City.



This version of Stalwart is written to be easily usable during the solo adventure. To that end, we’ve rolled his superpowers right into his stats to avoid clutter and confusion. For example, Stalwart’s “armor” stat consists of Brawn and his superpowered toughness and his attacks include all relevant abilities and modifications!

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

- Acrobatics 1D
- Flying 1D

Brawn: 4D

- Melee 3D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 3D

- Investigation 1D
- Stealth 1D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 15
- Armor: 5D

ATTACKS

Punch: Attack – 7D; Damage – 6D

Mr. Malefactor

Malcom Edward Faktor was a mercenary and expert in industrial espionage who gained superhuman powers after exposure to a mysterious green crystal he was hired to steal. Since then, Faktor has operated at the costumed villain Mr. Malefactor. A keen strategist, he prefers to operate with henchmen or other super-criminals—though he is a picky about who he works with. Malefactor's powers are psychokinetic in nature and using them is always accompanied by a distinctive green glow.

Combat Tactics

Mr. Malefactor is a cunning strategist, but he's also arrogant and overconfident. In combat he opens with a psychokinetic blast, favors direct damage attacks, and occasionally spices things up with a more complex use of his powers. If desired roll a d6 every turn for the villain to determine his attack: 1-3 Psychokinetic Blast, 4-5 Psychokinetic Grab, 6 Uses Psychokinesis to grab a large object from the environment and strike his target.



ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

- Shooting 3D

Brawn: 3D

- Melee 2D
- Throwing 1D

Knowledge: 3D

Perception: 3D

- Stealth 1D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 15
- Armor: 4D

ATTACKS

Psychokinetic Blast: Attack - 6D; Damage - 4D

Psychokinetic Grap: Attack - 5D; Damage - 5D

Psychokinetic Throw: Attack - 4D; Damage - 6D

Malefactor's Minions

A better brand of henchmen than many villains hire, these guys tend to have better weapons and a bit more sense than most in their line of work. However, they're still no match for costumed heroes except in large groups.

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

- Shooting 1D

Brawn: 2D

- Melee 1D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 1D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 10
- Parry: 10
- Armor: 3D

ATTACKS

Stolen Energy

Pistol: Attack - 3D;
Damage - 4D

Punch: Attack - 3D;
Damage - 2D



Warehouse Goons

These are typical lower-rung gangsters who were hired because they can hit hard, act intimidating, and don't mind committing crimes. They aren't much of a threat alone, but with luck and numbers they can cause plenty of trouble.

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

Brawn: 2D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 1D

DEFENSES

• Dodge: 10

• Parry: 10

• Armor: 2D

ATTACKS

Punch: Attack - 2D; Damage - 2D

Agent Morgan Ambrose

A former FBI profiler turned agent for MERLIN, Morgan Ambrose is a skilled detective and expert in abnormal psychology. She's decent in a fight, but prefers to leave the "grunt work" to superpowered individuals who are better suited to confronting the costumed psychopaths and amoral super-mercenaries her cases tend to involve.



ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

Brawn: 2D

Knowledge: 2D

• Scholar 2D

• Sciences 1D

Perception: 4D

• Investigation 3D

• Stealth 1D

DEFENSES

• Dodge: 20

• Parry: 10

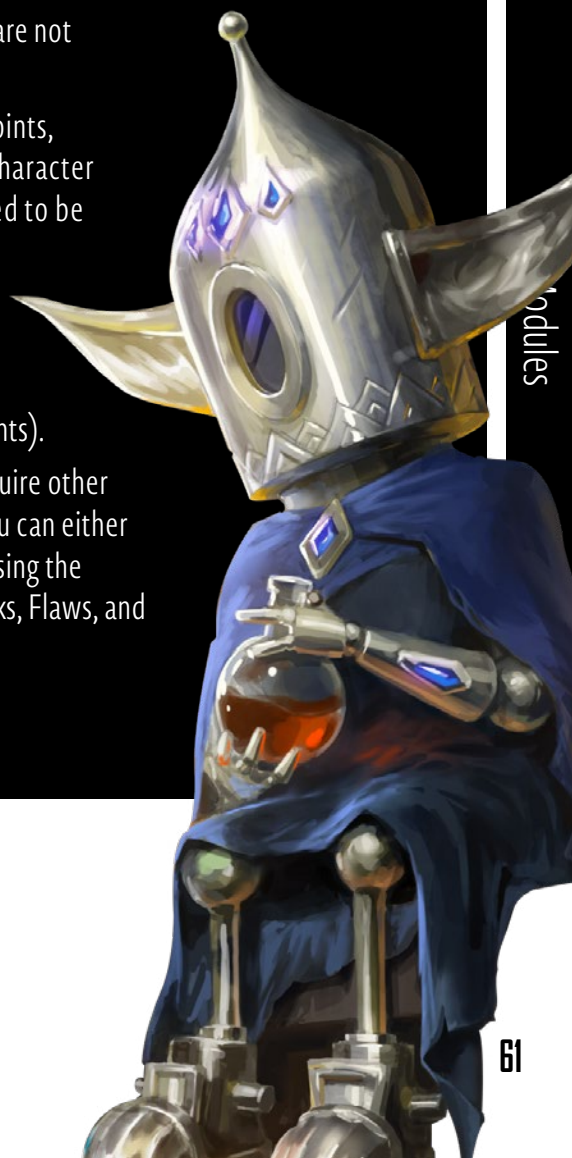
• Armor: 2D

Core Modules

What follows are the core modules that can be used to modify your game. These modules are not tied to particular genres or settings, but can be applied how you see fit. Some modules are incompatible or do not play nicely together, and we've done our best to call them out so you can be forewarned with the decisions you're making.

INCOMPATIBLE MODULES

- When using Wild Die modules, only use one. These are not designed to be compatible.
- When using Hero Point modules, only use *one*. These are not designed to be compatible.
- When using Initiative modules, only use *one*. These are not designed to be compatible.
- When using Advancement Modules (experience points, milestone character advancement, and narrative character advancement) use only *one*. These are not designed to be compatible.
- Some modules require other modules. This most often appears as a module requiring Hero Points in some form, though others might occur. Those are called out in the module (illustrating any requirements).
- The Perks, Flaws, and Talents modules will often require other modules (Pips and Hero Points most frequently). You can either rework the Perks, Flaws, and Talents if you are not using the requisite modules, or just eschew the particular Perks, Flaws, and Talents that require other modules.



Module: Additional Attributes

These attributes can be slotted into and added to your game to customize what your characters can (and can't) do! Some are tied to particular genres, but any of them can be slotted in easily.

The Charm skill module is suitable for any game.

The other modules are generally tied to specific genre, though you can add them however you want:

- Mechanical and Technical are rooted in the Science fiction module, though they easily slot into modern or superhero genre games.
- Mysticism and Magic are rooted in the Fantasy genre module.

We've tied various modules to genres, but that's mostly for organizational purposes. We felt they made the most sense in those places throughout the book. The only real guide is the mechanical call outs above that define what rules *do not work* together.

As long as the module fits your game, regardless of where it sits in the genre list, you should use it!



Charm

Charm is the attribute that governs social interactions. It's a combination of personality, appearance (though it doesn't have to be), self-esteem, and mastery of niceties. Charm is how you can convince the guard to let you in, even if they don't know you, and how you resist intimidation or seduction.

Highly charming characters are often the center of attention and great with people, but can seem smarmy, shady, or self-centered.

Charm Skills

Command

Command is your ability to be a leader, to have your instructions followed, and your actions emulated. It's based on your force of personality, your experience, and your charisma. You can rally fleeing allies and help troops stand their ground.

Command generally takes an action to use.

Deceive

Deceive helps you mislead, misdirect, and disguise yourself. It's used when subterfuge is the order of the day, and when the truth has to be hidden.

Deceive generally takes an action to use.

Persuasion

Persuasion is your ability to use soft social power to convince others. It's rhetoric, diplomacy, flattery, and empathy. It's used in courts, haggling, and debates to convince others of your position.

Persuasion generally takes an action to use.

Willpower

Willpower is your ability resist and withstand social attacks (like those done with Command, Deceive or Persuasion), temptation, torture, and seduction. It's a defense for your esteem, thoughts, and emotions.

Willpower is used in reaction to situations and events and generally doesn't take an action to use.

The most common use of Willpower is when either of the two magical modules ([page 145](#) and [page 160](#)) or Psionics ([page 184](#)) are in use. Those powers will often allow a Willpower test to avoid, reduce, or resist the effects of the powers.

If you are not using those modules, it is a good idea to make sure Willpower can be used to power through hard situations (to give it something to do).



Mechanical

The mechanical skills cover operating non-digital and mechanical equipment, from vehicles and starships, to radios and navsat gear.

Mechanical Skills

Communications

The communications skill involves the use of communication devices, codes, and call signs, as well as boosting signals, or overcoming jamming, as well as utilizing tools like radar or various science fiction sensory arrays.

Communications generally takes an action to use.

Navigation

Navigation involves plotting courses, be they for starships, sailboats, or land caravans. It involves using maps, landmarks, and other tools to move through a terrain.

Navigation generally takes an action to use.

Piloting

Piloting involves flying airplanes, spaceships, hovercraft, or any conveyance that takes place through the air.

Piloting generally takes an action to use.

For how piloting affects combat, see [page 176](#) for Starships and Starship Combat.

If you are using the Mechanical Skill module, the core skill Driving is changed to cover ground/terrestrial transportation (no flying vehicles). It covers riding, driving, and boating. The Piloting skill covers aerial vehicles (interstellar and atmospheric).

Use/Repair Mechanical

This skill involves using other mechanical equipment not covered by the above such as industrial equipment, heavy machinery not covered by the above skills, or other items that might crop up.

It also covers repairing mechanical items in general, though gamemasters might want to lean on other Mechanical skills for some specifics (Piloting for airplane repair).

Use/Repair Mechanical generally takes an action to use.

It might seem odd to shove all those skills into one “catch-all” skill, but a majority of the smaller use cases come up so rarely, that a general skill proved very useful in playtesting. If you want to fine-tune the skill, the Specializations and Advanced Skill module on [page 96](#) will prove useful!



Technical

Technical skills cover manipulating, repairing, modifying, hacking, or destroying equipment and gear (specifically digital gear).

Technical Skills

Computers

Computers involves programming, hacking, disrupting and undermining technological threats, and can be used for repairing computers.

Computers generally takes an action to use.

Demolition

This skill covers setting explosives or destroying items and gear. It can be used to pinpoint weak points, find access, or know exactly how to build or set a bomb for maximum effect and nothing more.

Demolitions generally takes an action to use.

Use/Repair Technical

This skill involves using other technical equipment not covered by the above, such as power armor, specific firearms, drones, or similar equipment or edge cases that might crop up.

It also covers repairing technical items in general, though gamemasters might want to lean on other Technical skills for some specifics (Computers for laptop repair).

Use/Repair Technical generally takes an action to use.

It might seem odd to shove all those skills into one “catch-all” skill, but a majority of the smaller use cases come up so rarely, that a general skill proved very useful in playtesting. If you want to fine-tune the skill, the Specializations and Advanced Skill module on [page 96](#) will prove useful!

Upgrade

Upgrade covers improving technical (and often mechanical) gear, so the gear provides a greater benefit. This might be for a narrative gain against a particular obstacle, or for a limited +1D (or more) bonus when the equipment is used next.

Upgrade generally takes an action to use.



Mysticism

Mysticism covers religious abilities, prayers, miracles, faith, cults, religions, and divine beings. These skills tend to be about faith and belief more than magical or arcane power, and as such are more nebulous in their application.

Unlike other attributes, the Mysticism attribute module only has three skills under it.

We’ve chosen the word *mysticism* for “divine magic” in this game. We felt it struck a balance between the mythical and occult of ancient antiquity and common fantasy gaming parlance.

Mysticism Skills

Esoterica

The esoterica skill covers knowing things about gods, their faiths and cults, divine beings like angels, demons, or similar, as well as the practices and rituals of various faiths. It is scholarly knowledge around religion.

Esoterica generally takes an action to use.

Ritual

Ritual is the skill used to lead a religious group, through rite, action, or other elements. This can involve a sermon, baptism, or other ordination to a faith, or secret words or codes that allow access to inner sanctums of faith. It also might cover secret rituals, rites, and lore of the faith.

Ritual is a skill those who lead and practice in a faith have whereas esoterica is what anyone can learn about that faith.

Ritual generally takes an action to use.

Prayer

Prayer is a skill that involves attempting to commune with divine beings. Usually prayers for intervention or aid are directed at a deity that one worships. It can be a lesser being (an angel or demon), though the reward will likely be less. Prayer generally comes with some aid (the gamemaster will determine what that looks like), though a catastrophically bad roll might result in a removal of the favor of the divinity one is supplicating to.

Prayer generally takes an action to use.

If you are using a Hero Point module, a good reward for a Prayer roll can be a bonus hero point that can only be used in service of the god or faiths' goals and restrictions.

Alternatively, you might allow Prayer to emulate a spell ([page 145](#)). In this case, treat Prayer like the appropriate magic skill, but add +5 to the difficulty and the supplicant must spend a Hero Point for the effect to happen.



Magic

This module requires the Skill Specialization & Advanced Skills module on [page 96](#).

The Magic Attribute & Skill Module is explicitly tied to the Freeform Skill Based Magic module ([page 145](#)). It can be use independently of that, though the gamemaster will have to adjust how various things work (as this module covers how one casts magic using the Freeform Skill-Based Magic rules).

The Magic attribute governs skills related to understanding magic, crafting magic items, knowing how to identify and cast arcane spells.

Magic Skills

Arcane World

This skill governs knowing, understanding, and identifying magical creatures, planets, locations, and more. If the being, location, item, or lore is part of the world, this skill is how you can tell if you know that information.

Arcane World generally takes an action to use.

Craft Magic Item

This skill is used to create magic items like potions, weapons, armors, wands, and more. The difficulty of crafting, as well as how magical effects are handled is up to the gamemaster, though inspiration can be taken from the “Crafting Spells” section on [page 153](#).

Craft Magic Item generally takes a long time to use (measured in days or weeks), rather than actions.

Identify Magic

This skill governs understanding magic, its effects, analyzing and assessing spells as they’re cast, as well as the knowledge needed to negate or overcome magical effects and spells.

Identify Magic generally takes an action to use.

Spell School (Specialization)

Each spell school is its own specialization (see [page 147](#) for details on skill specializations).

There are four schools of magic and skill specializations to choose from: *change* (also called alteration), *movement* (also called apportation), *creation* (also called conjuration), and *knowledge* (also called divination).

You can find more details on how this skill works under Freeform Skill-Based Magic on [page 145](#).

Spell School always takes one or more actions to use.

Astute D6 System veterans might notice that these skill names mirror those found in D6 Fantasy. While we have taken the naming convention and meaning of the skills from that edition of the game, the rules are not the same as in that edition, so read carefully!

Module: Alternate Initiative

What follows are optional initiative systems. One system should be used as the default for the campaign (replace the standard initiative with whichever system you choose). We don't recommend using multiple styles of initiative in a single campaign.

The gamemaster applies one of three methods to determine in what order everyone goes. Determining initiative does not count as an action.

Simple Initiative

The first method is to allow whichever group makes the first significant action (such as those surprising other characters in an ambush) to act first in the round. The groups retain the same order until the scene ends. Inside the groups, initiative can be treated fluidly (players can go in any order, then all enemies go in any order, or inverse).

Basic Initiative

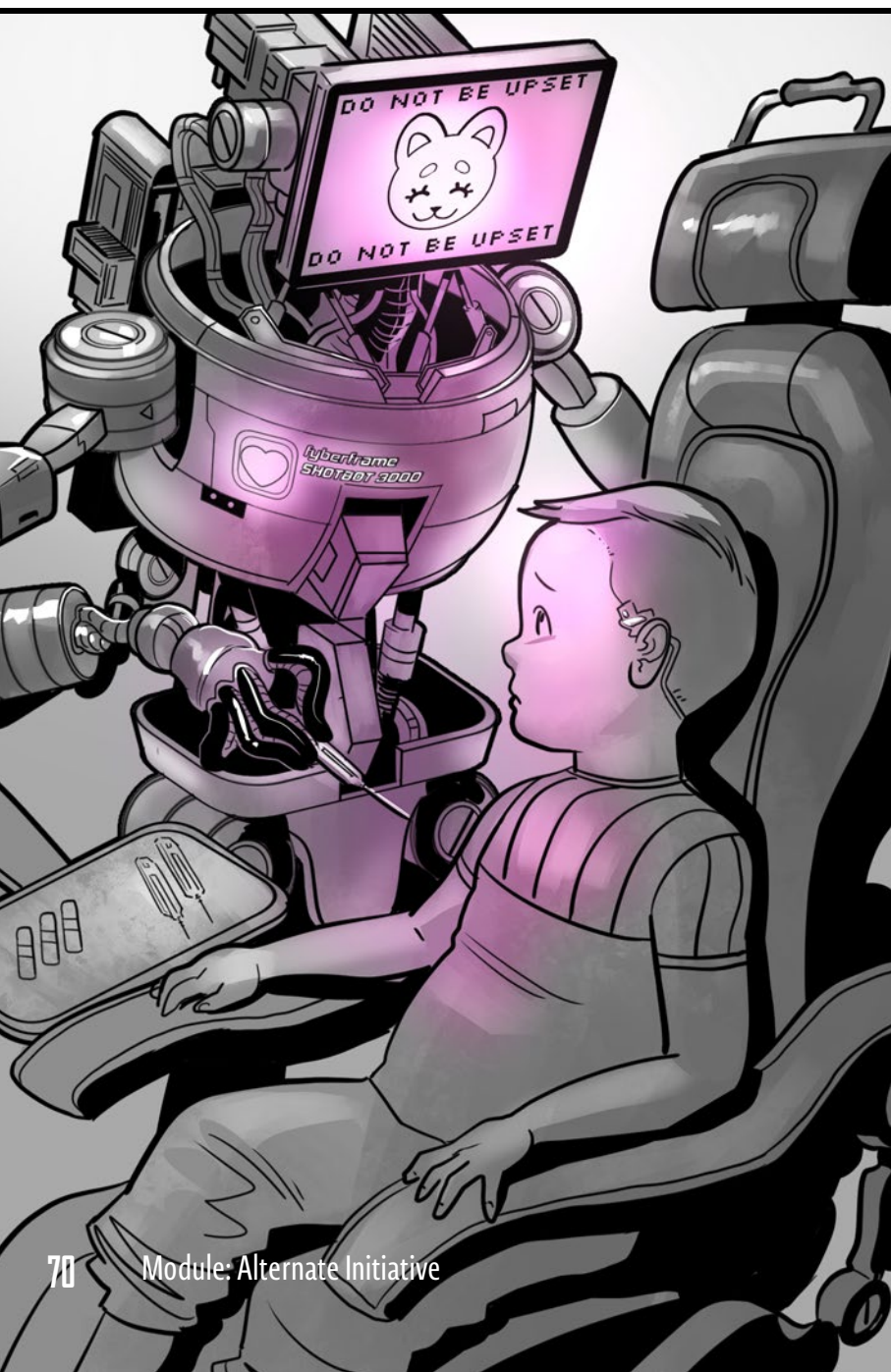
All participants in the combat make a Perception attribute roll. The participant with the lowest result must declare their action segments for the combat round. Declarations continue from lowest to highest, then actions are resolved from highest to lowest, taking all declared penalties and results into consideration.

There is no hard limit on how many action segments a character can take as part of a combat round, though each action segment after the first applies a penalty on any die codes used during that combat round.

Narrative Initiative

This mode grants a lot of control on how the scenes unfold, and can be unwieldy (it leads to “top heavy” style actions where one party can be overwhelmed).

Make a Perception attribute roll. Whomever has the highest result declares their action segments. Then, they choose who goes next. This continues until all participants have declared their action segments. Then, resolve (from highest to lowest) the declared action segments. Whomever went last gets to go first on the next round and choose who follows them.



If the game is using hero points, the gamemaster might want to consider allowing for an interrupt. The gamemaster can grant one (or two) hero points to the player who is about to declare their actions, and have an enemy declare instead (effectively short cutting the order). This grants the player a bit of reward for being overruled in turn order, but stops the players from an “alpha strike” style approach to problem solving.

Module: Alternate Wild Die

What follows are modules that modify how the wild die works or is applied in your game. You should only choose one Wild Die module.

The game presents four in total, three below and one in the core rules (called “Core” Wild Die – see [page 26](#)).

“Basic” Wild Die

This is the middle of the road choice of these three below (Classic being the more complex option and Simple being the easiest).

In the Basic Wild Die module, whenever dice are rolled, one of those dice must be of a different color than all of the others (this is not an extra die; if it ever matters for module interaction, the wild die is mechanically one of the character’s skill dice).

- Whenever the wild die comes up as a 2, 3, 4, or 5, it counts normally.
- When the wild die comes up as a 6, it counts as a 6 (add it to the total) but it is also rolled again. This is called “exploding” the wild die.
 - If the new roll comes up as a 1,2,3,4, or 5, add that to the total and stop rolling.
 - If the new roll is a 6, add that to the total and roll the die again, repeating the process until you stop rolling sixes.
- If the wild die result comes up as a 1 on the first roll only, remove the wild die and your *single highest* non-wild die result from the roll total. Tally up the rest of the dice and resolve the test as normal!

This wild die result leads to swingy rolls, as well as severe penalties on some rolls. It’s best suited for hardscrabble, horrific, or grim games where failure is more common than success.



“Classic” Wild Die

This module emulates some of the most-played and loved versions of the wild die from previous D6 System games.

Whenever dice are rolled, one of those dice must be of a different color than all of the others (this is not an extra die; if it ever matters for module interaction, the wild die is mechanically one of the character’s skill dice).

- Whenever the wild die comes up as a 2, 3, 4, or 5, it counts normally.
- When the wild die comes up as a 6, it counts as a 6 (add it to the total) but it is also rolled again. This is called “exploding” the wild die.
 - If the new roll comes up as a 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5, add that to the total and stop rolling.
 - If the new roll is a 6, add that to the total and roll the die again, repeating the process.

As you can see, it’s possible to roll really high totals if the die keeps on coming up as a 6! This can lead to exciting, but improbable amounts of character success, so some gamemasters like to cap how many times a wild die can “explode” (be rerolled).

The wild die can also hurt a character’s chances of doing something.

- For the first roll only, if the wild die comes up as a 1, do not add the die to the total because some kind of a mishap has occurred (see Mishaps).

MISHAPS

Mishaps take two distinct forms: penalties and complications.

While the type of mishap is left strictly up to the gamemaster's interpretation, penalties are much more common than complications.

Penalties are routine; complications are special events which increase tension and add to the drama of the story.

If you want a simple mechanic, roll a die: on a 1-5, the character suffers a penalty; on a 6, the character suffers a complication.

- Penalties: ignore the wild die result, as well as the highest single die result from the total of the roll (basically, losing the wild die, and the best result on the roll).
- Complications: These are significant narrative modifiers to the stories (an ambush, being captured or discovered, etc).

“Simple” Wild Die

This is the easiest version of the Wild Die to use. It’s also the most swingy!

Whenever dice are rolled, one of those dice must be of a different color than all of the others (this is not an extra die; if it ever matters for module interaction, the wild die is mechanically one of the character’s skill dice).

- Whenever the wild die comes up as a 1, 2, 3, 4, or 5, it counts normally.
- When the wild die comes up as a 6, it counts as a 6 (add it to the total) but it is also rolled again. This is called “exploding” the wild die.
 - If the new roll comes up as a 1,2,3,4, or 5, add that to the total and stop rolling.
 - If the new roll is a 6, add that to the total and roll the die again, repeating the process.

There are no other effects for the wild die.

As you can see, this particular module is very easy to use, but can lead to wild “swings” in results for lucky characters! You might wish to cap how many times the wild die can explode if you feel it goes too far.

Module: Chases

Chases are a dramatic concern in most stories, and therefore the rules presented are kept relatively light and freeform so they can be adapted to the needs of the table as you play. A chase should be resolved quickly and be an exciting set piece!

Chases are opposed rolls that leverage an extra rule: Distance.

Distance is a number that must be reduced or increased to be the victor in a race. Distance normally starts at 4 when a chase begins but can be modified by the gamemaster as needed.

Each participant in the race will roll (a group elects one individual to make a single roll for the group.) The winner gets to increase or decrease the Distance by 1 (2 on an Exceptional Success). If the Distance reaches 0, the pursuer has caught the fleeing party. If it reaches 8, the fleeing party has evaded being caught and vanishes.

Chases can cover quite a bit of territory, both in terms of location, as well as game mechanics. The goal of the Chase rules in D6 System: Second Edition is to be easy to use, quick to resolve, and to be flexible enough to fit a variety of situations and genres you might find yourself needing them for.

For vehicles, superpowers, or magical chases, the gamemaster will probably have to add or consider additional options, but keep this basic framework in mind, and you'll find a lot of the heavy lifting done!

The skills that are rolled in a chase illustrate the conditions, obstacles, and opportunities of the chase. Rolling Stamina would indicate a dogged and flat contest of fortitude, whereas Acrobatics is suitable for a chase down a crowded street or across rooftops. It's possible that each participant rolls different Skills based on how they are approaching the chase.

For example, a thief dexterously attempting to escape across a rooftop would roll Acrobatics, but guards who are attempting to simply wear the thief out and run them down as they follow in the streets might roll Stamina.

Bonuses or penalties to the rolls can be applied as the environment changes (knocking over goods or wares, vehicles or locals getting in the way, attempting to trip bystanders)!



Module: Hero Points

Many D6 System games featured Hero Points over the years! These modules allow you to add a variety of different Hero Point uses to your game.

We advise you only use one Hero Point module in your game (there's also a 'Superheroic Hero Points' module which isn't detailed here. You'll find it in the Superhero Modules on [page 204](#)).

"Heroic" Hero Points

In this mode, Heroes start with 1 point each session (and can have more, depending on a few factors like Perks/Flaws, what modules are used, and more). Additionally, Heroes have multiple ways to gain Hero Points (two that are player-controlled, and one that is Wild Die managed).

Characters acquire Hero Points from Complications ([page 27](#)), Troubles ([page 130](#)), and Assets ([page 131](#)). These Hero Points can be spent in several ways:

1. To double the Die Code of a single roll.
2. Reroll a failed roll without doubling down.
3. To avoid being Stunned in combat. Spend the Hero Point right when you would become stunned.

In essence, this option is the "Big Damn Heroes" option for Hero Points. Hero Points go a long way, they have a big cinematic impact, and they make a splash at the table.

For mechanical reasons, the game presumes this is the default option (when designing modules, we have to have a default we can work from, even if we have other optional modules that work instead, and it's easier to work down in complexity than up.).

There are optional rules for Hero Points that are carried between sessions (rather than refreshing every session). In this case, certain Perks/Flaws adjust a bit but work relatively the same.

“Basic” Hero Points

This module works with any of the Wild Die variants we include in the book (including the previously previewed one).

It also works with Troubles and Assets. In this mode, each Hero starts with 3-5 hero points (again, like above, subject to various modules), and can gain more.

- Hero Points are spent on a 1-for-1 basis to add a single die (which is not a wild die) to any roll. Any number of hero points can be spent on a roll.

This is simplest mode of using hero points. It’s deliberately designed to be useful and easy to teach, learn, and play with.

"Classic" Hero Points

This module is designed to work with the Experience Points module (on [page 86](#)) and the “Classic” Wild die module on [page 72](#).

Here, Hero Points are the same as experience points, so when we say Hero Point or experience point in this module, we mean them interchangeably. Hero Points carry over between sessions.

Whenever a result of 6 is rolled on the wild die, in addition to the normal effects in the “Classic” Wild Die module, the character gains an experience point (Hero Point).

- Hero points can be spent to add an additional wild die to a roll (on a one for one basis), up to a maximum of *the baseline attribute die* code used for *the roll*.
 - This means if you have an attribute die code of 2, you can spend up to two Hero Points to add two wild dice to the roll (for a total of three).
 - You may make this decision before or after the roll, but you must make it before the gamemaster tells you the result.
- Once spent this way, hero points cannot be spent to advance your character (they are lost).

Module: Environments

The environments module covers different types of dangerous environments heroes and characters might encounter.

When a character is in a dangerous environment every four hours, they must make a Stamina test against the difficulty as indicated by the environmental threat below. Failure means they suffer a penalty.

After about one day in a safe environment with remedial solutions (fire to remove cold, water or AC to remove heat, etc) the penalties from environmental harms go away. If you wish to heal or aid a character who is suffering from a negative environmental effect, the difficulty of the roll to remove the condition is the same as the difficulty made to resist the condition!

Cold

In cold environments, characters can go numb, fall asleep and die without proper protection! Characters who are wearing appropriate weather gear do not need to make tests for cold (unless their gear is damaged).

- **Moderate Cold - Difficulty 15:** The character suffers a -1D penalty on rolls they make until they have a chance to recover. They also move at half speed until they can recover.
- **Severe Cold — Difficulty 20:** The character suffers a -2D penalty on rolls they make until they have a chance to recover. If they become stunned while suffering from severe cold, they instead become wounded.
- **Deadly Cold — Difficulty 30:** The character becomes mortally wounded! The cold has really sapped them and they are at risk of dying without immediate care.

Drowning

When a character is submerged underwater without air for a good while, they might drown! A character can hold their breath for a number of action rounds equal to their Stamina die code, without any risk or penalty.

After that, each round they are underwater without fresh air, at the end of their turn, after all their actions are resolved, the character must make a Stamina roll against Difficulty 15. On a failure, they become incapacitated. As normally, another failure while incapacitated means they become mortally wounded. A third failure (naturally) causes them to die.

Heat

In hot environments, characters can go numb, fall asleep, and die without proper supplies. Having water, shelter, and garb to protect from the sun or other heat sources will go a long way towards keeping a character safe.

- **Moderate Heat - Difficulty 15:** The character suffers a -1D penalty on rolls they make until they have a chance to recover.
- **Severe Heat — Difficulty 20:** The character suffers a -2D penalty on rolls they make until they have a chance to recover. If they become stunned while suffering from severe heat, they instead become wounded.
- **Deadly Heat — Difficulty 30:** The character becomes mortally wounded! The heat has really sapped them and they are at risk of dying without immediate care.

Gas/Poisonous Air

Gas and poisonous air can be deadly, because it is often so difficult to detect. A gas mask, enviro-suit, or other tools go a long way towards solving the problem and providing appropriate protection against the unseen threats.

- **Moderate Danger - Difficulty 15:** The character suffers a -1D penalty on rolls they make until they have a chance to recover, and might suffer additional penalties as the gamemaster sees fit based on the circumstances.
- **Severe Danger — Difficulty 20:** The character becomes incapacitated.
- **Deadly Danger — Difficulty 30:** The character becomes mortally wounded.



Module: Equipment by Genre/Era

This module contains all the equipment tables for all the genres in this game. There are no costs included, as each campaign might have different rules and requirements - and if you combine modules, it gets even more complicated! We have to leave it to the gamemaster to determine how much things cost for players, though we recommend the Professional Skill rule we call out in the sidebar.

To that end, we've focused heavily on common equipment a character might need or want, as well as examples of gear that requires rules for special effects.

We realize that due to the modular nature of the game, there's lots of variables we're not considering in equipment. That's why we've kept a generalized list, and we expect players and gamemasters to use common sense in adjudication.

For example, we haven't marked that a shotgun takes two hands to use (maybe you want a troll to fire one in a science fiction game, and that might be reasonable).

However, in a pulp modern game, it's likely that the average character cannot fire a shotgun one-handed with any reasonable chance of hitting their target or avoiding self-inflicted injury.

When these situations arise, we expect you to use common sense, as well as the story and narrative you've already established (and want to establish) at your table.

The same idea goes for a tracking signal. We likely all know what they do. The gamemaster just has to determine any risks or drawbacks (what's the effective range? Can it be jammed?) and those are questions that depend on the campaign they are running. So we leave it to them to define and answer those.

Where we feel a call out is appropriate, we've included that.

It's possible (and likely) that in future products we might add additional content or expanded item lists and more details or rules around those items (especially our setting books).

The most common benefit of gear is a die code bonus to a skill. This means gear applies a +XD bonus to a various die code when tests are made. Many items will not specify a particular skill, as gear can apply to multiple skill die codes when used cleverly or even in standard circumstances. Most gear gives a +1D or +2D bonus (higher bonuses are the province of magic or super-science).

Alternatively, gear might lower difficulty numbers imposed by obstacles. When in doubt, the gamemaster makes the final decision.

PROFESSIONAL SKILL

If you don't want to assign costs to things, we recommend the concept of a Professional Skill. Have each character define a skill that represents their job or profession. When they want to buy something, have them test their Professional Skill against a difficulty (easy to find items have a lower difficulty).

If they are successful, they can acquire the item!

Medieval Gear

Candle or Lamp: If used as a weapon, a small, lit candle or lamp deals damage of 1D per round after the first when held in contact with a flammable surface for more than one round. Light can reduce the difficulty of tests made in the dark (by -5 or -10 depending on the gamemaster's decision).

Climbing Kit: Outfitted with spikes and climbing gloves, as well as pitons and more, a climbing kit grants +2D to attempts made to climb difficult terrain or obstacles.

Grappling Hook: When climbing, a grappling hook grants +1D bonus to climbing attempts. The grappling hook must be attached to a rope for this purpose. If used

as a weapon, a grappling hook can inflict Brawn Damage +1 in damage.

Healer's Pack: A small kit of soothing herbs and clean cloth strips adds a +1D bonus to medicine die codes. A healer's pack can only be used six times.

Lockpicking Tools: Lockpicks grant a +1D bonus to lockpicking attempts. Generally, lockpicking cannot be attempted without lockpicking tools.

Rope: Rope is a useful tool! It can be used to tie enemies or prisoners, climb walls (when paired with a grappling hook) or numerous other applications.

Torch: If used as a weapon, a torch deals damage of 3D per round after the first when held in contact with a flammable surface for more than one round. Light can reduce the difficulty of tests made in the dark (by -5 or -10 depending on the gamemaster's decision).

Magical Gear

Magical items generally give die bonuses of +3D or greater to skill or attribute die codes, though some might use (or grant as a benefit of their magic) various Perks or Talents (see [page 101](#)) if the gamemaster determines what is appropriate. The gamemaster can put conditions, requirements, or other rules to govern how magic items work.

Magical items generally give die bonuses of +3D or greater to skill or attribute die codes. Some might grant as a benefit of their magic various Perks or Talents (see [page 101](#)). The gamemaster can put conditions, requirements, or other rules to govern how magic items work.

We've included a limited group of samples to help inspire you.

Healing Potion: The character who drinks this potion removes the Wounded or Incapacitated condition from themselves.

Gem of Trueseeing: While tightly clutching this gem, character gains the infravision talent (see [page 218](#)).

Blessed Water: When splashed or thrown on undead or demonic foes, the blessed water does 5D damage!

Medieval Weapons & Armor

Armor	Armor Bonus
Hide/Fur	+1
Light leather	+2
Hardened Leather	+1D
Mail	+2D
Plate	+3D
Shield	*+1
Heavy Shield	*+2

An armor bonus applies to the Brawn roll made to resist damage (see [page 33](#)). Normally, armor does not stack, but if you have a shield, you may add its bonus to your normal armor bonus.

Our armor list is short and sweet and relatively generalized to keep things moving. We talk more about that in the weapons callout below, but the same theory and suggestions for modifications applies below.

Missile Weapon	Damage	Short Range	Medium Range	Long Range
Blowgun	1D	10	40	80
Crossbow, Light	4D	10	80	140
Crossbow, Heavy	5D	10	80	140
Longbow	4D	10	100	200
Shortbow	3D	10	100	200
Slingshot/Sling	Brawn+1D			

Thrown Weapon	Damage	Short Range	Medium Range	Long Range
Rocks	Brawn	Brawn	Brawn+2	Brawn+4
Darts	Brawn+1D	Brawn x2	Brawn x3	Brawn x4
Javelin	Brawn+2D	Brawn x2	Brawn x3	Brawn x4
Handaxe	Brawn+3D	Brawn	Brawn+1	Brawn+2
Throwing Dagger	Brawn+2D	Brawn+2	Brawn+3	Brawn+5

Range weapons have a Range which is measured in meters (so a ‘10’ in short range means that 10 meters, or 10 1” squares on a grid or hex map is short range).

Melee Weapon	Damage	Range*
Axe	+3D	1
Bullwhip	+2D	2
Club	+1D	
Club, Spiked	+2D	
Greatsword	+4D	2/Two-handed
Handaxe	+2D	Can be thrown (see above)
Halberd/Spear	+2D	2
Knife	+1D	Can be thrown (see above)
Longsword	+3D	
Quarterstaff	+2D	2/Two-handed
Shortsword	+2D	
Warhammer	+2D	

The list of melee weapons is a brief list of potential weapons. There are numerous variations, historical weapons, and nuance to delve into. While we could add ten different sorts of swords (for example), the stats would all be relatively the same when you are dealing with whole dice. If you are using the “Pips” module, adding a +1 or +2 to damage of various weapons can differentiate, but for our purposes, it’s easiest to treat an arming sword, katana, and rapier all as a “longsword” for the pulp gaming style that D6 System: Second Edition defaults to, even if the reality is more detailed.

*Some melee weapons can reach further than others. This is represented by a “range” that allows them to reach one additional meter (1” hex or square on a battlemat).

Modern Gear

Much of the fantasy gear above can be appropriate in a modern setting! Torches, lamps, climbing kits, and medical kits all work just fine. You might find that calling a medical kit a “first aid kit” will help with immersion, but the rules are the same.

Binoculars: Binoculars give a +1D bonus to sight-based rolls for viewing objects that are 3 or more meters away. Without modification, the bonus only applies in daylight.

Cold Weather Gear: Cold weather gear includes boots, gloves, hat, facemask, and a heavy jacket. It grants +1D to Stamina die codes to avoid harm or negative effects from cold weather (see [page 77](#)).

Crowbar: A crowbar grants a +1D bonus to prying attempts to open jammed or sealed doors. In combat, treat it as a club.

Flashlight: A flashlight can reduce the difficulty of tests made in the dark (by -5 or -10 depending on the gamemaster’s decision).

Gas mask: When worn appropriately, a gas mask provides a +2D bonus to stamina rolls against gas attacks or negates up to 1D in relevant modifiers.

Shovel: A shovel adds +1D to digging attempts. In combat, you can treat it like a club.

Telescope: Adds +2D to sight-based rolls for viewing objects that are 3 or more meters away. It takes two rounds to set up and focus a telescope.

Tool kits: A catch-all item for a variety of tasks, a tool kit adds +1D to relevant modifications, upgrades, repairs or construction attempts only if the user has the appropriate skill.

Walk-talkie/Radio/Headset: A catch-all item for communication devices, they generally can operate easily at 10 kilometers (though of course a cell phone can go much further). It allows someone to keep their hands free while talking or communicating.

Modern Weapons & Armor

Armor	Armor Bonus
Bulletproof Vest	+3D
Flak Jacket	+3D+1
Light Ballistic Armor	+2D+1
Heavy Ballistic Armor	+3D
Ceramic Armor	+3D+1
Riot Shield	*+2

An armor bonus applies to the Brawn roll made to resist damage (see [page 33](#)). Normally, armor does not stack, but if you have a shield, you may add its bonus to your normal armor bonus.

Modern armor is generally better than medieval armor. However, we recommend that you consider if you want to raise the difficulty of

acquiring the items, as well as social concerns. Remember, while the item might be better, local law enforcement will look oddly at some random individual in riot gear walking down the street.

Missile Weapon	Damage	Ammo	Short Range	Medium Range	Long Range
Revolver	5D	6	5	15	40
Semi-automatic	4D	8	10	25	40
Shotgun (12 gauge)	5D+1	2	5	20	40
Shotgun (20 gauge)	5D	4	5	30	60
Submachine gun	4D	8	10	40	80
Machine Gun	7D	12	100	250	500
Rifle	5D	10	25	50	200

Modern missile weapons introduce **ammo**, which represents how many times a weapon can be fired before an action to reload it has to be taken. Ammo doesn't represent the amount of bullets the firearm holds, but instead represents how many times it can be shot before the weapon has to be reloaded.

Remember, range weapons have a Range which is measured in meters (so a '10' in short range means that 10 meters, or 10 1" squares on a grid or hex map is short range).

Explosives	Damage	Short Range	Medium Range	Long Range
Grenade	5D	Brawn+2	Brawn+4	Brawn+6
Dynamite	6D	Brawn+1	Brawn+2	Brawn+6
Anti-tank Mine	10D*	Stationary	Stationary	Stationary

Explosives hit more than the initial target! That's the point of throwing a grenade after all. Anyone or anything within 3 meters of an explosive also suffers the damage.

When throwing weapons or explosives, use the value of the attribute to calculate the total distance you can throw. For example, a Brawn 2D character would treat a grenade's short range as "4" (2+2), the medium range as "6" (2+4), and the long range as "8" (2+6). If you are using pips, simply add those numbers to the final total. So 2D+1 would be "5" for short range, and so on.

*Additionally, the anti-tank mine must be set before it can be used (an action). Armor may not be used on Brawn rolls to resist damage from an anti-tank mine.

Melee Weapon	Damage
Brass Knuckles	+1D+1
Chainsaw	+4D
Icepick	+2
Garden Shears	+1D
Machete	+1D+2

In a modern setting, it's likely that a medieval weapon can be acquired (or stand in for a modern equivalent). We expect that a blackjack or tire iron can be used like a club, and so on.

*Some melee weapons can reach further than others. This is represented by a "range" that allows them to reach one additional meter (1" hex or square on a battlemat).

Science Fiction Gear

Much of the science fiction gear can be drawn from the modern or medieval lists. For example, a flashlight works the same in the science fiction genre and a walk-talkie can mechanically stand in for a comlink if you increase the range.

Enviro-suit: The basic survival suit of the space explorer, the enviro-suit features a sealed bodysuit and a helmet that provides clean air. It counts as having a gas mask (see above) while the helmet is worn, and grants +2D to Stamina tests made to avoid environmental conditions.

Handcomp: A small, portable computer with significant capabilities, the hand-comp often interfaces with starships, AI networks, or neural ports in the user. It is functionally a tool kit (+1D bonus) but its bonus can apply to any Knowledge skill die codes (and Technical or Mechanical as the gamemaster sees fit).

Science Fiction Weapons & Armor

Armor	Armor Bonus
Nanoleather	+1D
Nanomesh	+1D+2
EDA (Energy Dissipation Armor)	+2D
Synthweave Plasarmor	+3D
Heavy Synthweave	+4D

An armor bonus applies to the Brawn roll made to resist damage (see [page 33](#)). Normally, armor does not stack, but if you have a shield, you may add its bonus to your normal armor bonus.

Missile Weapon	Damage	Ammo	Short Range	Medium Range	Long Range
Blaster Pocketgun	3D	6	4	8	12
Blaster Pistol	5D	12	50	50	150
Blaster Rifle	7D	30	150	150	300
Energy Pistol	5D	20	25	25	40
Energy Rifle	5D	50	150	150	300
Laser Pistol	4D	15	90	90	180
Laser Rifle	5D	20	125	125	250

What’s the different between a blaster, energy, and laser pistol? Well, nothing other than the rules here.

Mechanically, blasters are standardized and common, with better range than energy weapons. Energy weapons are more consistent, but have less damage and range, but greater ammo capacity. Laser weapons have the best range, but fall between blasters and energy weapons in terms of ammo.

How you want that difference to play out in your game is up to you.

Science fiction weapons also use ammo, which represents how many times a weapon can be fired before an action to reload it has to be taken. Ammo doesn't represent the amount of energy bolts, beams, or charges the firearm holds, but instead represents how many times it can be shot before the weapon has to be reloaded.

Remember, range weapons have a Range which is measured in meters (so a '10' in short range means that 10 meters, or 10 1" squares on a grid or hex map is short range).

Melee Weapon	Damage	Range*
Energized Longblade	+4D	
Nanoknife	+2D	Can be thrown (like throwing knife)
Shockbaton	+2D	Stun

*Some melee weapons can reach further than others. This is represented by a "range" that allows them to reach one additional meter (1" hex or square on a battlemat).

Weapon Options & Modifications

Shock/Stun: Some weapons can shock or stun their targets. When a shock weapon or a stun weapon hits its target, if the target would be staggered by the attack, they are stunned instead. Stun/shock weapons can never inflict a damage level greater than incapacitated (unless they are illegally modified).

Unwieldy Weapons: You can apply a -1D penalty to attacks made with two-handed weapons if you want to represent how top-heavy and unwieldy they are.

Module: Experience Points

This module adds *experience points* to the game. Experience points are a benchmark that characters can use to move forward and improve their abilities as they play the game.

Granting Experience Points

Generally speaking, each session (2-4 hours of play) should reward a certain number of experience points. Assigning experience points is a bit more of an art form than a science, but we've included the two options for you to choose from: session rewards and ad hoc rewards.

Session Rewards

In session rewards, everyone gets a certain amount of experience points for showing up and participating. These numbers are designed to be baselines, see the examples below. We've marked out a slow, moderate, and fast rate of advancement.

As the gamemaster, you should consider rewarding additional points as you see fit, based on the difficulty of the adventure, how long you played, and any other factors you want to consider.

If you are using the "Classic" Hero Points module ([page 76](#)), add +3 to the speed you choose to use for assigning experience points as they'll also be spent on rolls.

- **Slow Advancement:** 2-3 per session.
- **Moderate Advancement:** 4-6 per session.
- **Fast Advancement:** 7-10 per session.

Ad Hoc Experience Point Guidelines

Previous D6 System games used a formula based on the individual challenges of a session. While that can be a lot to calculate in advance, some gamemasters enjoy that! Below, you will find those rules included. If you use this, do not use the Session Rewards.

- Obstacle was easy to overcome (the difficulty numbers were about three times the die code in the skills required): No reward.
- Obstacle was somewhat difficult to overcome (the difficulty numbers were about three to four times the die code in the skills required): 1 experience point per low-difficulty obstacle in the adventure.
- Obstacle was quite challenging to overcome (the difficulty numbers were about five times the die code in the skills required; generally reserved for the climactic scene): 2 or more experience points per high-difficulty obstacle in the adventure.
- Individual roleplaying (overcoming goals and playing in character): 2 to 3 experience points (awarded to each character, not to the whole group).
- Group roleplaying (teamwork and interacting with each other in character): 3 to 4 experience points.
- Everybody had fun (including the gamemaster): 1 to 2 experience points.

If you are using the "Classic" Hero Points module ([page 76](#)), add +3 or so at the end. These should loosely make up for spent experience points made to modify rolls.

Using Experience Points

Improving your character costs experience points. Based on what you are improving, there are varied costs.

- The cost of improving a skill is equal to the current number of the skill (in experience points). The minimum cost is always 1 experience point.
 - If you are using the **Pips** module, you have to purchase the pips (+1 and then +2) before you can move onto the next die. The cost is the same as increasing the skill. You just have to buy the pips first.
 - If you are using the **Pips** module, you discount the current pips on that skill (+1 or +2) from the total cost spent to get a new die (not pips).
- The cost of improving an attribute is ten times the current number of the attribute.
 - If you are using the **Pips** module, you must buy the +1 and +2 first. The cost is the same as increasing the attribute. You just have to buy the pips first.
 - If you are using the **Pips** module, you discount the current pips on that attributes (+1 or +2) from the total cost spent to get a new die (not pips).

CAPS ON ATTRIBUTES & SKILLS

It's important to note that all these combinations (pips, experience points, and more) can create characters that have very high attributes. Some gamemasters prefer to cap total die codes.

You can see the superheroic modules ([page 204](#)) for discussion on die code caps, and how you might integrate those rules if you feel like die codes are getting out of hand.

Module: Hyper-lethal Combat

This module adds two options to increase the lethality in your combat (and inversely, turn it down). D6 System: Second Edition is inherently cinematic, which means characters have a very pulpy ability to resist and avoid damage.

If you use this module, we do recommend using at least one hero points module, as that will allow characters to have an option to control their fate and have some survivability.

The core mechanics (on [page 33](#)) are great for that pulpy damage feel, but if you want to go with a more lethal style of damage, here are some options (which you can combine as you see fit):



Removing Stunned

If you remove the Stunned condition from the normal damage (see [page 33](#)) and make the first level “wounded,” you’ve already increased the lethality!

Removing Wounded

If you remove the Wounded condition from the normal damage (see [page 33](#)) and make the first level “Stunned” and the next level “Mortally Wounded,” you’ve also increased the lethality!

You can combine removing stunned and wounded to only have mortally wounded (which would be an exceptionally lethal game)!

If you want less lethality, you can add additional wounded levels which characters can suffer before becoming incapacitated or mortally wounded.

Killing Blows

An attack or series of attacks can cause enough injury that the target may never recover from the harm! We call this a killing blow, as it takes the target right out of the game forever.

If the Brawn roll made to resist damage totals less than half the damage roll total, the target receives a killing blow. When the target receives a killing blow, they immediately die.

- If you are using a hero point module, allow the target to spend a hero point to survive!

BODY POINTS & WOUNDS

Previous D6 System games featured Body Points and wounds. Those slot in easily enough to D6 System: Second Edition, though you will need to adjust the Attribute names and how they link.

Maximum Armor Rule

If you find characters are too durable when confronted by damage, you can always put a cap of 6D on their Brawn+Armor rolls to avoid damage. This will inherently increase the lethality.

Module: Milestone Character Advancement

Milestone advancement is (in many ways) a common default of gamemasters in a variety of roleplaying games! Milestone advancement features set benchmarks in the campaign, that when met grant the players additional abilities and chances to improve and increase their characters.

Setting Milestones

As the gamemaster, you have two ways you can set milestones: by campaign events (a particular set of accomplished tasks) or by sessions played. Both have advantages and drawbacks.

When you use the sessions played method, it is easier to track, and it allows flexibility in awarding milestones (you don't have to worry about if the story derails, or the players take off on a different direction they find interesting). But the inverse is true. Your players might go slow and gain more power than you expected when they reach the ultimate showdown! You'll have to keep an eye on it.

- If you are using the sessions played method, we recommend rewarding a milestone every 2-4 sessions.

If you use the campaign events method, you'll set particular story events you want to happen. This is a great method as it allows the players to see rewards happen as they pursue the overarching campaign narrative. However, it can at times feel like the players are being funneled or railroaded and do not have room to explore, and they might feel constrained!

- If you are using the campaign events method, we recommend setting a milestone every 3 sessions or so.

There's no right answer, as each gamemaster will have to find the right solution for their table and group.

Reaching Milestones

Every time a milestone is reached, each player should gain the following:

- +1 attribute die to increase an attribute with.
- +3 skill dice to increase skills with.
 - If you are using the Pips module, instead of skill dice, the player gains +9 pips to increase skills with. Remember, pips never go higher than +2 and a +3 instead grants an additional +1D to the die code (so you can functionally turn +9 pips into +3D between three skills).
- A player can forgo their attribute and skill dice to gain a new Perk (at R1) if you are using the Perks, Talents, and Flaws module (see [page 103](#)).
 - If a player already has a Perk, they can instead forgo their attribute and skill dice to increase that Perk by one rank.

Gamemasters who are concerned about characters advancing too quickly or becoming too powerful can consult the Capping Die Codes module on [page 208](#) for some suggestions about how that can be managed!

Module: Narrative Advancement

In order to promote player involvement in the ongoing narrative, characters can have arcs. An arc is an individual story your character attempts to fulfill. When you choose an arc, you should work with the GM and other players to ensure your arcs work together narratively, but arcs should not be identical.

Each arc is a series of narrative steps and goals your character must fulfill, but at the end of the arc, they gain an increase to an attribute or skill. The steps and arc must tie logically into the attribute or skill that is being improved by the arc.

When you craft an arc, it needs to have one more step than the skill being increased.

For example, if my paladin sword master wants to improve his Melee Skill, which is currently a 4D rating, he would need to create a five step arc focused around his sword skills. The arc might look like this:

- I must acquire a new sword from the Divine Blacksmith Zoka Tu'Vath.
- I must then travel to the city of Dragon's Roost to acquire a book on ancient knightly sword techniques from a master of my Paladin Order.
- Then, I must return home and practice in quiet meditation and contemplation.
- After that, I must defeat three foes in combat, solely by myself.
- Then, finally, I must defeat a superior martial combatant in single combat (someone with a higher Melee skill than myself).

After all these events have unfolded in the campaign, my paladin would then increase his Melee skill to 5D.

To create your arc, you do the following:

- Choose your reward (what skill you get an increase for when you complete the arc).
 - We recommend arcs remain tied to skills, rather than attributes.
- Generate the Steps of the Arc
 - The Arc will have a number of steps equal to the new Skill rating.
- Get approval from the gamemaster for the arc.
- Try to accomplish those steps during play!
 - Remember, gaming is a team effort, so try to write an arc that can be done parallel with the ongoing campaign and what others are doing.

If you are using Perks, Flaws, and Talents, we recommend that a Perk be gained by a number of steps equal to the Rank of the Perk (see [Module: Perks, Flaws & Talents](#)) on [page 103](#).

Narrative arcs generally shouldn't be used for Flaws and Talents.

Using Arcs

Utilizing arcs can be complicated, and often times feel like they create lots of little threads that run against the grain of your campaign. When you're assisting players in crafting arcs, proactively work with them to meld the steps of their arcs into the ongoing narrative. It's okay to communicate what your plans are in advance without giving much away in order to allow a character to prepare their arc and the steps as best they can.

The majority of arcs shouldn't be side stories but having a piece or two happen off screen can be great.

In our example above, if the swordmaster's player can't make it to a session one night, perhaps their character can head off to a distant location off screen, thereby advancing the character's arc, and moving their personal story forward, even though the character is not present in the ongoing narrative for that session.

The most important thing to know about being a gamemaster is that character sheets are a tool the players use to communicate the sort of stories they want to the GM.

When a player chooses their arc, their skills, and their abilities, they are telling you the kind of game they want to play, and as the GM, it's your job to put the pieces together. A character with a high Melee skill wants to get into personal combat. It's exciting and they're telling you that by selecting that skill and raising it high.

When in doubt, refer to the character sheets and communicate with your players openly to learn their feelings on the game and how the campaign is going! Secrets don't help someone tell a story, so be open, communicative, and responsive. You're all in it to have fun together.



Module: No Dodge Defense

This module replaces the Dodge defense from the core rules. If you use this module, characters have no Dodge defense. They still have a Parry defense.

D62e uses the concept of Dodge and Parry to provide character specific difficulties when making attacks. This allows for characters to have benefits based on their Attributes.

However, previous D6 games have used standardized difficulties for ranged attacks. If you want to replicate that, you can use the optional difficulties for ranged attack in place of Dodge below:

- **Difficulty 5:** firing a ranged weapon at point blank range (against a target in melee with you).
- **Difficulty 10:** firing a ranged weapon at short range.
- **Difficulty 15:** firing a ranged weapon at medium range.
- **Difficulty 20:** firing a ranged weapon at long range.
- **Difficulty 30:** firing a ranged weapon at long range at someone dodging.

Module: Pips

The core game we present here does not use Dice Modifiers like many classic West End Games D6 games. However, those are easy to add into your game, using this module!

We call these modifiers “pips.” A pip is an added bonus to the total result that came up on the dice. A “+1” means one is added to the total, while “+2” means two is added. Pips are almost universally a bonus (+X), but sometimes a penalty (-Y) can occur (this core rulebook does not present -Y penalties for pips, though expansions might).

Pips are always locked in at one of two values: +1 or +2.

Anytime you’d get +3 in a pip, you instead add +1D to the code you are rolling (any value past +3 is simply treated as a +3, and therefore +1D).

Pips During Character Creation

Pips are assigned to skills or attributes, and the die split must be from the pool that the pips are being assigned to (attribute die split into attribute pips, skill die split into skill pips).

You can split your attribute dice, creating **modifiers** that allow you to add numerical bonuses to your attributes. One die can be split into three '+1' modifiers or a '+2' and a '+1' modifier. You append these modifiers to the attributes (and thus the die code).

You can also **split** your skill dice, creating **modifiers** that allow you to add numerical bonuses to your stats. One die can be split into three '+1' modifiers or a '+2' and a '+1' modifier. You may append these modifiers to skills, but a skill can never have a modifier of +3. If it would, you simply increase the die by +1 (so 2D+2 would become 3D, rather than 2D+3).

You can only split 2D into modifiers during character creation.

Note: Your GM might decide to run the game without modifiers, in which case, you can't split skill dice. Make sure you confirm with your GM that they're using modifiers before you split your dice.

It's important to note that no matter how many pips a skill die code (attribute + skill) has, it can never have more than +2 pips. If you would have a total dice modifier of +3 or higher, just add an additional die to the die code. This means that having a +2 to an attribute would render any pips on skills associated with that attribute limited in effect (as any +1 would make it a die increase, rather than a +3 total).

Pips & Advancement

If you are using pips, it modifies how advancement works. Below are the two call outs for experience points and milestones

Pips & Experience Points

If you are using the Experience Points module, please see [page 86](#) for how pips impact that.

Pips & Milestone Character Advancement

If you are using the Milestone Character Advancement module, please see [page 90](#) for how pips impact that.

Module: Skill Specialization & Advanced Skills

The following module adds more granular skills through rules for advanced skills (skills that are harder to learn) as well as specializations (focused and narrow areas of expertise inside skills).

Both of these modules can be used together and with any skill modules or other modules, though they are not included in any of the prebuilt templates in this game.

Due to the modular nature of the game, as well as the multi-genre toolkit approach of this book, we've avoided defining loads of advanced skills and specializations. Those will be the work of the gamemaster and players who are playing the game.

We have included examples and suggestions for you though, on [page 98](#) (tied to a more generalized approach). You can use those or adjust them to fit your game.

Advanced Skills

Advanced skills represent very advanced and specialized areas of knowledge that characters cannot attempt unskilled.

These types of skills might be advanced engineering or technical abilities, deep and research heavy magical lore, or other elements. In effect, they are things that characters can't do without appropriate training. These skills require years and years of disciplined study to master.

Advanced skills are “locked” due to their rare and specialized knowledge. Unlike regular skills, if you do not have dice in an advanced skill, you cannot test it.

Advanced skills are tied to two or more prerequisite skills (for example: surgery might be an advanced skill of medicine and sciences). Whenever you use the basic skill tied to the advanced skill, you add your advanced skill rating as a bonus to the total skill die code.

Advanced skills do not benefit from attributes in their die codes, relying only on the number of dice the advanced skill has (when rolled alone, the advanced skill die code is effectively the skill only – a normal departure from skill die codes being attribute + skill).

- For example, let's presume surgery is an advanced skill of medicine and sciences. If you have 3D in medicine, 2D in surgery, and 3D in knowledge, you would roll 8 dice for basic medicine rolls.
- In the same instance, if you had to make a surgery specific roll (perhaps a heightened situation beyond the confines of basic medical knowledge where only your knowledge of surgery benefits you), you'd roll 2 dice.

You may never have more dice in an advanced skill than the lowest rating in a prerequisite skill. The minimum required rating in a prerequisite skill is always 3 (meaning you must have a 3 rating in any prerequisite skills the advanced skill lists).

Starting With Advanced Skills

We recommend that advanced skills be avoided during character creation, but if you want to add one, you can use up to two of your skill dice for advanced skills, presuming you meet any prerequisites.

You can indicate an advanced skill how you wish on the character sheet. We recommend an (A) or (*) behind the skill (the A works best if you're using specializations).

Advancing and Acquiring Advanced Skills

To acquire an advanced skill, it takes twice as much effort as a regular skill, due to the high focus and uniqueness.

- If you are using the **experience point module** ([page 86](#)), this means it costs twice as many experience points as a regular skill will.
- If you are using the **milestone advancement module** ([page 90](#)), this means it takes twice as many milestones to advance that skill.

To be absolutely clear: if you do not have an advanced skill, you cannot make a check related to it. These skills should be purely the domain of those who've put the time in to develop them. As the gamemaster, that means you should be careful to include them (so players who have them can leverage the skills they put effort into), but not lock important story points or forward momentum behind them if no one has the skill!

It's a balancing act, but with practice, the pace of how to use advanced skills will become natural.

Defining Advanced Skills

Advanced skills represent areas of intense dedication, skills that can take a lifetime of practice and expertise to learn. They are truly difficult challenges, ones that luck or raw talent cannot accomplish.

As the gamemaster, you will need to define the advanced skills your game is using. Any advanced skills should be used to improve and enhance the setting you are playing in, as well as give characters a chance to distinguish and set themselves apart. There are nearly infinite options, and advanced skills are a perfect tool to showcase what makes the world you are playing in unique.

We've included a few examples below to illustrate what we mean or how it might be used. Published settings will include any advanced skills they use.

Example Advanced Skills

- Interstellar Navigation: Mechanical Skill Module, suitable for the Science fiction module.
- Nuclear Engineering: Knowledge in the Core Rules, or Technical in the Technical Skill Module.
- Necromancy (or other schools of magic): The Magic skill module (as well as Freeform Magic, under Fantasy on [page 140](#)).

Skill Specializations

Characters can choose to specialize in a skill, which means they know a great deal more about one very specific aspect of a certain skill. Specializations are ideal when a character is going to be using the same type of tool, weapon, or solution to overcome obstacles over and over again.

Specializations are suitable for a narrow focus of a skill, something that is an extension of the normal use of the skill. Unlike an advanced skill (which requires dedicated training and education to use), a specialization can come with practice and is a natural offshoot of using that skill.

For example: using Sciences would not lead one to understand how to be a Nuclear Engineer (though maybe some basic theory), no matter how much science you apply. You exclusively learn nuclear engineering by going through specific training and educational processes.

Alternatively, it's conceivable that a character who simply practices their acrobatics enough could learn parkour by trial and error.

This is not to say one can't be trained in a specialization, but that a specialization is a more limited expression of a skill that is evolved from both practice, experience, and perhaps training.

Of course. if you are only using specializations or advanced skills, the difference is irrelevant in your game!

They also work well for characters who want to utilize only a small part of a skill's domain. Specializations give characters a quick edge, but they aren't nearly as diverse as the basic skill that they are based upon, and can therefore be less useful.

Acquiring Skill Specializations

- You may choose to spend one skill dice for specialized skills, but it is suggested you pick your "normal" skills first.
- Then pick three skill specializations and write them near the skill on the character sheet noting them with an "S" for specialization.
- You want to clearly note the governing skill for the specialization.
- Attributes never have specializations.
 - If you are using Advanced Skill, advanced skills are already focused, and therefore do not have specializations.
- Specializations do not advance or increase when the base skill does (remaining at a +1D bonus) and they cannot be increased past +1D (as a total bonus).

After character creation, a character can acquire a specialization for a skill.

- If you are using the experience point module ([page 86](#)), a specialization costs a number of XP equal to the rating of the skill, plus the current number of specializations that skill has.
 - Adding a new specialization to a skill with a rating of 2 and one specializations would cost 3 experience points (2+1).
 - Skills may never have more specializations than they have rating. For example, a skill rating of 2 means you can have up to two specializations for that skill. A skill rating of 3 would be three specializations, and so on.
- If you are using the milestone advancement module ([page 90](#)), it takes three milestones to add a specialization to a skill.
 - Skills may never have more specializations than they have rating. For example, a skill rating of 2 means you can have up to two specializations for that skill. A skill rating of 3 would be three specializations, and so on.

Using & Defining Specializations

When you have a specialization in a skill and the task at hand relates to the specialization, the character adds +1D to the die code they are rolling!

Example Specializations

The gamemaster will define the specializations available (or a player might suggest options that fit their character). Below are some basic examples (though in no way are specializations limited to these).

- Acrobatics: Parkour, Gymnastics
- Shooting: Pistols, Rifles, Bows
- Melee: Sword, Martial Arts
- Sleight of Hand: Lockpicking, Card Tricks/Illusions
- Athletics: Climbing, Power-lifting
- Intimidation: Interrogation
- Stamina: Holding Breath, Endurance
- Throwing: Throwing Daggers, Spears
- Languages: Thieves' Cant, Slang
- Medicine: First Aid, Poisons
- Scholar: Specific fields of Study are all appropriate here.
- Sciences: Specific fields of Study are all appropriate here.
- Driving: Vehicle Types (Car, Cycle), Environment (Urban, Off-Road)
- Investigation: Crime Scene, Interrogation
- Stealth: Hiding, Shadowing
- Survival: Environment (Cold, Desert), Foraging, Shelter

Module: Perks, Flaws & Talents

This module is designed to give detailed options that allow you to create or customize characters outside of just attributes and skills. Additionally, these rules can be used to create alternative origins, heritages, archetypes, or ancestral backgrounds for characters to enjoy (by baking them into templates, using the rules below).

In previous editions of D6 System, there were rules like “Advantages,” “Disadvantages,” and “Special Abilities.” In order to streamline communication, as well as prep for future releases, we’ve chosen to rename and update those rules in this module to Perks, Flaws, and Talents.

The words Advantage and Disadvantage often mean different things in the modern world of tabletop roleplaying games and we want to communicate efficiently to new fans of D6 System gaming who might have previous experiences.

Perks are special benefits that the character has because of their status, profession, knowledge, the people they know, or something in her background. They generally do not directly affect attributes or skills, but instead provide an additional tool in the character’s toolbox.

Flaws hamper the character in some way. They might affect attributes or skills or they might mean trouble for the character in certain situations. Both Perks & Flaws make the character more rounded and more believable.

Talents are those abilities that exceed the usual or natural capabilities of a Human character. The character’s species, some sort of unique training, or a magical/miraculous/other effect might explain their origin. They give the character a bonus to attributes or skills, or they provide access to something that the average character can’t do.

If you want to create non-human templates for a particular genre (aliens for Science fiction or Superheroes, fantasy cultures and people for the Fantasy module), the Talents option is the best way to do so!

Perks, Flaws, and Talents all have a measurement called ranks, which defines how significant and impactful they are. Think of ranks as a scale. A lower rank is a less significant impact on the game, and a higher rank is a more significant impact.

Perks and Flaws can scale (having multiple levels they can be acquired at) and thus have a multitude of costs (and rewards) for taking them.

Talents tend to have a singular cost and these costs often are not changeable, nor can you take a talent more than once without gamemaster permission (unless the talent explicitly notes so).

Ranks are communicated as R#, with the number indicating the rank.

Starting with Perks, Flaws, and Talents

Below are the costs for perks, flaws, and talents during character creation.

- Perks cost one skill die (during character creation) per rank of the perk.
 - At character creation an R3 perk costs 3 skill dice.
- Flaws grant one skill die back to your character creation, per rank of the flaw.
 - At character creation an R3 perk grants 3 skill dice back.
- Talents cost a number of skill dice as indicated by the talent (written as “Talent Name (X)”). Some talents have ranks and can be purchased multiple times at the cost indicated. If a talent does not explicitly say it has ranks, you may only purchase it once.

While the game doesn’t inherently impose a limit on flaws and perks, we recommend that characters have no more than 5 points of flaws and 5 points of perks. Of course, each gamemaster should make their own ruling on this matter!

However, the more perks and flaws a character can take, the more unwieldy (or inordinately powerful) they can become through lots of little rules interactions. We’ve done our best to minimize those interactions, but the modular nature of the game make true parity difficult and we acknowledge that!

Acquiring Perks, Flaws, and Talents

After character creation, perks, flaws, and talents are acquired narratively, at the discretion of the gamemaster. The gamemaster might impose the same cost in skill dice (depending on the advancement module used), or simply award them based on how the narrative of the campaign unfolds.

If a character wants to acquire a perk, flaw, or talent, the player should communicate with the gamemaster and work up a plan to do so!

Perks

Authority (R1-R3)

The character has some measure of legal, cultural, social, or religious influence and power over others in the region. The scope of the character's rank, duties, and power in the local jurisdiction or community are defined by the rank in this perk. An Authority (R1) Perk might belong to someone who, because of circumstance, does not have a lot of opportunity to use their authority or someone who is very low in rank.

Generally, the character should indicate the scope of their authority, such as "Authority: Local Faith" or "Authority: City Government," and so on. A common version of this perk is Law Enforcement, which gives adventurers some measure of abilities associated with being a deputized agent of the law. Authority: Law Enforcement (R1) means the character has limited authority to enforce the law on a single city, region, planet, or area.

At R2, the character has more influence, possibly commanding a small number of troops or being in charge of a small company or town. With Authority: Law Enforcement (R2), the character is actually a law enforcement officer and is allowed to make full arrests and reasonable search and seizure.

At R3 the character has a great deal of power and influence. The head of a large company or someone whose authority is simply never questioned would have this Perk. With Authority: Law Enforcement (R3), the character may enforce the law across a wider spread (national jurisdiction in a fantasy or modern game or planetary systems in science fiction).

Characters like private investigators, bounty hunters, and bail bondsmen would need this Perk.

Restrictions/Notes: It is not necessary to have the Authority: Law Enforcement Perk to own a particular weapons (depending on setting) that allow ordinary citizens to own them. However, if owning that weapon is illegal in that setting, or the equipment (even if it isn't a weapon) is limited to deputized officials, then this version of the Perk would be necessary.

Remember, too, that outside of the character's jurisdiction or permit limits, this Perk may have little or no value.

Contacts (R1-R4)

The character “knows somebody” or a group of somebodies who will generally help out the character if they make a decent appeal or sufficiently compensates the contact. This level of contact only sticks around for a limited amount of time (part of an adventure or maybe throughout a short adventure).

The character might know a “group” with a wider range of influence (but less power) that will help out, again, for a modest fee or under the right circumstances. The influence might not be as direct, but it is easier to come by. For example, there might be clubs or organizations that provide certain services for travelers — navigation coordinates to common systems, accommodation reservations, emergency transportation, and so on — for a small membership fee. You have to call them or go to their offices, and they won’t do much about that maniac with the blaster who is chasing you, but they can be of immense help under the right circumstances.

Contacts (R2) is identical to Contacts (R1), except the contact is more powerful, more influential, easier to get hold of, willing to do more favors, or affects the game on a larger scale.

If the contact is supposed to be a large group, it now has much greater influence over a wider area. For instance, instead of belonging to a travel club, the character might have a government agency to help them out occasionally.



Contacts (R3) is nearly supernormal, supernatural, or uncanny in origin or far reaching in scope. For example, a character's Contact (R3) might be an "adventurer's guild" with multi-system branch guildhalls and an impressive ability to get its members the oddest things. Work with the gamemaster to come up with some interesting contacts. It might be a group of psionic monks who can be called upon for "mental aid" — or maybe a really complete technical stellar library. It might be a superhero league or organization, a shadowy government ops department, or more.

Contacts (R4) is at a different level and scope. There is some sort of strange "force" that "watches over" and occasionally helps the character in a guardian angel fashion (though usually with insight, equipment, or information rather than direct action). In many ways, this Perk is not as useful in most adventure situations as the other versions of Contacts, but it can have dramatic effects on occasion.

Some examples of this include a particularly powerful gamemaster character who steps in occasionally to help the character when he's in trouble. Or, a large governmental agency might, for some reason, want to step in and aid the character at times.

Generally, the character can get minor assistance — as could be gotten from Contacts (R1) or Contacts (R2) — on a fairly regular basis — and under the same sort of circumstances as having lower versions of Contacts — but "the big stuff" only happens when the gamemaster thinks it appropriate. The character might get killed before the Contacts (R4) intervenes — maybe the character just wasn't doing something the Contact felt was important to it — but, most likely, assistance comes, though perhaps at the last minute.

Restrictions/Notes: players' characters should take the R4 option only if they want to take Flaws relating to it. For example, if a character in a space opera campaign wants to have a group of super-scientists who like the character and will supply them with substantial aid on a regular basis (like a space ranger who gets outfitted with new equipment at the beginning of every adventure and who can call for more during certain times in the adventure), then they should take Flaws that relate to that. The character could be a member of an organization (see the Flaw Employed), or they must do reciprocating favors for the providing company (see the Flaw Price), or there are equally powerful people who want to eliminate the character because of their contacts (see the Flaw Enemy).

If the character does not want to take extensive Flaws relating to the contact, then Contacts (R4) should be unpredictable and not always useful. For example, the company might provide the character with plenty of extraordinary equipment, but it might not always be what the character needs or might not work correctly all of the time.

Contacts should not automatically help the character, but they should be reasonable in their negotiations. Multiple contacts of various ranks may be selected and they may be stacked. For example, a certain person might be a Contact (R1) in most circumstances, but they could be a Contact (R2) or even a Contact (R3) in the right place — for example, a mercenary might help out for a fee versus normal foes, but when fighting their “hereditary enemies,” they might be almost invincible and eager to help.

Remember that contacts are gamemaster characters. They should be created and played rationally. A character who abuses or treats contacts poorly will find those contacts unwilling to aid or help. There should also be a reason in the character’s story why they have these contacts.

Equipment (R1-R4)

The character gains a piece of equipment they would not normally have because it is too expensive or “unavailable,” but only if it is allowable under the game setting. For instance, in a science fiction world, a character could start the game with a small laser pistol, but not a rare alien disintegration beam pistol. As the alien relic is quite powerful, it should be generally unavailable for civilian use and even characters with Authority or Patrons should have to take the Equipment (R2) or (R3) Perk to get it.

The same rationale applies for magic items in fantasy games, rare or unique cybernetics in science fiction, and others. The equipment perk is very flexible and will require a gamemaster to consider how it might impact the game and narrative that unfolds.

Alternatively, the character could take lots of little pieces of equipment instead — more than what the gamemaster would normally allow.

The higher the rank of this perk, the more really bizarre and, most likely, powerful equipment is open to the character — but only one such piece or a collection of small, related pieces. For very powerful items, no one else can use the equipment without making some sort of exhaustive skill total, and it can probably not be repaired or duplicated. “Special effects” equipment fits into this category.

The equipment could be a weapon more powerful than most personal weapons in the game setting. Or it could be a magical manipulation that could not normally be used by the character or anyone else in the world at its relatively low difficulty. Or it could be a collection of gadgets and gizmos that can perform many different mundane tasks — but how, nobody knows.

Restrictions/Notes: Typically, as long as the character is not careless with it, Equipment taken with any rank of this Perk is replaceable, unless the Burnout Flaw is included with it. Equipment (R1) may be selected more than once or in combination with higher ranks of the Equipment Perk with gamemaster approval.



The gamemaster should watch this Perk carefully. R3 and R4 can only be selected once at character creation — though the Rank 1 and Rank 2 versions can also be selected — but it can still unbalance a beginning character. Generally, things that can be taken away fairly easily or require an additional trigger to use — like energy swords, magical artifacts, cutting-edge military hardware, super-science gadgets, and other similar equipment — would be suitably appropriate for characters with minimal experience.

At R4 the character should have Flaw related to the equipment. Maybe Enemies want to steal it, or it has a Flaw so it doesn't work all the time — or the same way every time. In addition, the equipment should not make the character so powerful that opponents fall before them. In game mechanic terms, the equipment should be a just slightly more powerful or more useful item than what is available normally. The more powerful the item, the more Flaws and restrictions should be related to it.

For superhero characters, Equipment works well to cover a variety of options (R1 makes for an excellent utility belt, for example). You can find examples of how the Equipment Perk can play into Gadgets and Gear on [page 227](#).

Fame (R1-R3)

The character, for some reason, is fairly well known. The extent of the character's fame should be determined by the game setting.

In a global game setting, the character has moderate recognition value in a particular region.

In a smaller game setting (post-apocalyptic community or fantasy city), the character might have more dense penetration of recognition, but with less wide-sweeping effects (for instance, everyone in town knows who they are, but no one from more than a few days' travel away has ever heard of them).

Whenever the gamemaster thinks the character might be recognized (and the Fame Perk would come into play), the gamemaster should roll $3D+R$ (the character's rank in Fame). If the result is 15 or higher, the character is recognized. Otherwise, they will have to do something "special" and appropriate for why he's famous to be recognized (and gain the benefits of recognition).

If a character with Fame (R1) is recognized, they should gain small perks, like being seated in a restaurant early, avoiding small legal hassles (like routine customs checks), or just be treated generally better (perhaps a +1D bonus on some social die codes).

Like most roleplayed Perks, the gamemaster should decide on the results.

At R2, the character is very well known. In a single world setting, the character would probably be recognized in most fairly civilized cultures and almost definitely in their homeland or culture. The gamemaster should roll $3D+R$ and, on a 15 or higher, a person from another culture recognizes the person and react (usually favorably). In the character's own culture or homeland, this reaction comes on an 8 or more.

If the character draws attention to themselves in their own culture (identifies herself), then the reaction will most likely be automatic (gamemaster's option).

At R3, there is a pretty good chance anyone in the game setting (unless it is a multi-world setting) will recognize the character (or what the character is) fairly easily. The base die total needed is 8, and it can be modified by circumstance. The character has the status of a famous hero or adventurer, feared investigator or authority figure, holo-vid star, a famous politician, or a top-ranked sports hero.

Restrictions/Notes: Fame may be chosen multiple times as long as the player defines how each Fame is different. For example, a character might have Fame (R1) in regards to their fighting abilities, but another type of Fame pertaining to their intelligence or some other ability.

Keep in mind that some gamemaster characters will be immune to Fame, but most will have some sort of (generally positive) reaction.

Patron (R1-R3)

The odds are that most players' characters are not independently wealthy. But they might have access to wealth in the form of patrons! If the characters are adventurers or treasure hunters, patrons might include museums, universities, private philanthropists, news agencies, megacorporations, or even retired adventurers.

Patron (R1) means the character has a backer who will fund one expedition, adventure, or excursion, with all proceeds going to the patron. All of the costs (room, board, travel, expenses) are covered by the patron, with the understanding that the player's character is basically just a worker-for-hire. Anything that the adventurer discovers or purchases becomes the property of the patron.

A Patron (R2) expects much less from those they back. Though the character may receive less financial support, they gain a greater freedom of action. A news agency looking for hot stories is a common example of an organization qualifying for Patron (R2). They cover a character's travel expenses and any legal fees in exchange for inspiring stories. Anything that the character finds on their own (like artifacts) remain their own.

A Patron (R3) gives a character a limited stipend and covers most expenses, then offers to purchase whatever the character recovers. Without consistent results, the funding will be cut off.

Restrictions/Notes: Generally, a Patron is less demanding than nearly anything (or else it'd be a flaw). If a character wants a more obligatory superior or supporter, the Debt, Devotion, or Employed flaws serve nicely to handle that. They can also be coupled with Patron to create a Patron with a higher level of expectation of the character.

Size (R1 or more)

The character is much larger or smaller than the average Human. The player must specify whether the character is bigger or smaller than the average Human.

If larger, for every rank in this Perk, the player receives up to +1D when attempting to physically push, shove, manhandle, grapple or manipulate smaller individuals (use Brawn+Ranks in Size as a baseline comparison for size).

If smaller, for every rank in this Perk, the player receives +1 to their Dodge defense, as well as +1 to Stealth skill die codes.

Restrictions/Notes: Generally, the character's weight is proportional for their height, but other Flaws, could be used to represent a very thin or very large character (respectively). Obviously, no character may take the Size: Large and the Size: Small Perks.

Trademark Specialization (R1)

This Perk works a lot like a combination of the Skill Bonus Talent and Fame. The character excels at one very specific thing, and they are known for it. Choose any specialization that the character has (or would like to have in the future), and the character gains +2D to the roll when it is used, rather than +1D.

If the gamemaster feels its appropriate, when the character uses the trademark specialization, people acknowledge how “naturally good” the character is at the specialization, and this might produce interesting situations socially!

In addition, the character might be contacted or recognized by certain people because of how good they are at that one specialization.

Restrictions/Notes: No character may have more than two Trademark Specializations.

Wealth (R1 or more)

The character with this Perk probably has an estate, inheritance, or series of investments that will keep them comfortable for a good long time. Alternatively, the character could be minor nobility, have a large trust fund, or be married to the owner of a large corporation. The form of wealth will be subject to the setting at hand.

This doesn't mean the character can buy everything — they are still subject to the availability of items.

For each rank in this Perk, the character adds +1D to their Professional Skill (see [page 80](#)) when purchasing items. Additionally, the bonus dice from wealth might apply to die codes to influence folks who are impressed by wealth, successfully bribe officials, or others.

Additionally, adventure bonuses could temporarily raise the wealth die bonus, though the character would have to purchase an additional rank of Wealth to make the increase permanent.

Restrictions/Notes: Characters should select only one rank of Wealth, unless there is some reason they might have Wealth (R1) and another rank of Wealth in other circumstances. Also, this wealth does not always help and disappears if misused (and it should be a major concern to the character at times), but it should be there most of the time. Gamemasters will probably think of ways to work around wealth and players should play along — if you can throw money at every problem, then they aren't that much fun to try to solve, are they?

The most likely Flaw a character with Wealth would have is Devotion, such as “helping all those in need” or “righting all wrong doing.” Otherwise, there should be fairly extensive reasons why the character can’t use their wealth to resolve every situation — or hire somebody to do it for the character (which is really the same thing).

Flaws

Achilles’ Heel (R3-R4)

The character has a particular serious weakness. It is not something that most other characters find especially dangerous or inconvenient, but the character suffers severe penalties and difficulties or even damage when exposed to it. Some examples include:

Allergy: A reasonably common thing the character cannot always avoid strongly affects the character. When exposed to the allergen, the character must make a Brawn roll (the Difficulty is determined by the gamemaster based on the amount of allergen present). If they fail, the character becomes stunned (R3) or incapacitated (R4). The character has to spend an action to make the Brawn roll every round they are exposed to the allergen (which imposes the normal penalty for multiple actions).

Social Allergy: Social allergy works the same as the allergy Achilles’ Heel, but there is some social situation that causes the character to freeze and become shellshocked (exposure to nudity, the sight of police, etc.).

Environmental Incompatibility: The character is sensitive to something in the environment: an extreme of temperature, the chemical content of rain water, a component of the atmosphere, or something similar. Exposure to this without the proper protection causes the character to take a -1D per rank penalty to all die codes until the character is out of the harmful situation (gamemaster’s discretion on how far is removed enough).

Example: The high quantity of carbon monoxide produced by some combustion engines may poison a plant creature. When in the presence of these engines (for instance, when in a big city where these sorts of engines are used), the character must have an air filter on at all times.

Metabolic Difference: The character needs more life support (typically food) than “normal” and begins to suffer penalties (up to and including damage) after hours of malnutrition. Resolving the malnutrition will remove the penalties or heal the damage.

Example: the character eats the equivalent of twice as many meals per day than the average.

If the gamemaster needs guidance, a penalty of -1D for each “missed meal” (stacking the penalty as more meals are missed) is an excellent benchmark. Alternatively, after suffering malnutrition, every meal the character misses, the character must suffer a damage roll with damage dice equal to the rank of this Flaw+the number of missed meals.

Nutritional Requirements: The character must ingest an element not commonly consumed by those of their culture, heritage, or background to survive. Often, the character encounters prejudice (suffering a dice penalty on social die codes equal to the rank of this flaw) because of this. They might develop physical drawbacks or have a reaction if they fail to consume this substance in a reasonable amount of time.

Rot (R3 only): The character’s body is rotting. They periodically loses pieces such as fingers and toes and must pause to fuse them back on. This is a simple action with no roll, but does impose a multi-action penalty. The character suffers no damage from this flaw, but it will inconvenience them. Depending on the Wild Die option used, this can make an excellent complication.

Vulnerability (R3 only): A particular form of attack or interaction affects the character much more severely than other characters. Those forms of attacks or interactions grant a +1D or greater bonus *against* the character (usually for the first roll made in that scene or situation only). The less likely the situation is to occur, the greater the die code modifier.

Symbiosis (R4 only): The character is bound symbiotically to another, drawing strength or energy from them. This symbiosis can be either physical or mental. For every 100 meters by which one character is separated from the other, the character suffers a -1 penalty (cumulative) to either their die codes using physical attributes (Agility and Brawn) or their mental attributes (Knowledge or Perception).

If the character’s symbiote is killed, the character loses 1D from the attributes affected until they can convince another character to willingly bond with them (the bonding process should be simple — like sharing blood — but willing participants must want it to happen).

For an extra rank in this Flaw (making it R5), the character is bound both mentally and physically to another, and loses from both sets of attributes if separated. For the separation to equally affect the “host,” they must also have this version of the Achilles’ Heel Flaw.

Restrictions/Notes: As a general rule of thumb, an Achilles' Heel should be very serious, but not “instant death” for the character who has it.

There should always exist some way to avoid it (not easily), or some chance that the character can counter it. The more likely it affects the character, the less it actually should do.

It's equally possible that the Achilles' Heel imposes different modifiers under different circumstances.

Age (R1-R2)

At Age (R1) the character is a teenager or just past middle age. And, since this is a roleplaying game and not real life, he'll stay that way. In general, characters who are “too young” often have to roleplay through episodes where they are not taken seriously, where they are ignored, and where they have less rights and control than older characters. Those who are “too old” get treated in much the same way — characters in their prime often defer to the character, but they also treat the character as if they were infirm or possibly senile.

At Age (R2), instead of being a teenager, the character is a preteen child. Instead of being just past middle age, the character is old. The roleplaying situations are basically the same, but the effects are more dramatic.

Restrictions/Notes: In general, the gamemaster should try to treat the character as if they were “too old” or “too young” and have fun with it. Game mechanics are seldom required, as good roleplaying can make things work here, but if they become necessary, impose a -1D per rank penalty to a die code performed by the character that their age would struggle with (a young character trying to lead a group of experienced characters, or an older character trying to convince younger characters that they are “with it”). A character may only have one version of Age.

Bad Luck (R2-R4)

The character is exceptionally unlucky. This Flaw is under the gamemaster's control most of the time. A number of times per session equal to the ranks in this Flaw, the gamemaster can have the player reroll a successful die roll. If the player does not wish to suffer the reroll, the player must expend a number of Hero Points equal to the rank in this Flaw.

Restrictions/Notes: This is a painful ability and the gamemaster will likely use it at the worst possible time. players who take this Flaw should be prepared to see their successes suddenly turn sour with little warning!

Burnout (R1 or more)

Under a certain set of proscribed circumstances, the Perk goes away — permanently. The player and the gamemaster should work out the circumstances, with the following criteria:

1. The Burnout should have a chance of occurring about once or twice an adventure.
2. The Burnout should be something the character can avoid — but they might not want to avoid it.
3. A logical reason for the Burnout to occur should exist.
4. Both the player and the gamemaster operate under the knowledge that the Burnout will occur at some point. Some examples of when a Burnout could occur include:
 - An opponent soundly defeats the character in an adventure or subjects the character to a particular uncommon attack (and thus, for example, the character loses the respect of their Contact or foster Culture).
 - The character completes a particular mission of great importance (this would probably only happen after several adventures, but it is something the character wants to complete for some reason).
 - A character's Perk is somehow negated (a Contact who has a good chance of being killed, a piece of Equipment that someone is trying to steal or destroy, a deific power source is displeased for a violation of its ethical code, etc.).

This Flaw is worth a number of ranks equal to one-half (rounded up) of the Perk with which it's associated.

Restrictions/Notes: Any Perk could have the possibility of Burnout. Just think of a logical (or, perhaps, supernatural – if appropriate) reason a Perk would go away. There should exist a decent chance that it could go away, but the character should have some chance of avoiding that occurrence ...for a while.

Debt (R1-R3)

The character owes money, or something else valuable, to someone.

At Debt (R1), some sort of lending institution or credit house exists, and the payments aren't too arduous. The character just has a harder time getting credit and has to turn over a substantial amount of any profits they makes on an adventure to the lender.

At Debt (R2) the character owes a lot of money (or something else valuable) to someone dangerous or the results of owing this debt are dangerous. For example,

the character could owe their life to a really strange old scientist, and, every time that person needs a favor (usually going off somewhere dangerous and doing something suicidal), the character has to drop everything and go. Knightly fealty, oaths of service, and gangland “debts” all can fall under this level.

At Debt (R3) the character owes almost everything to someone or something. In the case of worldly goods, the character must turn over nearly everything to the “lender” at the end of an adventure — the character must “borrow” these things back at the beginning of the next adventure. And it is up to the gamemaster what the “lender” gives back.

In most cases, this means the character is either Employed or under some similar sort of restriction.

Example: In a fantasy campaign setting, your character might belong to a particularly strict cult or religion. As part of their oaths of obligation, the character has to tithe all worldly goods (or, at least, a large portion of worldly goods) to the cult after every adventure.

If they do not, they would be cast out — a fate they would not enjoy — or even hunted and killed. At the beginning of each adventure, the character must beg and persuade whoever is in charge to let the character have any goods they need.

Restrictions/Notes: players should take this Flaw if they intend for their characters to live up to it. The character should have a reason they don’t want to default on the debt, which the player works out beforehand. Also, Debt (any rank) with Enemy (any rank) can be an interesting combination — maybe the character is in deep to a loan shark or a manipulative and unscrupulous lender.

As a word of warning: Debt (R3) is so wide-sweeping that players may not combine it with other versions of this Flaw or link this Flaw to individual Perks without the gamemaster approving such a decision before hand. A character with Debt (R3) might “owe” the possession of a Rank 3 or Rank 4 Perk to a particular source (a character might have received Equipment from a multiple-system-spanning megacorporation source or particularly powerful mystical artifact from a deeply controlling wizard academy) and have to pay some sort of tithe (a sacrifice, all the money the character obtains, etc.) to get the use of the Perk.

A character may have this Flaw with the Perk Wealth (any rank), as long as there is some reason it can’t be just paid off. A character with Wealth (R3) (phenomenal resources) might be stuck in a contract where they have to turn over the profits of any adventure to someone, for example — they still have their wealth, but they must cough up all the little neat things and rewards they get at the end of the adventure (or the character has to persuade the lender/contract holder to let them keep them).

Devotion (R1-R3)

The character feels compelled to take certain actions out of love, an honor code, or a perceived duty to something else. The character may, at times, do things they find morally questionable in order to achieve a greater good. With Devotion (R1), the character's beliefs do not come into play very often.

At Devotion (R2) Flaw the character believes very strongly in something and will attempt to persuade others of the truth of the character's beliefs. Their loyalty to an ideal plays a role in day-to-day life.

At Devotion (R3), the character's belief in the cause motivates almost all actions. The character would willingly die for these beliefs.

Restrictions/Notes: Devotion is primarily a by-product of roleplaying and carries little mechanical penalty. A gamemaster should ensure that a Devoted character keeps the faith and stays focused.

Employed (R1-R3)

The character has a job. Maybe the job relates to what the character wants to do during adventures, or maybe not. Regardless, the character wants to keep their job (or has to, for some reason), and they must take responsibility for missing work and fulfilling their obligations.

When using Professional Skill rules ([page 80](#)), this Flaw is an excellent way to represent the obligation that employment imposes.

Restrictions/Notes: The player and the gamemaster might have to work to roleplay this, but an occasional conflict should arise between what the character wants to do and what they have to do. The character might even have to keep some activities secret or lose their job. The less freedom a character has in making decisions during the adventure on how they spend their time and effort (due to their employment and its obligations), the higher the rank of this Flaw should be.

Enemy (R1-R3)

An individual or group has it in for the character. An Enemy who is a single person of power and influence no greater than the character might actually want the character dead. An Enemy (R1) of power and influence greater than the character simply wants to hassle the character for some reason. Maybe in the town the character operates, the law enforcement authorities have their name and picture on file — and they'll use any excuse to run them in or hassle them because they think of them as

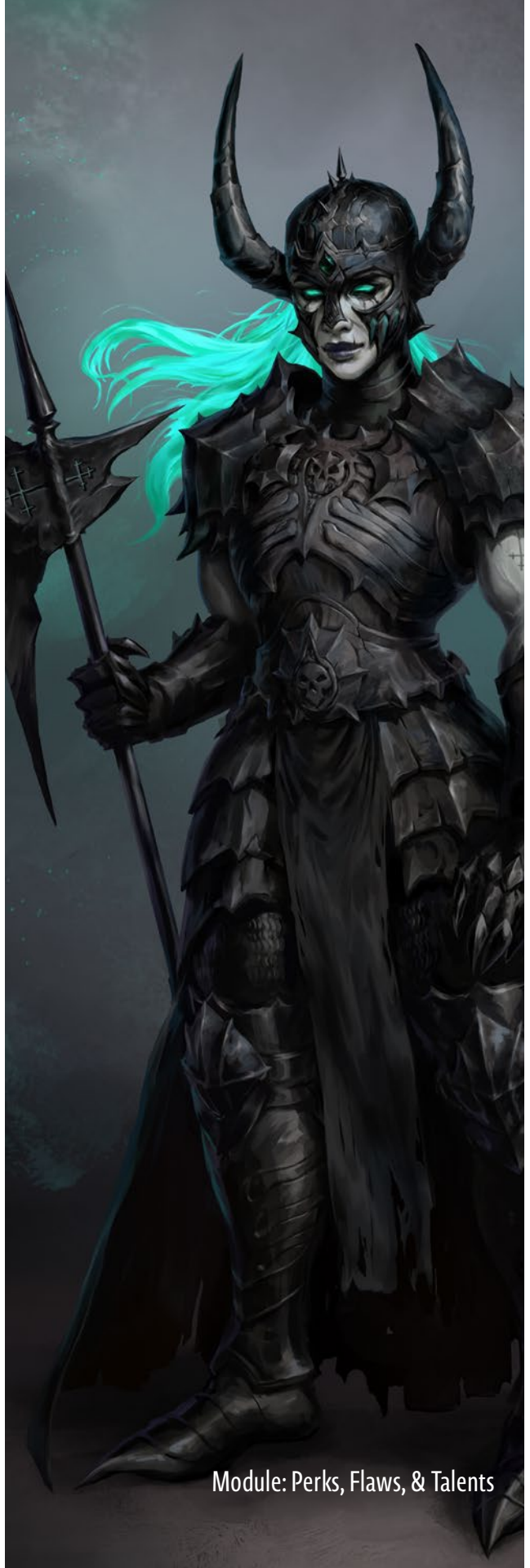
a troublemaker. Or, perhaps, the character's landlord throws everything out on the street if he's one minute late with the rent, or the character's boss always assigns them the most boring or most dangerous missions. The Enemy does not have to have a position in the character's life — they can just be someone who, for some reason known to the gamemaster (and probably the player, but not always the character), has a grudge against the character.

At Enemy (R2) and Enemy (R3), the enemy is more powerful, more annoying, or more involved in the character's life and day to day. The enemy might be an organization, group, or similar foe with greater reach, greater influence, and greater power to impact the character.

The higher the rank of Enemy, the more frequently the enemy shows up.

Restrictions/Notes: There is no reason a player can't use this Flaw similarly to a Perk or as a complement to other Flaws or Perks. There's many creative ways to tie Enemy into other Perks, Flaws, and Talents.

Multiple Enemies of various ranks can be selected (just don't go overboard).



Hindrance (R1 or more)

The character has a minor drawback that makes certain actions more difficult. The Hindrance could be a permanent physical injury, a particular mental block regarding certain types of activities, a limitation innate to the character's species, or the result of age.

The player and the gamemaster should work out some sort of affliction and then choose a group of related actions and die codes. When using those skills, the character must apply a -1 penalty per rank in the hinderance to the die code total after each roll.

For example, a character has an old lingering knee injury that has only gotten worse with age. The player wants this to be Hindrance (R1). In talking with the gamemaster, it is decided that the knee injury will impact Acrobatics, Athletics, and Stealth. Anytime the player rolls one of those die codes, they apply a -1 to the result.

The players may use this Flaw to restrict one form of their characters' movement. A two-meter reduction in one form of movement (running, swimming, jumping, or climbing) is equivalent to a -1 penalty on the roll, so a player could take a small movement restriction along with penalties to skills. The minimum movement rate for a character is one meter.

Hinderance: Atypical Movement: As an alternative to the standard hinderance, characters with a native environment that requires an alternative means of movement other than walking (such as swimming or burrowing) may take one rank of Hindrance: Atypical Move to represent the inability to walk or jump.

In this case, the character uses their base Move to represent the base swimming or burrowing Move. Thus, a water-dwelling character without legs and with this type of Hindrance would have a swimming Move calculated normally (see [page 32](#)), could not walk, and would be limited in the kind of jumping they could perform.

Hinderance: Fragile: players who wish to reduce their characters' ability to avoid harm (to represent delicate physical natures) may take a -1 modifier to all rolls to resist damage for each rank in this Flaw.

Restrictions/Notes: Hindrance (R1) can be selected several times, as long as the gamemaster thinks it appropriate. Since it is very much the counterpart to the Skill Bonus Talent, additional restrictions and notes can be related to the ones found there.

Infamy (R1-R3)

The character is about as well known as a character with Fame (R1), but for different reasons.

The odds of being recognized are the same as for Fame (R1), but the reaction is quite different. The character experiences hostility, prejudice, and intentional slights — in game mechanic terms, the character suffers a -1D penalty per rank in this Hinderance on social die codes when confronted with their infamy or where the infamy would have a negative perception among the others in the social situation.

Infamy (R1) should be something minor — maybe the character is a former criminal, or they did something questionable in the past and was cleared. People are not overtly hostile, but they are unfriendly when they recognize him. Several ranks of Infamy can only be selected if the character is infamous for multiple reasons — but the effects should be cumulative, and this can only be done if the gamemaster thinks it is appropriate. A character with Infamy (R3) would hardly have to worry about Infamy (R1) in most cases, so it would not be a proper combination.

At Infamy (R2) the character is, most likely, wanted for a crime of a fairly serious nature, or they did something (or is thought to have done something) in the past that makes them hated and reviled by most people.

At Infamy (R3) the character has trouble going out in public because a lot of people hate or wish harm on the character. Most social interactions easily escalate to the point of violence against the character.

Restrictions/Notes: There is a reason for this negative attention. Either the character did something, is accused of having done something, or is suspected of having done something not particularly pleasant, or the character has, through other strange circumstances, earned a “bad rep.” Sometimes, this Infamy will help the character — but it shouldn’t help too much.

Language Problems (R2)

The character does not understand the language of the area they spend most of their time in. They must learn skill pips in the specialization languages: (local language). They also receive a +6 difficulty modifier in addition to any other modifiers for what they are attempting to convey or understand.

Restrictions/Notes: The character cannot begin the game with more than one pip in languages: (local language), but they may improve the skill at +2 to the cost. However, the character should speak another language in the game setting fluently.

Learning Problems (R1+)

This Flaw is associated with a single attribute and applies to all skills, specializations, or advanced skills for that attribute.

When the character attempts to learn a new skill or improve an existing skill under that attribute, they does so at +2 per rank to the total cost or required effort to increase the skill.

Alternatively, the character can learn or improve a skill if they fail checks with the skill. A character should have to fail with a single skill at least three times per adventure before being allowed to learn or improve the skill.

There should be some sort of reason for this in the character's background, such as a difficulty reading or a lack of education.

Restrictions/Notes: This Flaw can be taken multiple times, either for the same attribute (with a cumulative increase in skill cost) or for different attributes.

Poverty (R1)

Since characters who adventure tend to accumulate wealth, this Flaw is only available at Rank 1. The character begins the game with the shirt on their back and, maybe, a few pieces of cheap and substandard equipment. The character should also have the attitude of someone who is "poor," whatever that might be in the game setting.

Restrictions/Notes: As an excellent combination, this Flaw could be selected with Debt or Price to make the situation more realistic. Poverty can only be selected once and only at character creation.

Perk Flaw (R1-R3)

This Flaw is linked to a particular Perk or set of skills. Whenever the character uses the Flawed Perk, there is an opportunity for a negative modifier or roleplaying complication. Here are some examples for certain Perks:

Contacts: The Contact helps the character, but they are either "annoying" about it, "high maintenance," or a "hard bargainer." Where a normal Contact would assist the character for an almost negligible fee, the Flawed Contact will haggle and demand something until "rewarded." Some reason should exist why the character would want to keep the contact happy and useful (maybe the contact has deep insights or knowledge that are truly powerful).

Cultures: When the character gets hints or knowledge about a culture, they should know everything except some sort of critical piece of information. Or, if the character has the sweeping knowledge of lots of cultures, their interpretations sometimes are almost totally wrong or contain erroneous leaps of logic (gamemaster option). In order to make this Flaw work, the character should not find out about the error until it would be “interesting,” though players should lean into these misunderstandings. GMs should encourage their players to propose cultural gaffes and then roleplay the consequences.

Equipment: In most cases, some sort of minor mechanical imperfection exists in the equipment that no normal means can fix. For equipment that requires a die code or a roll to use, gamemasters could impose a -1D penalty when using that equipment, or, on a complication, the equipment won’t work or malfunctions. For equipment that wouldn’t normally require a skill total, occasional side effects could happen or maybe it requires a periodic skill check of some kind to keep operating.

Skills: Select three related skills the character has at least a 1D rating in. If the character fails a skill check with one of those skills, they can’t spend Hero Points or use other abilities to reroll those skills either until the end of the scene or until they succeeds at one of those skill checks in a later action.

Wealth or Funds: The character cannot access their wealth easily. Those funds might be tied up in obligations, non-liquid assets or methods, red tape and bureaucracy, or the character might have to go somewhere distant or difficult to reach to get the funds. It might be possible that someone else relatively friendly to the character has control over the funds and doesn’t always release them easily or swiftly.

In general, at Rank 1, a flaw should not debilitate a character or take away their Perk on a regular basis — but it should make it a little less of a sure thing. At Rank 2, the flaws occur more frequently or are more severe. At Rank 3, the Perk can be outright negated, or the outright becomes a flaw in its own right.

Price (R1-R2)

This is a Flaw similar to Perk Flaw. But, instead of there being something wrong with the character’s Perk or a set of three related skills, there is a “price tag” or “cost” attached. Every time the character wants to use the ability, he has to pay a Price at least a few times during the adventure to continue using the ability.

The Price might be an actual fee — and a significant one at that. If the fee isn’t paid, the Perk goes away until the price can be paid. But this won’t work for many Perks (at least not in an interesting manner), so there are other ways to do it.

However, it is more interesting if the Price will be a roleplaying effect. Maybe every time a Contact does a favor for a character, the Contact will not only demand the normal, negotiated recompense (if any), but the character must do a favor of equal importance for the character. Or, whenever a piece of Equipment is used, parts of it need replacing or servicing by a specialist (who may charge a high fee or ask a favor), most likely after the adventure. Perhaps a magical artifact that contains a bound demon and the character must offer some sort of sacrifice to keep access to the powers therein.

One other suggestion for Price (R1) would be that the character has to pay one Hero Point or forgo some small portion of their advancement at the end of an adventure where the Perk or skills were relied upon, to “pay for” the usage. This reflects the fact that the use of the Perk or skills take something out of the character when they are accessed.

Restrictions/Notes: The Price should be fairly easy to meet, but it should take some work. At this rank, it should be something that the character can roleplay along with an adventure or resolve between short adventures or parts of longer adventures (like paying off the recipient of the Price). However, if the character does not pay the Price, the Perk does go away — and, if the character does this too often, both the Perk and the Price should go away permanently. Price can be taken often at various ranks, and the same Price can be linked to more than one Perk, with gamemaster approval.

Quirk (R1-R3)

The character suffers from a personality quirk that makes certain types of roleplaying and interaction more difficult. This Quirk could simply be a habit or a mannerism that has gone too far, or it could be a minor psychological problem. The gamemaster will set the final drawback of the quirk, though some examples include:

Dependency: The character has a slight dependency on a substance or even a roleplaying event. The character might be a pack-a-day smoker who, if they don’t get a cigarette at least once every few hours of game time, gets irritable and can’t spend Hero Points until they get their fix. Or maybe the character always has to have the last word in any situation and will often beat an argument into the ground rather than “lose,” which makes them suffer in social situations.

Kleptomania: When in a store or surrounded by small, portable items, the character will occasionally try to “lift” something. When possessed by this Quirk (see rules below), the character suffers -1D to the sleight of hand die code because the subconscious action isn’t a focus.

Indecision: The character does not like making decisions and will delay making them. When confronted with truly serious situations, they might not declare their actions first, or when roleplaying, the character should actively participate in group discussions, but they should be indecisive at critical moments.

Multiple Quirks can be selected.

Quirks may offer variable difficulty modifiers depending on the circumstances. The more likely that the quirk affects the character, the less it actually should do in each situation.

Example: A character who has a fear of water might “panic” and suffer -1D to an Athletics die code in a shallow stream, a -2D in a deeper lake, or a -3D penalty in the ocean or a raging river.

Restrictions/Notes: Good roleplayers will have fun with these and other Quirks that they come up with. Indeed, this Flaw is often more fun to play than many Perks — but the gamemaster should make certain it is being roleplayed. The gamemaster can request a roll, upon which failure, the character will succumb or indulge their Quirk. In that case, the negative effects of the Quirk immediately come into play.

Some players may choose to have their characters roleplay Quirks they already have or might like to play. Sometimes this works; sometimes it doesn't. It can be hysterical to have a player “steal” dice out from under another player's nose (symbolizing the fact that the character is taking necessary items away from the other player's character) as long as things don't go too far — that is, when people start getting upset. Remember the rule to Play in Good Faith and communicate clearly and kindly!

Reduced Attribute (R2)

Something about the character's history, age, physical condition, or some other factor has permanently reduced one attribute. The attribute is set at 1D and the attribute die code may never be increased through advancement (though gaining a Talent or Perks might offset this penalty).

Restrictions/Notes: A player may not give a character this Flaw at character creation.

Talents

Before allowing players to create characters with Talents, the gamemaster may wish to peruse this list to see if there are any they would prefer not to appear in their games. They may also decide that certain Talents require specific Limitations on them or Flaws on the character.

Any Talent that gives a bonus to the die roll or the skill total also allows the character to use that skill as if trained. Bonuses received from taking multiple ranks of the same Talent are added together.

Some Talents grant new skills that don't exist anywhere else. Those skills gained with a Talent are not improved when that Talent is improved. Instead, they are increased as a normal skill.

Unless stated otherwise in the Talent, it does not count as an action for the character to get the bonus from a Talent. However, except for such automatic abilities like Combat Sense, the character must state that they are relying on the Talent or they do not receive the bonus.

At times, a Talent might seem applicable to the situation, but the rules don't apply clearly or cleanly. In this case, the gamemaster will make the final decision (we encourage a wider narrative interpretation of Talents).

If you are looking for more exotic, supernatural, or unusual Talents, many Superpowers function identically to Talents (see [page 212](#) for a list of superpowers). The list here is more mundane/modern in focus.

Some Talents can only be acquired once while some can be acquired multiple times. If a Talent can be acquired multiple times, their cost per rank is called out.



Ambidextrous (2)

The character is equally adept with their right or left hand. They may perform an action with each hand in the same round, and, though they still suffer the multi-action penalty, they reduce the full penalty by 1 (to a minimum penalty of zero). The actions must involve the hands and each action must require only one hand. If the character performs only one hand-related action in a round, they do not get the bonus. The gamemaster has final say on what meets these requirements.

Combat Sense (3)

The character can sense danger and cannot be surprised. When seeing who goes first in the initiative order, the character may always choose to take the first action. If another participant has this Talent, the two characters resolve initiative as a contested roll between them, and then may resolve their actions in order, but before other participants.

If using one of the alternative initiative modules, the gamemaster will have to tweak or adjust this ability. We recommend the following:

- **Simple Initiative:** If this character's group would not act first, roll a Wild die. Unless there is a complication, the character's group goes first.
- **Basic Initiative:** +1D to the Perception roll to see who goes first.
- **Narrative Initiative:** +2D to the Perception roll to see who goes first.

Endurance (1 per rank)

The character has great endurance, and gains a +3D per rank to Brawn die codes checks when performing taxing physical tasks (such as holding one's breath underwater for a long period or running a long distance).

Enhanced Sense (3 per rank)

One of the character's five senses is heightened to precise and nearly inhuman levels.

The bonus to the skill total received depends on the sense: sight is +1; hearing is +2; touch, taste, or smell are +3. The bonus is per rank and applies to all reasonable uses of skills related to the sense. To have multiple enhanced senses, this Talent must be taken at least once for each sense.

Environmental Resistance (1 per rank)

The character is resistant to extremes of heat, cold, and pressure and gains a +3D per rank to Brawn or skill checks to resist ill effects from these environmental conditions. The character is not resistant to heat or cold attacks, as these come and go too quickly for the Talent to provide protection.

Fast Reactions (3 per rank)

For each rank in this talent, the character may take an additional action for one round (still subject to the appropriate multi-action penalties). The character may only benefit from this talent once per adventure for each rank they have in this talent.

Good Luck (2 per rank)

The character is blessed with unusually good luck. Once per Rank in this Talent per adventure, a character with Good Luck may reroll a single roll and keep the better of the two results.

Additionally, they gain 1 Hero Point at the start of every session.

Hardiness (2 per rank)

The character can withstand and suffer damage better than most. They add +1 per rank to the total of Brawn rolls they make to resist damage (of any type). They may not have more ranks in this Talent than their Brawn die code.

Increased Attribute (2 per rank)

Some extraordinary training or physiological trait allows the character to gain +1 bonus per rank to all rolled totals related to that attribute.

- For Brawn, this also includes the damage resistance total and melee damage.
- For Agility and Perception, this also modifies Dodge and Parry defenses at half rate (rounded down).

A character may have multiple ranks of this Talent, as well as multiple versions of it.

Note: After character creation, this Talent cannot have its ranks increased.

Iron Will (2)

The character is highly resistant to all interaction attempts and mental attacks. When resisting social or mental manipulation, mental or psionic attacks, or other attempts at mind altering influences, the character gets +2D to Knowledge die codes made to resist or overcome those effects

If you are using the Charm module, this bonus instead applies to Willpower rolls.

Longevity (3)

The character lives longer than the average Human. Often, this Talent has a Flaw attached that governs what the character must do to maintain their life. The character should gain peripheral bonuses during game play because of their “longer outlook.” A character may not have this ability more than once.

Master of Disguise (3)

The character has a natural talent for disguise. When making attempts to hide, deceive, disguise, or mislead others socially, they gain a +2D bonus to die codes.

Poison & Disease Resistance (1 per rank)

The character is highly resistant to disease and poisons and receives a +1D per rank to Brawn checks when determining whether they have contracted an illness or suffering from ingested poisons.

Sense of Direction (2 per rank)

The character has a good sense of direction. They gain +1D per rank to navigation and search related die codes.

Stealthy (3 per rank)

The character can move in complete silence. They gain +2D per rank to all sneak checks and a +1D per rank when attacking an unaware opponent.

Skill Bonus (1)

Skill Bonus represents a natural talent (a character with the Charismatic group might be “friendly and outgoing”), a particular knack (a character with the Ranged Combat group has a “keen eye”), years of devotion to a profession prior to beginning adventure, or the result of an extended life.

The character chooses a group of three related skills in which they gains +1 to the skill total of any action performed with those skills (or specializations of that skill). The skills need not be under the same attribute. The character may or may not actually have die codes in those skills, and the gamemaster must approve the fact that they are “related.”

The skills are linked thematically, rather than mechanically.

Example: A player of a soldier character suggests a “Military Historian” Skill Bonus group for their academic. The gamemaster and player agree that Languages, Scholar, and Investigation are appropriate as a group for Military Historian. The skills are chosen for the justification that follows: Languages due to the focus in reading ancient military texts, Scholar for the historical studies and learning, and Investigation to represent research done.

This Talent does not affect the cost of improving the related skills.

Gamemasters may allow a higher bonus for fewer skills (such as a set of two skills where one gets a +1 bonus and the other gets a +2 bonus). However, the bonus per rank may total no more than +3.

At each additional rank, the player may increase the bonus by +1 for three of the skills affected by this Talent. A character may have different versions of this ability for different groups of skills, though the skills in each group may not overlap.

Skill Minimum (4)

The character can select three related skills unaffected by any other sort of Talent and the character will always gain a minimum result total of 3 times the number before the “D,” regardless of any other impact or rules.

Example: If the player selects scholar, sciences, and languages (all knowledge skills) for their character, all of which they have at 4D, if the die code total generates a less than 12, the total automatically becomes 12. That is the character’s minimum total. The player may not select Skill Minimum for any skill that has any other Perks or Talent tied to it.

Also, the skills must be related in some way (see the Skill Bonus Talent for information on related skills). The character may only select general skills, but any specializations (if that rules module is in use) underneath that general skill are affected as well. This Talent may be selected only once for each group of skills.

Uncanny Aptitude (3)

This Talent is similar to the Skill Bonus Talent in that some sort of bizarre ability gives the character added bonuses to certain actions. However, instead of selecting a group of skills that the character gains a bonus to, the player and the gamemaster work out circumstances where these abilities come into play. For instance, a character might gain a +1 bonus to all Agility-related skill totals when in sunlight (for a creature energized by direct sunlight).

A character may have several variations of this ability, reflecting different bonuses.

Ventriloquism (3 per rank)

The character can throw their voice up to three meters away per rank. No skill roll is required to do this, but if it is part of a trick attempt, they receive a +2D bonus per rank to appropriate die codes.

Youthful Appearance (1 per rank)

The character looks much younger than they actually are and receives a +1D per rank to appropriate social die codes. In general, characters should not look more than 10 to 20 years younger than they are, regardless of the number of ranks, though gamemaster discretion and common sense rule here.

Module: Troubles and Assets

If you want to have narrative and characterful ways for characters to control their own Hero Points, you can do so with the Troubles & Assets module!

We recommend you don't use this pack with the Perks, Flaws, and Talents module as there is some overlap between the two ideas, but it's not a hard and fast restriction. This module is designed to work with any of the Hero Points modules.

Think of Troubles and Assets as “Weaknesses” and “Heroic Reputations.” They are triggers that the players can control to get Hero Points if they want. Troubles are narrative setbacks players choose for themselves, akin to weaknesses that give them hero points if they choose to invoke them, Assets are narrative benefits that players can invoke to gain a hero point during a session.

Troubles

Troubles are concepts or short phrases that cause a character to make a bad decision and get themselves into hot water. They are usually two or three words summations of some weakness or foible the character has.

Example Troubles: *Overly Ambitious*, *Blindly Vengeful*, *Mob Debt*, *Hot-Headed*

Troubles should be triggers that the character can willingly enter into to set themselves into a chaotic situation that will prove interesting.

Using Troubles

At any point, a player can declare they are triggering their trouble. When they do so, the gamemaster gives the character a hero point and immediately triggers a *complication* (see [page 27](#)).

The situation that you trigger the complication with should be impactful (you can't trigger a trouble about being *Blindly Vengeful* towards your shoelaces for coming untied for example).

When in doubt, the gamemaster has final say.

A character can only trigger a trouble twice per session.



Assets

The inverse of troubles, assets are character traits that make your character more heroic and larger than life. These are the things people say about you when telling the stories of your exploits and heroic deeds. They are reputations, folklore, and mythical attributes.

Example Assets: *Brave & Steadfast, Clever like a Fox, Tough as Nails*

Assets should be dramatic statements about the character that inform how they are viewed, seen, or tend to act in important narrative moments.

Using Assets

At any point, a player can declare they are triggering their asset. When they do so, the character can either gain +3D to a die code or gain a hero point. The gamemaster can always reward another benefit as they see fit.

The situation that you trigger the asset for should make sense narratively, as well as be impactful. When in doubt, the gamemaster has final say.

A character can only trigger an asset twice per session.

Module: General Foes & Bestiary

For significant or campaign level foes, we recommend you use the a la carte or template rules and create those bespoke foes yourself.

When crafting those enemies, for each player in your campaign, we'd recommend you consider adding additional attribute and skill dice (+1D or so per player) to help the big bads keep up!

While many foes can be created using templates (for common archetypes) or the standard a la carte character creation rules, we've included a series of common foes and enemies for you.

These foes all follow the same rules as players. Where a skill is not called out on the enemy profile, just use the attribute (as normal). If you add additional attribute modules, you might need to modify these enemies and foes a bit, but that should be easily handled!

You might not even need to (after all, a bird of prey doesn't need a technical attribute or skills).

Creatures

For many of the creatures, their Dodge and Parry abilities will not match the calculation used by standard characters. This is deliberate.

As creatures, "Parry" and "Dodging" isn't always the natural state of defense. Usually a creature runs away or attempts to overwhelm a foe. Think of how a bear defends itself (usually relying on its mass to bear down on a foe).

These numbers have been adjusted away from the standard to represent that concept
Later foes use the standard calculations.

Bear, Black

A black bear is more likely to run from people or animals who invade their space, but they will protect their young. They are excellent climbers and can also run extremely fast.

Dodge 10 **Parry** 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 4D

- Athletics: +1D

Knowledge 2D

Perception 1D

Damage: Talons (Brawn+2D)

Bear, Brown

Grizzlies are more aggressive than their black bear cousins, but only when threatened. Longer, deadlier claws and the pronounced hunch on their back make a grizzly bear easy to spot, and while they are also quite fast, these large creatures are not accomplished climbers. However, they have little fear of humans and will often roam into towns.

Dodge 10 **Parry** 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 5D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 1D

Damage: Talons (Brawn+3D)



Bird of Prey

Representing hawks, falcons, and eagles, a bird of prey is a powerful companion for those who can tame it and a relentless and harrying foe for those who disturb it.

Dodge 25 **Parry** 30

Agility 6D

Brawn 2D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 5D

Damage: Talons (Brawn+1D)

Special: Naturally birds can fly! Wings allow the bird to fly or glide for several hundred miles or as long as there are thermals to keep them aloft.



Mountain Lion

Solitary by nature, mountain lions avoid humans under most circumstances. They can be tempted by loose livestock and or pets. These powerful apex predators are extremely dangerous when cornered or protecting their young.

Dodge 15 Parry 15

Agility Skills 4D

Brawn Skills 4D

Knowledge 2D

Perception 3D

Damage: Claws or Bite (Brawn+1D)

Shark

Popular culture has these beasts as terrifying sea predators and well...they are.

Dodge 10 Parry 15

Agility Skills 3D

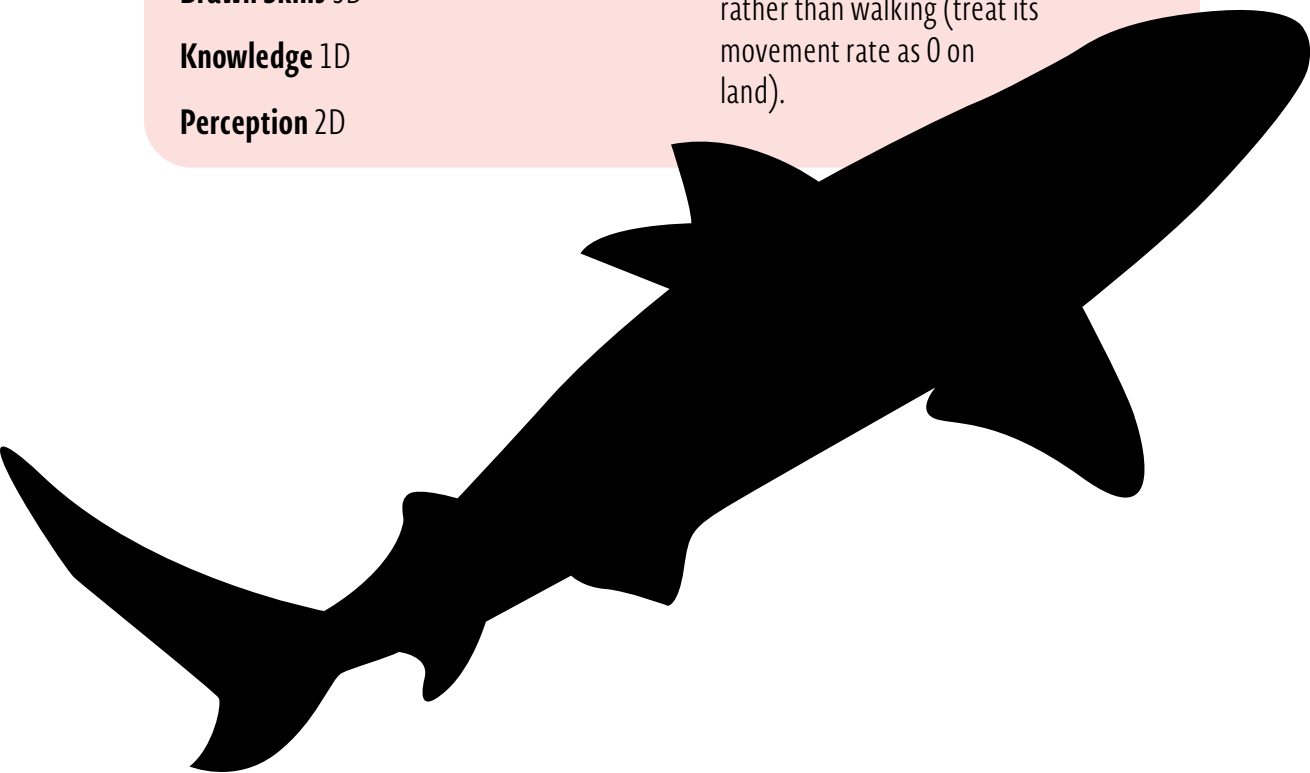
Brawn Skills 5D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 2D

Damage: Bite (Brawn+3D)

Special: Swimming! Any movement this creature does is at a swim speed, rather than walking (treat its movement rate as 0 on land).



Snake, Constrictor

Growing quite large, a constrictor snake can grapple and drown, crush, or suffocate a foe it can get its coils around.

Dodge 5 Parry 15

Knowledge 1D

Agility Skills 3D

Perception 1D

Brawn Skills 4D

Damage: Constrict (Brawn+1D)

Snake, Venomous

Widespread throughout the world, venomous snakes have the potential to be deadly to even a large person (non-venomous snakes either flee or are constrictors).

Dodge 5 Parry 15

Agility Skills 3D

Brawn Skills 1D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 1D

Damage: Bite

(Brawn+1D) If the

target of a bite from a venomous snake takes damage from the attack (stunned, wounded, or incapacitated), they suffer a 6D damage roll at the start of their next round.

Wolf

The ultimate pack hunter, wolves are smart, and during lean times, very dangerous in packs.

Dodge 10 Parry 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 3D

Knowledge 2D

Perception 3D

Damage: Bite (Brawn+1D)

Special: Wolves are rarely alone. If you can see one there's usually a half-dozen more nearby.

Generic Characters

For these characters, you might need to massage or tweak some skills, and you will have to assign them weapons and equipment based on the setting you've chosen to run.

Assassin

Dodge 15 Parry 20

Agility Skills 4D

- Shooting 2D
- Melee 1D

Brawn Skills 3D

- Throwing 1D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 3D

- Stealth 2D
- Survival 1D

Corrupt Politician

Dodge 10 Parry 10

Agility Skills 1D

- Sleight of Hand 1D

Brawn Skills 1D

- Intimidation 1D

Knowledge 4D

- Languages 1D
- Medicine 1D
- Scholar 2D

Perception 4D

- Investigation 1D
- Stealth 1D
- Survival 1D

Detective

Dodge 10 Parry 15

Agility Skills 3D

- Acrobatics 1D
- Shooting 1D

Brawn Skills 4D

- Athletics 1D
- Stamina 1D

Knowledge 2D

- Sciences 1D

Perception 2D

- Investigation 2D

Medic

Dodge 10 Parry 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 2D

- Intimidation 1D

Knowledge 4D

- Medicine 3D

Perception 2D

- Survival 1D

Pickpocket

Dodge 15 **Parry** 25

Agility Skills 5D

- Acrobatics 1D
- Shooting
- Melee 1D
- Sleight of Hand 2D

Brawn Skills 2D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 3D

- Stealth 2D
- Survival

Street Soldier

Dodge 10 **Parry** 20

Agility Skills 4D

- Shooting 1D
- Melee 2D

Brawn Skills 1D

- Intimidation 1D
- Stamina 1D

Knowledge 2D

- Languages 1D

Perception 2D

- Driving (or Riding/Piloting) 1D
- Survival 1D

Soldier

Dodge 10 **Parry** 15

Agility Skills 3D

- Melee 1D

Brawn Skills 4D

- Athletics 2D
- Intimidation 2D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 2D

- Survival 1D

Street Thug

Dodge 15 **Parry** 15

Agility Skills 3D

- Acrobatics 1D
- Sleight of Hand 1D

Brawn Skills 4D

- Athletics 1D
- Intimidation 2D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 3D

- Survival 1D

Module: Templates

What follows are general templates that can be used to build your character. In a template, all you have to do is add 7D worth of skills. Your attributes, defenses, and any other details are already done! Each template includes a small list of a few suggested skills that fit into the theme of the template, but you do not have to assign any dice to those if you don't want to.

Keep in mind that if your GM adds extra skills to the game, the increased starting skill dice might be higher. Your GM will let you know if you need to worry about that.

After assigning skill dice, you'll select equipment based on the campaign your GM is running, and you'll be good go to!

These templates do not make any use of optional modules (though some in the various genre sections later will). These templates are as barebones as the game can get when it comes to complexity, and you can use them as a scaffolding to build on top of if you need inspiration or ideas!

Athlete

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 5D

Brawn: 4D

Knowledge: 1D

Perception: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 10
- Parry: 25

Recommended Skills:
Acrobatics, Athletics,
Stamina

Brawler

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 5D

Knowledge: 1D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 15

Recommended Skills:
Athletics, Melee,
Stamina

Doctor

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 3D

Knowledge: 4D

Perception: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 10
- Parry: 15

Recommended Skills:
Medicine, Sciences,
Scholar

Driver

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 2D

Knowledge: 3D

Perception: 4D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 20
- Parry: 15

Recommended Skills:

Driving, Sciences,
Stamina

Investigator

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

Brawn: 2D

Knowledge: 3D

Perception: 5D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 25
- Parry: 10

Recommended

Skills: Investigation,
Languages, Stealth

Jack of all Trades

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 3D

Knowledge: 3D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 15

Recommended Skills:

Any and all

Scholar

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 2D

Knowledge: 5D

Perception: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 20
- Parry: 15

Recommended Skills:

Languages, Scholar,
Sciences

Thief

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 4D

Brawn: 2D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 4D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 20
- Parry: 20

Recommended Skills:

Acrobatics, Sleight of
Hand, Stealth

Veteran

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 4D

Brawn: 4D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 20
- Parry: 10

Recommended Skills:

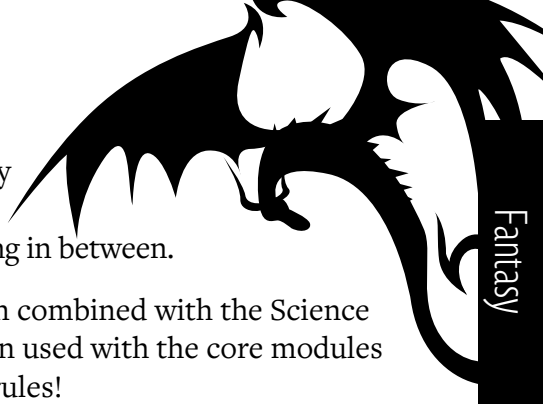
Athletics, Melee,
Shooting

Fantasy



These rules cover fantastic and historical style roleplaying, from deep and dark dungeons to mighty quests and heroic happenings in worlds of sword and sorcery, high fantasy, low fantasy, and everything in between.

They are equally suitable for science fantasy (when combined with the Science fiction collection of modules), urban fantasy (when used with the core modules in an urban milieu), or alongside the superheroic rules!



Module: Fantasy Skills

The following are new skills suitable for the fantasy genre. You do not (and should not) need to apply all of them to your campaign, but instead, should select and choose a select number for each attribute to add.

When you add more skills to the game, be sure to decide if you are integrating the following modules:

- Skill Specializations and Advanced Skills
- Perks, Flaws, and Talents
- Additional Attributes

When adding skills, we recommend that you consider giving +1D for skills during character creation for every *three* skills you add to the game over the core or module skills. This is a loose benchmark, and you might find that a different ratio works better at your table.

Make sure you are familiar with the module you are adding, and decide how you will integrate any rules: for example, will any new skills be advanced skills or specializations? Do you need to add any skills to use particular talents or perks?

Limited Focus Skills & Adjusting Existing Skills

There will be times that you might want to create a new skill that is covered by another skill, because you want a particular focus in that skill for your game. A good example of this is swimming. Swimming is covered by the Athletics skill. However, the gamemaster decides that in their piracy and sailing campaign, they'd like a greater emphasis on swimming. To that end, the gamemaster creates a new swimming skill that is divorced from the traditional Athletic skill.

Doing so allows the gamemaster to add some skill focus without leaning into the entire Skill Specializations and Advanced Skills Module (which they might feel are unsuitable).

We don't cover those particular use cases in this section, but be aware the option exists.



Agility Riding

Riding covers using other creatures as mounts, particularly horses, camels, dragons, or other esoteric beasts that a character might ride.

When mounted, the Riding Skill die code replaces Agility for calculating your Dodge defense (this calculation excludes the Agility die code from the total – no double-dipping.)

Riding generally takes an action to use.

When using the Riding skill, Driving becomes entirely situated on wagons, transports, and similar elements. If you are not sitting on the animal, it is probably Driving.

Lockpicking

Lockpicking covers the dexterity and agility required to precisely open a mechanical lock without possessing the key or combination. It usually requires tools, but can be used without tools (which does make things more difficult). When not using tools, raise the Difficulty by +5 or +10 at the gamemaster's discretion, based on the complexity and quality of the lock.

Lockpicking generally takes an action to use.



Brawn Swimming

Swimming covers the physical act of movement through water (or similar elements). Generally Swimming is covered under athletics, but for particular fantasy character archetypes, heritages, or settings, Swimming is well-served as a standalone skill.

As a guideline, with Swimming you can:

- Swim a number of meters equal to your Swimming Die Code in one round.
- Tread water for a number of rounds equal to your Swimming Die Code (without a test).
- Perform other tasks as the Gamemaster and player agree upon!
- In combat, Swimming can replace your Agility when calculating your Dodge defense (this calculation excludes the Agility die code from the total - no double-dipping.)

Swimming generally takes an action to use.



Knowledge

Barter

Barter is a broad skill that covers trade, business, exchanges, and local financial customs, as well as extending to exchange rates, the monetary value of goods and opportunities, and other information regarding economics. It is best to think of Barter as the Scholar skill of making money, spending money, understanding how various economies work, and conducting business.

Barter does not cover religious financial customs like tithing, duties, and similar elements. Depending on your module, that is either covered by the Mysticism: Esoterica skill ([page 66](#)) or Scholar.

Barter generally takes an action to use.

Languages

The Languages skill lets you know, speak, understand, interpret and express knowledge about languages, both living and dead. In a fantasy setting, it is often presumed that all characters speak a common or “trade” language that is a patois of a variety of languages. The Languages skill represents fluency in the written and spoken tongue beyond that of the common speech.

Languages generally does not take an action to use, though if one is doing research or trying to decipher an obscure or lost language, it can!

The Languages skill works very well with the Skill Specialization rules on [page 98](#) to help define and add texture to a setting. Specific languages can be Specializations, and “dead” or exceptionally rare or esoteric languages can become Advanced Skills!

Navigation

Navigation covers helping guide a vessel or group on an accurate course or journey, using external reference points, such as stars, maps, or landmarks. In most games, it also covers cartography (creating usable maps).

Navigation generally takes an action to use.

Generally, Survival is used for a single individual (or small group) to find their way on short distances, as well as manage local details, difficult terrain and current weather. Navigation is more about long journeys, large groups or vessels and vehicles, and broad regional details and travel.

Additionally, this iteration of Navigation is different than that found in the “Mechanical” Attribute on [page 64](#). This is primarily because fantasy genre games are less likely to use the Mechanical module, but Navigation is important enough to include!

Traps

The traps skill covers the notice, installing, altering, and disabling of traps, alarms, and warning devices, as well as identifying various kinds of traps (gas, pit, wire-triggered, etc.). Failure can cause a trap to trigger on the user of the skill (depending on the scope of the failure).

Traps generally takes an action to use.



Perception Gambling

The gambling skill covers the playing, teaching, learning, understanding, and cheating at games of strategy and luck, as well as assessing risk and reward in dangerous situations where loss can be significant. Successful gambling rolls can increase winnings, while failures can decrease winnings (as determined by the gamemaster based on the scope of the success or failure).

Gambling generally takes an action to use.

Streetwise

The streetwise skill covers finding information, goods, and contacts in large population centers and urban areas. It particularly covers thieves' guilds, organized crime cartels, and similar criminal organizations, black markets, and other illicit operations, as well as contacts. Streetwise can be useful by investigators for determining possible motives and methods of criminals.

Streetwise generally takes an action to use.

Module: Freeform Skill-Based Magic

This module requires the use of the Additional Attributes module (specifically the Magic attribute).

Magic Skills

All spells require one of these skills in order to cast them. When casting a spell, the character generates a Magic skill total and tries to beat the spell's Difficulty. If the skill total exceeds the difficulty, then the spell works (to a greater or lesser extent).

All spells require a particular specialization to cast (change, movement, creation, knowledge). If a character does not have any ability in the specialization, they simply cannot attempt to use that spell (except under special rules – see Untrained Magic on [page 150](#)).

Arcane World

This skill governs knowing, understanding, and identifying magical creatures, planets, locations, and more. If the being, location, item, or lore is part of the world, this skill is how you can tell if you know that information.

Arcane World generally takes an action to use.

Craft Magic Item

This skill is used to create magic items like potions, weapons, armors, wands, and more. The difficulty of crafting, as well as how magical effects are handled is up to the gamemaster, though inspiration can be taken from the “Crafting Spells” section on [page 153](#).

Craft Magic Item generally takes a long time to use (measured in days or weeks), rather than actions.



Identify Magic

This skill governs understanding magic, its effects, analyzing and assessing spells as they're cast, as well as the knowledge needed to negate or overcome magical effects and spells.

Identify Magic generally takes an action to use.

Spell School (Specialization)

Spell school is a skill and each spell school is its own specialization (see [page 98](#) for details on skill specializations)

There are four schools of magic and skill specializations to choose from: *change* (also called alteration), *movement* (also called apportation), *creation* (also called conjuration), and *knowledge* (also called divination).

Spell School always takes one or more actions to use.

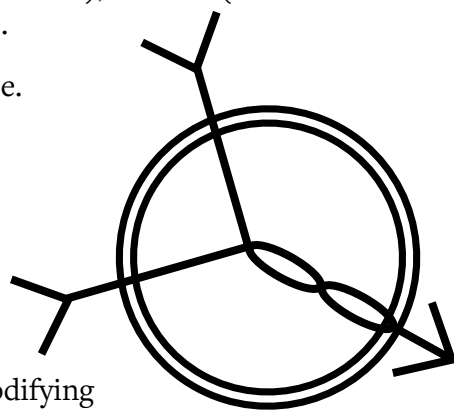
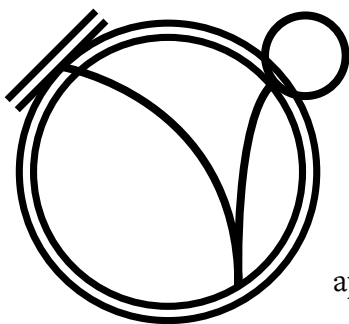
Spell Specializations

Change (Alteration)

Alteration governs magic involving change.

Change means taking something that exists and modifying it or mutating it into something else. A magic spell used to increase a character's Brawn attribute would be an alteration spell, as would one that converts a simple flame into an exploding fireball. Alteration could enhance, reduce, or restrict a character's existing skills.

Alteration must work with things that are already there. An alteration spell can only modify existing characteristics. It could be used to change a person into a bat, but it would not give the person the ability to fly; conjuration would also be necessary to give the character the Flight Talent, something they didn't have before.



Movement (Apportation)

Apportation governs magic involving movement. For example, a telekinesis spell, by which a character could "grab" an object and move it using magic, would be an apportation spell. Calling a dagger from a box at home to

your hand is apportation, as is teleporting yourself to another place. Apportation can also cause a person or creature to move from one place to another under its own power. Spells that restrict movement would also be apportation spells.

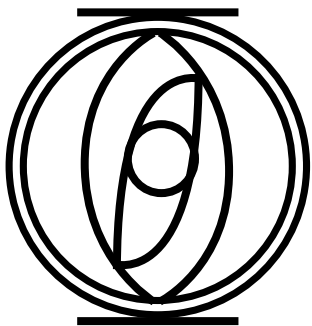
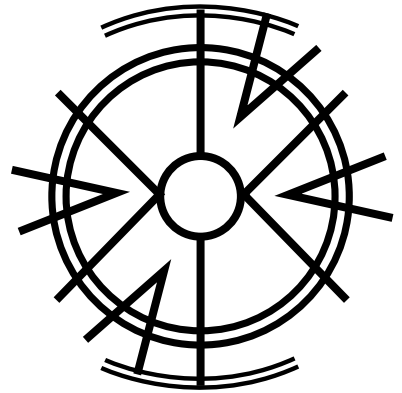
Apportation is not conjuration — the object or the creature summoned is in existence at the time the spell is cast, the apportation spell simply “calls” the object or creature.

Characters or creatures may either be apported by compulsion (and come under their own power), moved by the spell’s power, or teleported.

Creation (Conjuration)

Conjuration magic involves producing something from nothing. A spell that produces gold out of thin air is conjuration, as is one that imbues an inanimate object with animate features (such as creating a stone man and giving it the attributes of a person). Conjured items and characteristics remain in existence for the duration of the spell.

Conjuration is used for only one purpose: creation of something out of nothing. For example, if you wanted to animate a plant and give it the power of speech, you would use conjuration — you would have to “create” in it the ability to talk and the die codes necessary to speak. Conjuration is not used to bring things from one place to another — that is movement (apportation).



Knowledge (Divination)

Divination governs magic involving obtaining knowledge. For example, scrying spells, “far-sight” spells, and “speak with the dead” types of spells are all covered by divination. Spells that block the obtaining of Intellect are also divination spells.

Characteristics of a Spell

There are seven characteristics of a spell, and the precalculated spells that follow are formatted using these categories of information.

Skill Used: The skill selected is the one necessary to cast the spell. This is always Spell School + a specialization. Keep in mind that a different skill might be necessary to target or use the spell.

Difficulty: The difficulty is the skill total a character must generate to get a spell to work.

Casting Time: How long or how many actions the spell takes to cast.

Power: The power of the spell is a number (1, 2, 3, etc.) and is representative of the die code of any effects the spell applies. For damaging or attack spells, this is the damage die code of the spell. For other spells, it will indicate some quantity that the spell inflicts. It is best to think of power as a sliding scale. The higher the number, the more effects a spell might have, or the more potent those effects might be.

Resist: If the spell can be resisted, it will be indicated here, along with the skill used to resist it! Keep in mind that some spells might have more suitable resistance skills depending on what modules your game is using.

Duration: Duration specifies how long a spell's effect will last. The duration is given in both "real" time (minutes, seconds, hours, etc.) and in a time value (as read on the "Spell Measures" table).

Range: This is generally represented as "Melee," "Ranged," "Visual" or some other qualifier. You must be in range to have a spell effect the target.

Using Spells & Their Effects

Roll the spell skill for the spell in question to get a skill total. If the total is higher than the difficulty number, the spell has succeeded and the caster may use the spell's effect. Which skill the spell requires is either decided when the effect is developed or listed with a precalculated spell.

Remember that players may use Hero Points to influence these rolls!

Untrained Magic

Characters might have spurts of inspiration in areas in which they have no training. For those who have some training (that is, those without the appropriate specialization, but a Magic Attribute die code) the difficulty increases by +5 to cast a spell using a skill in which they have no experience.

For those who have no training (that is, no pips or dice in any Magic skill and no dice in the Magic attribute), the difficulty increases by +10 for all spell casting.

Targeting or Using the Spell

Many spells require separate targeting or manipulative skill totals when they are used. The most common of these are combat effects that act like weapons.

If the spell focuses on a target (such as a enhance attribute or alter movement spell), the player and gamemaster must decide what skill (such as Shooting, melee combat, or throwing) to use to hit, if necessary.

Strain Option

As another means of controlling the use of magic, gamemasters may choose to increase the difficulty to cast spells by 1 for each spell that the character performs beyond a set number (such as five or 10) before the spellcaster has a chance to rest (generally, five minutes or so per spell cast prior to the break).

Applying the Effect

You should use common sense when applying the effect of spells, but here are some guidelines:

- Damage spells resolve immediately upon a successful cast.
- Spells that add extra dice or enhance future rolls provide their bonus immediately after the action taken to cast the spell, and until the duration is over.
- Spells that move targets resolve immediately upon a successful cast.

Precalculated Spells

Below follows several common spells. You can use them right away or as inspiration for inventing your own.



Arcane Armor

- **Skill Used:** Creation (Conjuration)
- **Difficulty:** 5
- **Casting Time:** 1 action
- **Power:** 2
- **Resist:** Yes (Complete Nullification, Willpower)
- **Duration:** Ten minutes
- **Range:** Self
- **Target:** Self

The spellcaster summons mystical armor that protects and girds them. They gain +2D to Brawn to resist damage.



Enhance Attribute

- **Skill Used:** Change (Alteration)
- **Difficulty:** 15
- **Casting Time:** 1 action
- **Power:** 2
- **Resist:** No
- **Duration:** Ten minutes
- **Range:** Melee
- **Target:** One

The spellcaster grants +2D to a single attribute of their choice (chosen when this spell is cast).



Fireball

- **Skill Used:** Change (Alteration)
- **Difficulty:** 10
- **Casting Time:** Two turns
- **Power:** 4
- **Resist:** Yes (Complete Nullification, Acrobatics)
- **Duration:** Instant
- **Range:** Senses
- **Target:** One target (the flame).

The caster turns an existing flame (candle or larger) into a large fireball that harms the nearest four targets adjacent to or within reach of the fireball with a damage code of 4D. This spell can only alter an existing flame. It does not create wholesale fire out of nothing.

The flame is the target of the spell, and as a logical extension of that, the Spell Power (4) determines the impacted number of individuals (4) as well as the damage (4D). The gamemaster felt that the qualifier of “within reach or near the candle” was common sense, but using the Spell Power to limit it to four individuals worked well.



Oracular Sight

- **Skill Used:** Knowledge (Divination)
- **Difficulty:** 10
- **Casting Time:** One action
- **Power:** 1
- **Resist:** No
- **Duration:** Instant
- **Range:** Melee
- **Target:** Self

The caster can ask one question about a situation of the gamemaster. The gamemaster might have a proxy in narrative, such as an artifact (magic mirrors, etc.), an ally who has insight (a corpse awoken to be asked) or similar effects. Generally, the question is answered truthfully and honestly (the magic compels it), though answers might be esoteric or opaque and require research.

Because this spell targets the caster, the medium they are asking through must be in the same locale as the caster and reasonable able to respond. If the individual they are asking is not present, then the range would be changed to an appropriate number (and the difficulty would then increase).



Raise Zombie

- **Skill Used:** Change (Alteration)
- **Difficulty:** 15
- **Casting Time:** one action
- **Power:** 1
- **Resist:** No
- **Duration:** Instant
- **Range:** Melee
- **Target:** One target (a corpse)

One corpse is raised as a zombie (see [page 167](#)). The caster may issue it one (due to the Power of this spell) simple command, which the zombie will do its best to obey.



Snowfall Step

- **Skill Used:** Movement (Apportation)
- **Difficulty:** 10
- **Casting Time:** one action
- **Power:** 1
- **Resist:** No
- **Duration:** Instant
- **Range:** Senses (Sight)
- **Target:** Self

This spell instantly teleports the caster to a location they can see. The caster leaves behind a coldsnap of bitter frost and blinding whirling snow, which imposes a -1D penalty on any attempts during the next turn to locate the caster's new location.



Healing Touch

- **Skill Used:** Change (Alteration)
- **Difficulty:** 15
- **Casting Time:** one action
- **Power:** 2
- **Resist:** No

- **Duration:** Instant
- **Range:** Melee
- **Target:** One

After casting this spell, the target of the spell immediately makes a Medicine roll to heal damage they have suffered, with a +2D bonus. This medicine roll does not count as an action.

Designing a Spell

If you want to design a unique spell, you can use the guidelines below. These guidelines should be considered an art rather than precise science, and the gamemaster has the final say on any difficulty or details of a spell.

Do your best to consider what you want the spell to do carefully, then use the following tools as guidelines to craft the spell. Work with the gamemaster to make any final tweaks you might have in mind for the spell. Trust your gut, but remember that it's better for a spell to be too hard and require a little extra effort (hero points or help) than too easy!

Difficulty

The difficulty of the spell is determined by answering the following questions of the spell:

1. What is the effect of the spell?
 - This generally covers what spell school specialization will be used.
2. What is the Power of the spell?
3. Can the Spell be resisted?
4. What is the Duration of the spell?
5. What is the Range of the Spell?

Spells Starting Difficulty

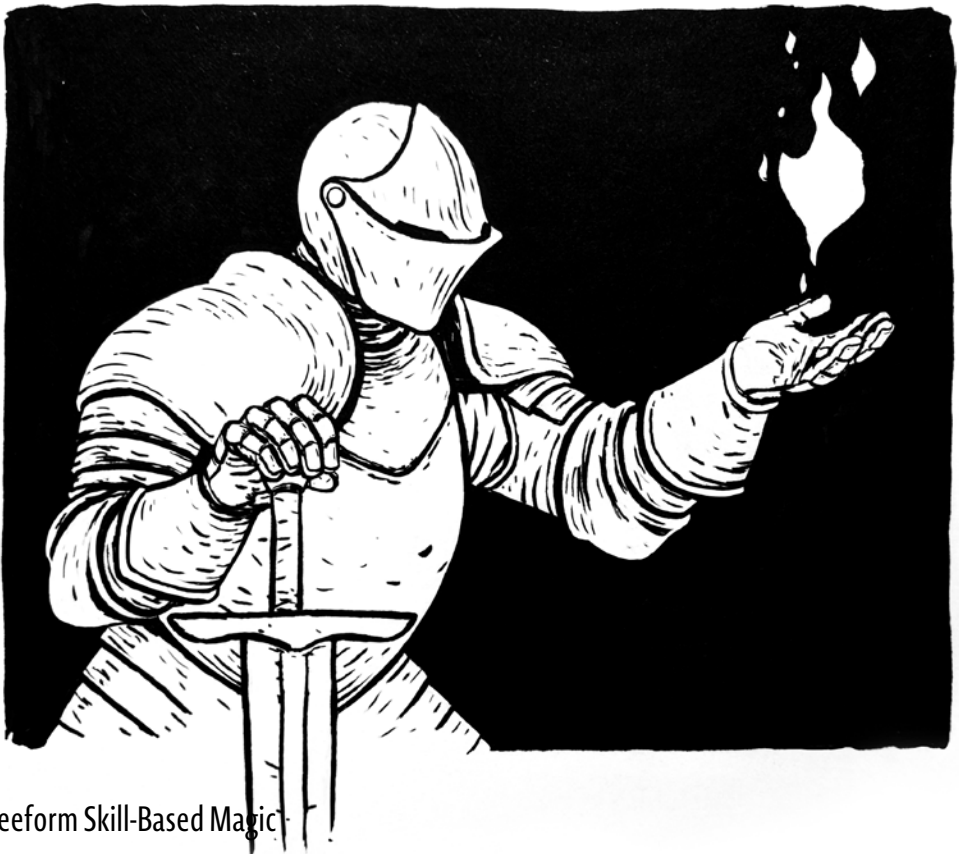
All spells have a base difficulty of 5. This is then modified as you create the spell, but a spell may never have a lower difficulty than 5.

The Effect of the Spell

You begin crafting a spell by asking what you want the spell to do. To do this, we ask four basic questions:

- Is the spell changing an existing thing to achieve the spell's effect?
 - If yes, it's **Change** (Alteration)
- Is the spell achieving its effect by wholesale creation of new energy, materials, or elements?
 - If so, it's **Creation** (Conjuration)
- Is the spell achieving its effect by relocation or repositioning?
 - If so, it's **Movement** (Apportation)
- Is the spell achieving its effect by asking questions or leveraging insight and knowledge?
 - If so, it's **Knowledge** (Divination).

If the effect could go either way, default to the most common sense option (or ask your gamemaster to decide).



Here are some examples of how we use those questions:

- Do you want the spell to harm enemies through fire, ice, lightning, mystical bolts, or other created magical effects?
 - If so, the spell is a Creation (Conjuration) spell.
- Do you want the spell to harm enemies by altering their form or applying a change to them that hinders and hurts them?
 - If so, the spell is a Change (Alteration) spell.
- Do you want the spell to harm them by hurling them into something or by moving something into them?
 - If so, the spell is a Movement (Apportation) spell.
- Do you want the spell to protect yourself or the target with mystical summoned forces?
 - If so, the spell is a Creation (Conjuration) spell.
- Do you want to alter yourself to be more protected by having scales, quills, or similar?
 - If so, the spell is a Change (Alteration) spell.
- Do you want to move under the power of magic, such as with flight, portals, or teleportation?
 - If so, the spell is a Movement (Apportation) spell.
- Do you want to alter the target to move by having them grow wings, longer legs, or other physical changes?
 - If so, the spell is a Change (Alteration) spell.
- Do you want to gain knowledge you do not have by reading minds, asking gods, or talking to corpses?
 - If so, the spell is a Knowledge (Divination)
- Do you want to summon extraplanar creations to serve you?
 - If they already exist and you are just bringing them here, that is a Movement (Apportation) spell.
 - If they are created wholesale that is Creation (Conjuration)
 - If they are living beings who are changed to serve you (zombies, intelligent plants or animals) that is Change (Alteration).

As you can see, the four spell school specializations have a pretty clear scope and scale, though you can always ask your gamemaster for a ruling if you are unclear.

Targets of the Spell

You must determine how many and what sort of targets the spell can impact and affect. Use the table below to determine how the Difficulty of the spell is modified.

Targets	Difficulty Modifier
Self only	-5
One target	+0
2 or 3 targets	+5
4-6 targets	+10
A small crowd or gathering	+15
A large crowd or gathering	+20
Single small non-living target (human-sized)	0
Small environmental area (farmstead, small village)	+5
Large environmental area (landscape feature/town)	+10
Large environmental area (city, entire landscape)	+15

With targets and modified difficulty, the gamemaster has to be careful to avoid making powerful, wide-ranging spells too easy. The highest Difficulty modifier should be applied when this is used.

For example, altering all the buildings in a city to mud (or crystal) would be fine with the +15, but if you wanted to do a spell that would also harm the living beings there, you'd have to take the higher +20.

Logic will sometimes say that the target of the spell is a single object, but the effect might be larger than the target (turning a candle flame into a fireball, for example). In these cases, we tend to use Spell Power to determine the maximum number of impacted individuals, within a framework of common sense (we did warn you it was a bit more art than science).

Spell Power

Spell Power determines the strength of the spell. Based on the spell power, the Difficulty of the spell is modified as per the table below.

Spell Power	Difficulty Modifier
1 (1D)	+0
2 (2D)	+5
3 (3D)	+10
4 (4D)	+15
5 (5D)	+20
6 (6D)	+25
7 (7D)	+30
8 (8D)	+35
9 (9D)	+40
10 (10D)	+45

For Spell Power over 10, simply add +5 to the difficulty for each +1 to spell power.

When considering how spell power impacts spell effects, use the following guidelines (though as you create your own spells, you'll probably have to define your own guidelines):

- For damaging spells or attack spells, the spell power is the damage die code of the spell.
- For spells that represent a burst or area of effect attack, the Spell Power determines the maximum number of impacted individuals (as the target is likely to be a single point).
- For defensive spells, the spell power is a bonus to the armor die code of the target.
- For divination spells, the spell power is how many insights or questions you may ask or gain.
- For movement spells, the spell power is how far the spell can move the target
 - Gamemasters might need to adjudicate movement spells a bit.
 - If the campaign and table are using battlemats, the movement is easy. Just treat each spell power as a square or hex on the battlemat.
 - If you are using a more theater of the mind approach, you might want to consider each spell power as a yard, ten feet, or maybe a mile.
 - Truly powerful movement spells can move the targets across planes or worlds.
 - How far away the target can be when the spell is cast (such as bringing a target to you) is covered by the range section below.
- For enhancing spells that add die to a die code, the spell power is the number of bonus die that are gained.

Resisting the Spell

Next, you have to ask if the spell can be resisted. If you answer yes, this means targets get a chance to nullify or partially reduce the impact of the spell. Use the table below to find the modifications. If the spell only works on willing targets or doesn't target anyone or anything able to resist, skip this table entirely, as the modifier doesn't apply.

Resisting the Spell?	Difficulty Modifier
No	+15
Yes (partial nullification)	+5
Yes (complete nullification)	-5

- If the spell cannot be resisted, that means the target does not get an opposed roll (against your casting roll) to nullify the spell.
- If the spell can be partially nullified, the target gets an opposed roll, and if they are successful, you must halve the spell power of the spell (rounded down) for the purposes of determining its impact and effects.
- If the spell can be completely nullified, the target makes an opposed roll, and if they are successful, you simply fail to impact or affect them with the spell.

If your spell can be resisted, you must define a reasonable attribute and skill that are used to resist the spell. For attack spells, Agility + Acrobatics are good choices, Brawn + Stamina work well for alteration spells, and so on.

If your campaign is using various Additional Attribute Modules, you might have other options too! But whichever skill and attribute are chosen should be consistent and make sense.

Duration	Difficulty Modifier
Instantaneous	-5
One round or one action	+0
Ten minutes	+5
One hour	+10
One day	+15
One week	+20
One month	+25
One year	+30
One century	+35
Permanent	+40

Duration

How long does the spell last? Is the effect ongoing or does it disappear immediately after the spell is cast?

Divination spells that grant questions or chances to get answers tend to last until all questions are asked (even if the spells themselves are instantaneous), but the presumption is that the questions must be asked then and there and quickly. The

caster just has a reasonable amount of time to ask them.

If the questions can be held or linger, use the maximum duration the questions can be held.

Casting Time

How long does it take to cast the spell? Generally a spell that works in combat can be done as one action, but some very powerful spells take longer.

If a spell takes multiple turns to cast, that means at least one action must be

Casting Time	Difficulty Modifier
One action	+0
Two Turns	-5
Four Turns	-10
One hour	-15
One day	-20
One week	-25
One month	-30
One year	-40

spent casting the spell on each required turn. However, only one spellcasting skill roll is made, on the last action. The turns must be sequential, though where the action falls in the turn is not relevant (as long as the spellcasting action occurs successfully during that turn).

Very few beings can achieve a casting time of more than one day (as hunger, sleep, and deprivation would impact them). Be sure to consider that when determining your casting time! No shortcuts in magic.

Range

What is the range of the spell? How far away can the target be before the spell becomes unusable?

Range	Difficulty Modifier
Melee (this covers spells that only target the caster)	+0
Senses (Sight, Smell, etc.) / Ranged Attack	+5
Within one mile	+10
Within same locale (city, town, etc.)	+15
Within 100 miles	+20
No range	+25

Module: Magic Points Casting

This module requires the use of the Additional Attributes module (specifically the Magic attribute).

To use this ability, characters will need to create spells using the rules under the Freeform Skill-Based Magic rules, but rather than *roll* a die code to cast that spell, the character must expend magic points.

Adjusting Spell School to Mystical Alignment

In this module, the Spell School skill is removed and replaced with a skill named “Mystical Alignment.” This skill is not rolled, but rather used to calculate the number of magic points a character has. Without any points in Mystical Alignment, a character is not a spellcaster and cannot use spells.

Calculating Magic Points

A spellcaster has a number of magic points equal to their Magic attribute plus their Mystical Alignment skill times three ($\text{Magic} + [\text{Mystical Alignment} \times 3]$). This means the mystical alignment skill determines the bulk of the magic points a character has.

Example: Alan’s character has a Magic attribute of 2 and a Mystical Alignment Skill of 2. This means, his character has 8 magic points ($2 + [2 \times 3]$).

Casting a Spell Using Magic Points

It takes an action to use a spell. As part of that action, the spellcaster expends the requisite number of magic points.

When determining how many magic points it takes to cast a spell, simply divide the casting difficulty by ten and round up (you can consult the following table).

Casting Difficulty	Magic Points	Casting Difficulty	Magic Points
0-10	1	41-50	5
11-20	2	51-60	6
21-30	3	61-70	7
31-40	4	71-80	8
		81-90	9



While it might seem silly to use the same rules for both forms of magic, it does allow us to keep the spells balanced, regardless of however a character might calculate, cast, or use the spell.

Obviously, rolling to cast a spell is likely to be more frequent in game play (as there's no resource depletion occurring), so those using Skill based magic are more likely to cast spells (more often) than those who use magic points.

However, magic points are not prone to failure. They just work. That makes them more powerful in specific circumstances.

Recovering Magic Points

A character recovers a number of magic points equal to their Magic attribute at the start of every hour.

Module: Active & Responsive Combat

Riposte

In melee combat a character may *riposte*, turning an opponent's strike against them! Riposting works as follows:

When an enemy has a '1' occur on the Wild Die when making a melee attack, the defender may riposte. The defender immediately spends a Hero Point and makes a Melee attack. This replaces the normal complication caused by a "1" on the Wild Die.

A character may also riposte as an action if they have a 4 or more in Melee whenever an attack misses them. They must still spend the Hero Point to riposte.

Riposting does count as a use of a skill when determining the number of skills a character has used in a round.

Feint

In melee combat a character may feint, using their melee weapons to put their opponent off-guard and enable the character (or an ally) to land a decisive blow! Feinting works as follows: When a character has a '6' occur on the Wild Die, they may feint. If they do, their opponent's Defense (either Dodge or Parry) is lowered by the character's Melee skill against the next attack.

A character may also feint as an action if they have a 4 or more in Melee. This doesn't require a roll but does count as a use of a skill when determining the number of skills they use in a round.

Autofire

Some weapons will allow the user to make an attack by unloading as many rounds in one action as they can. When a weapon has the autofire special rule, before you roll your attack, you decide how much you want to unload!

Each autofire rating has a number behind it, such as autofire (3). You can lower your attack roll by any amount up to the autofire rating or your Shooting (whichever is higher.)

You then add twice that amount to damage.

Example: If Alan's character has Shooting 3 and is firing a gun with Autofire (3), he lowers his attack total by -3. If he hits, he then adds +6 to their damage resistance total when making his damage roll.

Autofire is a bit odd to include in the Fantasy Modules (we know). But we didn't want to make a module just for this rule somewhere else, so here it is with the rest of the combat options!

Full Defense

Sometimes a character will need to focus fully on defending themselves. On their turn, they can go into a full defense stance. While in full defense, they may add their Melee die code to their Parry, and their Acrobatics die code to their Dodge, increasing their defense. If a character goes into full defense, they can take no other actions during that turn (and conversely cannot go into fully defense if they take other actions that turn beforehand.)

Veterans of the D6 System will notice that D6 System: Second Edition defaults to "static defenses" (predetermined numbers) rather than "active defenses" (opposed rolls).

This is designed to streamline play, especially as characters can grow in power as the game progresses.

If you want to revert to opposed rolls for defense, nothing is stopping you! The game supports that easily, you just have to define a "Dodge" and "Parry" skill and house them in the appropriate attributes. We recommend Dodge be under Agility and Parry be under Perception. While Agility might feel natural for Parry, quickness of senses has a lot of input into defending oneself, and it makes sense to split the two up, to avoid high Agility characters becoming too difficult to hit.



Module: Fantasy Bestiary

Many of the enemies you might want in a fantasy world can be found in the Module: General Foes & Bestiary. Thieves, assassins, and more are all there, just waiting for you to adjust and tweak them to fit your setting.

What we present here is a limited selection of new creatures that will fit in a fantasy setting, though, enterprising gamemasters will find ways to use them for aliens in science fiction games and other settings.

Modifying these enemies is easy to do when using the Perks, Flaws, or Talents Module, or any additional Attributes the gamemaster might wish to apply. Oftentimes a Generic Character template or a creature from the bestiary with a few Perks, Flaws, or Talents, adjusted skills, or tweaked attributes will make enough a difference to establish their own identity.

One of the great benefits of the D6 system is how easily one can tweak all these details with minimal effort!

For significant or campaign level foes, we recommend you use the a la carte or template rules and create those bespoke foes yourself.

When crafting those enemies, for each player in your campaign, we'd recommend you consider adding +3D to attributes and +3D to skills (just to keep it even, or they'll be outnumbered)!

If you are crafting your own monsters, we recommended 1D-2D in attributes for creatures less powerful than players' characters, 2D-3D for as powerful, and 4D or more for more powerful; skills are generally 1D-4D above base attribute if you feel you need skills!

Dragon

Dodge 20 (25 while flying) **Parry** 20

Agility Skills 4D

Brawn Skills 6D

Knowledge 2D

Perception 4D

Damage: Claws (Brawn+1D), Tail (Brawn, Range 3), or Bite (Agility+2D)

SPECIAL

Armored Scales: Dragons have armored scales that defeat most mortal weapons. They gain +3D to resist damage applied

against them, magical or otherwise.

Breath Weapon: Dragons can breath damaging attacks (such as fire, acid, or similar). This attack is made using the Perception attribute, and deals 6D damage. The attack is generally a stream or line, and can hit any foes in a roughly 30' foot line before it dissipates.

Flight: Wings allow the dragon to fly, glide and soar under their own power. They might be limited by their size or the area they are in and are generally more mobile in the air (count their Dodge as +5).



Giant

Dodge 10 (15 while flying) **Parry** 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 9D

Knowledge 2D

Perception 3D

Damage: Tree-trunk Club (Brawn+3D) or Unarmed (Brawn).

SPECIAL

Large Size: Giants are huge, and as such, their melee attacks have Range 3 (see [page 80](#)).

Fairy Nuisance

Flitting, dark, and deadly fairy creatures, fairy nuisances are bloodthirsty faefolk who steal children, attack travelers and generally infest a forest like a horde of the worst insects you can imagine.

Dodge 20 **Parry** 10

Agility Skills 4D

Brawn Skills 1D

Knowledge 2D

Perception 4D

Damage: Knife (Brawn+1D)

SPECIAL:

Fairy flight. Wings allow the fairy to fly, glide and flit around in forest areas. Outside of forested areas, they have to walk (something they hate).

Fairy magick: Sometimes these nuisances can be spellcasters. If they are a spellcaster, they use the Magic Points module ([page 160](#)) and have 10 magic points that they recover like normal.

Zombie

Shambling undead with no intelligence, zombies are often created by Necromancers. In some circumstances their bite can infect new zombies, though that isn't always the case.

Dodge 10 **Parry** 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 4D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 1D

Damage: Bite, Claw, or Grab (Brawn+1D)

Module: Fantasy Templates

The fantasy module templates make use of the Additional Attributes: Charm, Mysticism, & Magic ([page 62](#)) module, as well as the Skill Specialization module (which the Magic attribute needs for Spell School).

To that end, we recommend you add +3D to the total starting dice you can assign to the skills of these templates (for a total of 10D). We've already added +9 bonus attribute dice to account for the three new attributes (for a total of 21D in attributes).

Occultist

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 4D

Knowledge: 5D

Magic: 1D

Mysticism: 4D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 10

Recommended Skills:

Arcane World, Esoterica, Identify Magic, Scholar

The Occultist is one who studies magic in the world around them (much like a theoretical scientist might in our world). The Wizard is one who puts magic to use as a tool (much like an engineer might use science in our world).



Priest

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 3D

Knowledge: 4D

Magic: 1D

Mysticism: 4D

Perception: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 10
- Parry: 10

Recommended Skills:

Esoterica, Prayer,
Scholar, Ritual



Warrior

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 4D

Brawn: 5D

Charm: 3D

Knowledge: 3D

Magic: 1D

Mysticism: 1D

Perception: 4D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 20

- Parry: 20

Recommended

Skills: Athletics,
Melee, Shooting,
Stamina, Throwing





Wizard

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 1D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 3D

Knowledge: 5D

Magic: 5D

Mysticism: 2D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 5

Recommended

Skills: Arcane World, Identify Magic, Spell School*

*Don't forget that you must spend 1D from your assigned skill die and select at least one specialization for Spell School (see Acquiring Skill Specializations on [page 98](#)).

Science Fiction



These rules cover hard science fiction, space opera, and more! If you want to careen across the stars in acts of rebellion, try to make ends meet in a difficult and dark universe, or boldly go into the utopian future humanity could have, this is for you!

Module: Science Fiction Skills

You do not (and should not) need to apply all of them to your campaign, but instead, should select and choose a select number for each attribute to add.

When you add more skills to the game, be sure to decide if you are integrating the following modules:

- Skill Specializations and Advanced Skills
- Perks, Flaws, and Talents
- Additional Attributes

Make sure you are familiar with the module you are adding, and decide how you will integrate any rules: for example, will any new skills be advanced skills or specializations? Do you need to add any skills to use particular talents or perks?

When adding skills, we recommend that you consider giving +1D for skills during character creation for every *three* skills you add to the game over the core skills. This is a loose benchmark, and you might find that a different ratio works better at your table.

Limited Focus Skills & Adjusting Existing Skills

There will be times that you might want to create a new skill that is covered by another skill, because you want a particular focus in that skill for your game. A good example of this is swimming. Normally covered by the Athletics skill, if the gamemaster decides that in their piracy and sailing campaign, they'd like a greater emphasis on swimming, they could pull it out and create a new swimming skill that is divorced from the traditional Athletic skill.

Doing so allows the gamemaster to add some skill focus without leaning into the whole Skill Specializations and Advanced Skills Module (which they might feel are unsuitable).

We don't cover those particular use cases in this section, but be aware they do exist.

Modules to Apply in Science Fiction

The Mechanical and Technical Attribute and Skill modules ([page 64](#) and [66](#)) cover a significant portion of what would be covered by new skills under the science fiction genre. As such, there are less "new" skills in this module, but instead only a few suggestions that accentuate the genre outside of the addition of Mechanical and Technical skills.

We strongly recommend the use of the Skill Specialization or Advanced Skills rules ([page 96](#)) to add more detail to your science fiction campaign!



Agility Flying

Flying covers maneuvering under on one's own power (such as with wings) or in zero-gravity environments (such as drifting through space in an environmental suit). In science fiction settings, flying is an excellent pull-out as a new skill. Unless you have wings or a natural ability to fly (usually represented by the Flight Talent), you need technology to fly.

As a guideline, with Flying you can:

- Fly a number of meters equal to your Flying Die Code in one round.
- Hover for a number of rounds equal to your Flying Die Code (without a test).

- Perform other tasks as the Gamemaster and player agree upon!
- In combat, Flying can replace your Agility when calculating your Dodge defense (this calculation excludes the Agility die code from the total – no double-dipping.)

Flying generally takes an action to use.



Knowledge

Barter

Barter is a broad skill that covers trade, business, exchanges, and local financial customs, as well as extending to exchange rates, the monetary value of goods and opportunities, and other information regarding economics. It is best to think of Barter as the Scholar skill of making money, spending money, understanding how various economies work, and conducting business.

Barter does not cover religious financial customs like tithing, duties, and similar elements. Depending on your module, that is either covered by the Mysticism: Esoterica skill ([page 66](#)) or Scholar.

Barter generally takes an action to use.

Languages

The Languages skill lets you know, speak, understand, interpret and express knowledge about languages, both living and dead. In a science fiction setting, it is often presumed that all characters speak a common or “trade” language that is a patois of a variety of languages or have access to universal translators and supercomputers that ease the burden of language in communicating on a day to day basis.

The Languages skill represents fluency in the written and spoken tongue beyond that of the common speech.

The Languages skill works very well with the Skill Specialization rules on [page 96](#) to help define and add texture to a setting. Specific languages can be Specializations, and “dead” or exceptionally rare or esoteric languages can become Advanced Skills!

Languages generally does not take an action to use, though if one is doing research or trying to decipher an obscure or lost language, it can!



Perception

Gambling

The gambling skill covers the playing, teaching, learning, understanding, and cheating at games of strategy and luck, as well as assessing risk and reward in dangerous situations where loss can be significant. Successful gambling rolls can increase winnings, while failures can decrease winnings (as determined by the gamemaster based on the scope of the success or failure).

Gambling generally takes an action to use.

Gunnery

The Gunnery skill covers attacking with onboard starship weapons. It always takes an action to use.

Streetwise

The streetwise skill covers finding information, goods, and contacts in large population centers and urban areas. It particularly covers thieves' guilds, organized crime cartels, and similar criminal organizations, black markets, and other illicit operations, as well as contacts. Streetwise can be useful by investigators for determining possible motives and methods of criminals.

Streetwise generally takes an action to use.

Module: Starships & Starship Combat

Starships are an essential component of science fiction stories! This module does require the Mechanical and Technical skill modules to make use of these rules, as well as the optional Science Fiction skills.

Starship Die Codes and Attributes

Starships have four attributes that each have their own die code: Navicomp, the computer that helps the navigator plot interstellar courses; Maneuverability, how responsive and fast in local atmosphere or space the starship is; Engines, how quickly the starship moves outside of interstellar travel; and Hull, how durable and hardy the starship is.

Starships usually don't have skills, though the gamemaster can add "skill specializations" to the die codes of starships (if using the Skill Specializations module).

Additionally, starships will always dictate a Crew number, which tells you the minimum required crew to make the starship work! If you have less than the minimum crew, you suffer the difference in a penalty to your ship related rolls and die codes.

Example: A Crew 3 ship can be piloted by one person, but that person would suffer a -2D penalty on all die codes related to ship tasks (such as navigation, piloting, gunnery, etc).

In addition to their attributes, starships usually have some weapons (with damage die codes), shields (which are starship armor die codes), and other special rules that their crews can take advantage of. Starships are designed to be flexible and easy to use, rather than detailed and granular.

This starship system is a stripped down version of previous D6 System interstellar flight and starship rulesets. Our goal is to create a baseline framework that can be added to, and as such, we've defaulted to the simplest usable form factor for starships (they could have their own book and we'd still not have enough room to create lots of interesting permutations)!

It is broadly similar to and compatible with previous iterations if gamemasters wish to find easy ways to enhance or add complexity to the game.

Navigating and Piloting Starship

When the characters are attempting to fly their starship from one location to another, there are two types of flight: *interstellar* and *local*.

Interstellar flight is done via supercomputers and navigation tools that a normal human character cannot comprehend. This is for long range flights that have so many complicated factors (asteroids, data downloads from nearly infinite flight relay stations, and more) that the human mind cannot process or handle all that data effectively.

Local flight is done via manual controls and piloting, and is often used to avoid harm in combat, make rough landings when systems are down, or other tasks. It is usually handled like any other skill. When rolling *Piloting*, the character making the roll adds the starship's Maneuverability die code as a bonus to their total Piloting die code.

Navigating Between Systems

When the characters want to navigate to a new planet, star system, or location, they must fulfill a few steps. Interstellar flight is risky, and when rushed can be dangerous!

The gamemaster can (of course) allow characters to automatically succeed at the following tests if they are under no stress, pressure or difficulty. For most spacefarers, this sort of work is par for the course. It's only when a ship is damaged, the crew is under pressure, or some other looming threat is complicating factors that rolls really matter!

The goal of these rules is help add interesting friction points to the game, where plot and story can develop, rather than be the focus of the game. Gamemasters should remember to bend these rules to the story at hand, rather than concern themselves with a slavish fidelity to what's been put here.

First, a successful Difficulty 15 Navigation roll is required to input the correct data, parse the results, and program the flight path. The ship's Navicomp die code is added to the Navigation die code of the character making the roll. The Navigation roll takes ten minutes, but can be rushed as a single action (though the Difficulty raises to 25 in that case). If the navigation roll fails, it must be started over (there's no other penalty other than the lost time).

After the successful Navigation roll, a successful Difficulty 15 Computers roll is required to move all that data to the starship and trigger all the various systems and subroutines that are required to take that astronavigational data and turn it into actionable flight! This Computers roll only takes an action, but if it is failed, the entire process must be started again! If the Computers roll has a Mishap (the Wild Die is a '1'), consult the Mishap section below to see what happens!

If both rolls are successful, the ship moves into interstellar travel (regardless of whichever narrative device your science fiction campaign uses)!

Mishaps

If your ship has a mishap while moving into interstellar flight, there's a couple possible outcomes! The gamemaster should select whatever is most interested and appropriate to the narrative at hand, and can (and should) create alternate options based on the campaign setting.

- You make the flight, but are 1d6 days off course and have to manually fly the difference.
- You come out of the interstellar trip at the wrong planet (but similar enough to have made an error during computation).
- Interstellar Collision. Your starship collides with an object (another ship, an asteroid, debris, etc), and sustains damage. Roll a 4D damage roll against the starship (see Starship combat below) and the ship stops its interstellar flight.

Chartering Starships

Characters can hire a starship to ferry them to various locales or distant worlds. They might also hire a ship long term, as a leased based of operations.

Generally, these options are more expensive than commercial liners — some chartered ships charge insane amounts, in addition to supplies, hazard pay, and staffing — a chartered or leased ship generally offers more privacy and more travel freedom for characters. The characters can usually pick the departure and arrival timetable, and they don't necessarily have to go to popular destinations.

The cost of a charter is generally a Profession roll based on the total distance, as determined by the gamemaster.

Starship Combat

For the most part, starship combat happens just like regular combat, and is between a handful of participants (rather than large fleet battles). Use the general combat rules of D6 System: Second Edition, but apply the modifications below to starships.

Ranges:

When starship combat breaks out, first determine if starships are at *long*, *medium*, or *short* range. We recommend long range as a starting place for most combats, but the gamemaster should let the narrative determine.

Movement:

Engines covers movement for starships. When starships declare movement, the pilots say if they are trying to close (move closer to) or withdraw (move away from). All starships in the combat then make an opposed Engines die code roll. The winner achieves their goal (closing to an enemy or moving away from). If a starship is at long range and would withdrawn successfully, they flee the combat.

Starships don't hold still in combat, but if both participants want to maintain or keep the same range, you can simply skip the roll.

For combats with multiple participants, if there are groups or allies, we recommend having each "side" of the combat make their decision as a group with one single roll (the worst Engines die code among them) to see if they resolve their choice successful.

Attacking:

Attacking with a starship is done with the Gunnery skill. Damage is determined by the starship's used weapon die code. Starship weapons often have an attack bonus which is added to the Gunnery skill when rolling starship attacks.

Defending:

Starships don't have a passive Dodge or Parry like characters do. Instead, their Hull determines their Defense (Hull x 5), as well as their ability to resist damage.

Evading:

A pilot can declare they evade. This allows them to roll their Piloting Die code (ignoring the associated Attribute) + the Starships Maneuverability Die Code and add the total to their Defense until the end of the combat round.

Resisting Damage:

Starships resist Damage by rolling Hull + Shields and comparing that to the damage result of the attacking starships weapons.

Vehicle Damage:

Starships take damage the same way characters do, and their damage levels are the same (though your gamemaster might tweak them based on various modules they choose to use). The major difference is that starships don't automatically heal or remove conditions imposed by damage, instead needed to be repaired.

This uses the Repair Mechanical skill and works as follows:

- Difficulty 10 to remove stunned
- Difficulty 15 to remove wounded or incapacitated
- Difficulty 20 to remove mortally wounded

Repair Technical is used to fix particular damaged subsystems or portions of a ship outside of the holistic “keep it moving and functional” repair of Repair Mechanical.

While we use the same terms for vehicles as player characters (for ease of use and communication clarity), you can rename them or find more flavorful terms as you see fit!

STARSHIPS WEAPONS & ARMOR VS. NON-STARSHIPS

Generally speaking, non-starship weapons cannot damage a starship, and non-starship armor cannot be applied against starship weapons. The scale and scope of starship weapons are such as to obliterate terrestrial weapons.

Module: Driving & Vehicles

Vehicles (like starships) are an essential component of science fiction stories! This module does require the Mechanical and Technical skill modules to make use of these rules, as well as the optional Science Fiction skills.

Vehicles Die Codes and Attributes

Vehicles have two attributes: Maneuverability, how responsive and fast the vehicle is; and Hull, how durable and hardy the vehicle is.

Vehicles usually don’t have skills, though the gamemaster can add “skill specializations” to the die codes of Vehicles (if using the Skill Specializations module).

In addition to their attributes, vehicles usually have some weapons (with damage die codes), armor (which functions like character level armor), and other special rules that their crews can take advantage of.

Additionally, vehicles will always dictate a Passenger quantity, which is how many characters a vehicle can carry easily (you can usually cram one or two more past that into the vehicle in a pinch). This capacity never counts the driver of the vehicle.

Keep in mind the rules for vehicles are designed to be flexible and easy to use, rather than detailed and granular.

Like Starships, the Vehicle module is deliberately very light on rules and details and for the same reasons. The Post-Apocalyptic Guide for D6 System: Second Edition will contain more details for advanced and complex vehicle creation and management.

Driving a Vehicle

The Driving skill handles vehicular movement, and the Repair Mechanical skill is used for repairing and maintaining them.

Vehicle Combat

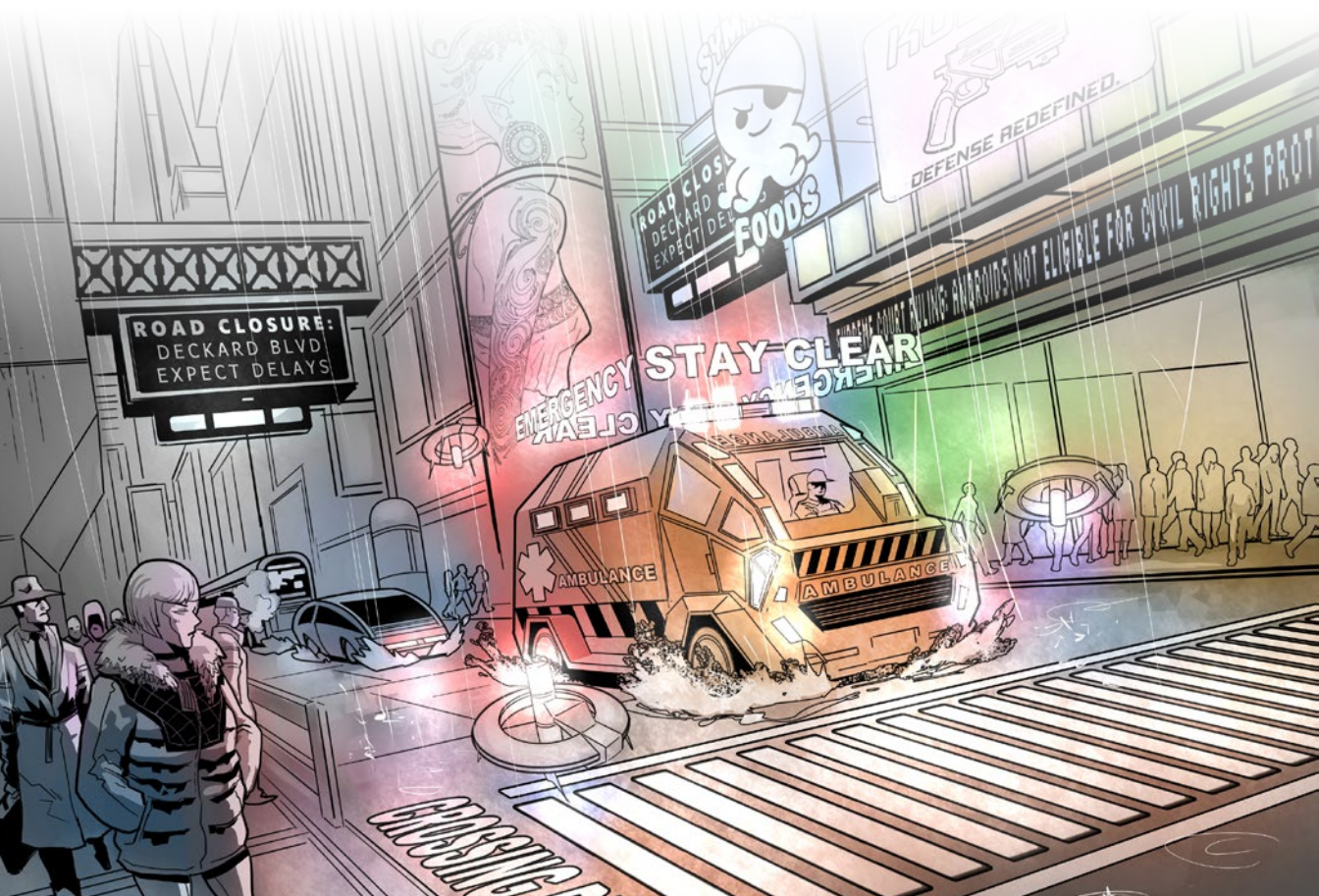
For the most part, vehicle combat happens just like regular combat, and is between a handful of participants (rather than large fleet battles). Use the general combat rules of D6 System: Second Edition, but apply the modifications below to vehicles.

Ranges:

When starship combat breaks out, first determine if starships are at *long*, *medium*, or *short* range. We recommend long range as a starting place for most combats, but the gamemaster should let the narrative determine.

Attacking:

Attacking with vehicular based weapons is done with the Gunnery skill. Damage is determined by the vehicular weapon die code. Vehicular weapons often have an attack bonus which is added to the Gunnery skill when rolling vehicular attacks.



Defending:

Vehicles don't have a passive Dodge or Parry like characters do. Instead, their Hull determines their Defense (Hull x 5), as well as their ability to resist damage.

Evading:

A Driver can declare they evade. This allows them to roll their Driving Die code (ignoring the associated Attribute) + the Vehicles maneuverability Die Code and add the total to their Defense until the end of the combat round.

Resisting Damage:

Vehicles resist Damage by rolling Hull + Armor and comparing that to the damage result of the attacking starships weapons.

VEHICLE WEAPONS & ARMOR VS. NON-VEHICLES

Generally speaking, non-vehicle weapons cannot damage a vehicle, and non-vehicle armor cannot be applied against vehicle weapons. The scale and scope of vehicle weapons are such as to obliterate most easily accessible weapons.

Vehicle Damage:

Vehicles take damage the same way characters do, and their damage levels are the same (though your gamemaster might tweak them based on various modules they choose to use). The major difference is that Vehicles don't automatically heal or remove conditions imposed by damage, instead needed to be repaired.

This uses the Repair Mechanical skill and works as follows:

- Difficulty 10 to remove stunned.
- Difficulty 15 to remove wounded or incapacitated.
- Difficulty 20 to remove mortally wounded.

Repair Technical is used to fix particular damaged subsystems or portions of a ship outside of the holistic “keep it moving and functional” repair of Repair Mechanical.

While we use the same terms for vehicles as player characters (for ease of use and communication clarity), you can rename them or find more flavorful terms as you see fit!

Module: Psionics

The psionics module is compatible with any other module, though care should be taken when combining it with magic modules (the modules can imbalance one another without careful use – as psionics is relatively powerful for little investment).

Psionics represents the art of mental metaphysics, the ability to tap into the innate potential of the self (or the universe at large) and channel that into effects that the average individual cannot achieve. Depending on your campaign, psionics might require special training, an innate talent or more.

Psionic Skills & Training

There are three psionic skills that a character must be trained in if they wish to use psionic powers. If a character has no die code in the requisite skill, they may not use psionic powers. These three skills have no governing or parent attribute, instead being stand-alone skills that form their own die codes.

There are three psionic skills: kinesis, perceive, and reform. Each of these skills governs a particular discipline of psionic powers. Kinesis governs the attempt of psionic powers to effect the external physical world through movement, as well as the movement of the self. Perceive governs understanding and tapping into the internal psionic power of an individual, as well as the external non-physical world (mental, emotional, and more). Reform governs altering, enhancing, adjusting, changing, or destroying physical elements using psionics.

When a character sets out to train in a psionic skill, they must first either find a teacher (perhaps at a psionic institute, academy, or temple) or they must attempt to learn on their own. This can be done three times (once for each skill)

If the character wishes to learn on their own, they must commit one month of downtime and study (wherein they can do nothing else of significance). At the end of that month, they gain 1D in a single psionic skill of their choice.

If the character can find a teacher, the downtime required is only one week, though they will likely be bound by some debt (if you are using Flaws) or other narrative consequence.

Only the first die of a psionic skill die code can be gained this way through study. Future die code increases must be acquired through the advancement module the campaign is using.

Using the Psionic Skills

Each of the psionic skill is its own die code, but they can also be combined when certain powers are used. Psionic skills are rolled just like regular skills (with a wild die and everything).

This combining of multiple skills is not the norm in D6 System: Second Edition, and this is the only module in which it appears. We generally recommend against it, but because psionic skills have no governing attribute, they remain relatively balanced.

Psionic Powers

The psionic powers below are categorized by the skill (or combined skill die code) that is used to activate the power.

It takes an action to use a psionic power (subject to all the normal rules), and each psionic power has a Difficulty that must be achieved to activate the power. Failure to succeed in the skill roll means the action is wasted. If a power has a scaling difficulty (such as growing harder every time a character attempts to benefit from it), the scaling difficulty applies even to unsuccessful attempts to use the power.

A psionic character knows all the powers related to the skills they have die codes in (if a character only has a Kinesis die code, they can only know and use kinesis powers, etc).



Kinesis

ENERGY DEFENSES

- **Difficulty:** Variable; if applied to a weapon, the Difficulty is the Damage roll of the weapon+10, small heat sources (candles, etc) are Difficulty 5, a bonfire or electrical conduit is Difficulty 10, minor radiation or a smelting forge is Difficulty 15, and electrical or radiation storms are Difficulty 20.
- **Effect:** The character negates the impact of energy on themselves to ignore harm. If the Kinesis roll exceeds the Difficulty by 5 or more, the character may also turn off or extinguish the energy source.
- **Special:** This power may be kept up in situations where the energy is continuous. It takes an action (and continual tests) to maintain the power.

HARM

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to benefit from this power in the last 24 hours (cumulative); additional penalties based on the range to the target.
- **Effect:** The character immediately makes a Damage roll against the target using their Kinesis die code.

PHYSICAL ENHANCEMENT

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to benefit from this power in the last 24 hours (cumulative).
- **Effect:** The character gains their Kinesis as a bonus on their next Agility or Brawn die code.

TELEKINESIS

- **Difficulty:** 5 for a small, handheld object under 1 lb; +5 if the target weighs 10 lbs or more; +5 if the target weighs 100 lbs or more; +5 if the target weighs 1000 lbs or more; and +5 for every multiple of 10 after 1000 lbs. These Difficulty modifiers are cumulative (thus a 1,000 lb object would be a Difficulty 20).
- **Effect:** The character can lift, move, levitate, or throw an object with their mental power. When throwing an object, the Damage roll is considered to be equal to the Difficulty of the Telekinesis power activation.
- **Special:** The character can continue to lift or manipulate the object without further **rolls** by maintaining their concentration, but the moment they take an action that requires a die code roll, they immediately lose their concentration and this power ceases.

TRANCE

- **Difficulty:** 20
- **Effect:** The character falls into a trance, wherein it is nearly impossible (Difficulty 25) to tell if they are alive. They consume little energy or food, and add their Perceive die code to any rolls made to resist environmental effects (gas, cold, heat, etc). If attached to a life support system, they could live indefinitely.
- **Special:** When this power is activated, the player must set a trigger event or time frame in which their character will automatically awake. This should

be a relatively unspecific event. “If someone brings a psionic artifact into the chamber I’m in” is sufficient, but a specific artifact would be too detailed. If the character is Wounded while in a trance, they automatically awaken.

Perceive

ENHANCE PERCEPTION

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to benefit from this power in the last 24 hours (cumulative).
- **Effect:** The character adds their Perceive die code to all perception die codes for 10 minutes.

TELEPATHY

- **Difficulty:** 5; +10 if the target is unfriendly, hostile, or Wounded.
- **Effect:** The character must select a living target that they can see. With a success, the character may read the surface thoughts of the target, as well as know and understand what the target is sensing.
- **Special:** If the character exceeds the Difficulty by 10, they may probe deeper and gain insight or information into the subconscious or hidden/repressed thoughts.

SENSE LIVING FORM

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to benefit from this power in the last 24 hours (cumulative).
- **Effect:** The character can sense the presence, rough location (to within 5

yards or so), general emotional state, physical health, and basic identity (gender, species) of any and all living being within 100 yards. Beings with a higher Perceive die code are allowed an opposed roll to avoid detection.

- **Special:** This power may be kept “on” by making a Difficulty 5 roll as an action for as long as the character would like, though it still imposes multi-action penalties.

WITHSTAND HARM

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 to the difficulty if a character is wounded; +5 if the character is incapacitated; +5 if the character is mortally wounded. These increases are cumulative (for a total of Difficulty 20 for a mortally wounded character).
- **Effect:** The character may act as if they are not incapacitated, wounded, or mortally wounded.
- **Special:** Using this power does not impose the multi-action penalty. The character still suffers any die penalties for being harmed or Wounded.

Reform

ENHANCE OTHER:

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to use this power in the last 24 hours.
- **Effect:** The target of this power gains the psionic character’s Reform die code as a bonus to their next die code rolled.
- **Special:** This power may not be used on oneself.

HEALING

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to benefit from this power in the last 24 hours.
- **Effect:** The character may immediately make a Medicine roll (applied to themselves) and adds their Reform die code as a bonus to the Medicine die code (see the Medicine skill on [page 41](#) for Difficulties to remove harm).

PURGE POISON

- **Difficulty:** 5; the gamemaster may add increased Difficulty based on the strength of the poison.
- **Effect:** The character immediately removes and purges all poisons and toxins from their system.

SUGGESTION

- **Difficulty:** opposed by the target's Willpower (or Knowledge if the Charm module is not being used)
- **Effect:** The character imparts a brief and easy to understand suggestion to the target. A simple "look that way" or "you heard a noise over there," a brief aid in disguise that provides a momentary distraction, or similar effect. The target will not risk itself, its life, and if the suggestion is too far outside of the normal or expected, the target will quickly realize what happened.

Kinesis + Perceive

HEAL OTHER

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 for every attempt to benefit from this power in the last 24 hours.
- **Effect:** The character may immediately make a Medicine roll (applied to their target) and adds their Reform die code as a bonus to the Medicine die code (see the Medicine skill on [page 41](#) for Difficulties to remove harm).
- **Special:** This power may not be used on oneself.

PURGE POISON OTHER

- **Difficulty:** 5; the gamemaster may add increased Difficulty based on the strength of the poison.
- **Effect:** The character immediately removes and purges all poisons and toxins from the system of their target
- **Special:** This power may not be used on oneself.

PLACE OTHER IN TRANCE

- **Difficulty:** 20
- **Effect:** The target falls into a trance, as described in the Trance psionic power (see above). All the rules and special rules of the Trance power apply, and the awakening trigger is chosen by the target of this power (not the user - no putting an enemy into a trance with no ability to wake up!)

Kinesis + Reform

CRYOKINESIS

- **Difficulty:** 15
- **Effect:** The character deals a damage roll equal to their Kinesis+Reform die code to a target they can see. This damage is a frozen burst of energy, and any applicable defenses or special abilities that apply to the cold apply to this damage.
- **Special:** This power can also be used to break items or equipment instead of dealing damage.

ELECTROKINESIS

- **Difficulty:** 15
- **Effect:** The character deals a damage roll equal to their Kinesis+Reform die code to a target they can see. This damage is a supercharged burst of electrical, and any applicable defenses or special abilities that apply to electrical energy apply to this damage.
- **Special:** This power can also be used to break items or equipment instead of dealing damage.

PYROKINESIS

- **Difficulty:** 15
- **Effect:** The character deals a damage roll equal to their Kinesis+Reform die code to a target they can see. This damage is a super-heated burst of fiery energy, and any applicable defenses or special abilities that apply to the heat apply to this damage.

- **Special:** This power can also be used to break items or equipment instead of dealing damage.

Perceive + Reform

PRECOGNITION

- **Difficulty:** 15; the gamemaster should apply increased Difficulty based on distance of the location, as well as distance in the timeline.
- **Effect:** The character may view and sense the chosen locale as though they were there in some future point. The future is not locked, and a character should be aware that things will almost certainly not unfold as they viewed them (especially the more far reaching a power is). However, this insight might allow the character to build an effective plan or find a solution for a problem.
- **Special:** A character may maintain this power without rolling as long as they take no other actions or suffer no damage.

POSTCOGNITION

- **Difficulty:** 15; the gamemaster should apply increased Difficulty based on distance of the location, as well as distance in the timeline.
- **Effect:** The character may view and sense the chosen locale as though they were there in some past point.
- **Special:** A character may maintain this power without rolling as long as they take no other actions or suffer no damage.

PROJECTED SELF

- **Difficulty:** 5; +5 if the character is not within sight of their target; +5 if the character is not able to communicate effectively at this time (bound and gagged, etc), +5 if the target of this power is unwilling or resistant. These Difficulty modifiers are cumulative.
- **Effect:** The character may reach out and appear as a wavering, ghostly figure (akin to a distorted hologram or hallucination), and communicate with the target of this power as though they were in the vicinity of the target. Any standard hurdles to communication (language, etc), must be overcome normally. The projecting character has

no sensory input other than what is required to communicate.

- **Special:** A character may maintain this power without rolling as long as they take no other actions or suffer no damage.

FARSIGHT

- **Difficulty:** 5; the gamemaster should apply increased Difficulty based on distance.
- **Effect:** The character may view and sense the chosen locale as though they were there.
- **Special:** A character may maintain this power without rolling as long as they take no other actions or suffer no damage.

These are just a sample of possible powers that psionic characters might have. Science fiction is replete with ideas, and gamemasters should use the idea of the three psionic skills to craft new and interesting powers for their campaign!



Module: Cyberpunk

Hacking

Hacking is the most complex of any cyberpunk genre ruleset, and has the potential to bog down games if not handled carefully. We've elected to present a simple, straightforward take on hacking that leverages the basic skill rules of the game to keep it as consistent as possible.

The hacking as presented here is very cinematic and not very realistic. It doesn't deal with programs, AR or VR, malware, and how or where you might jack in. Like a majority of the pulp feel of D6 System: Second Edition, hacking is designed to be resolved in a single roll or two, and fit the feel of a movie or pulp adventure!

The gamemaster's campaign might require more intricacies or details around hacking (such as prerequisite equipment, using skill specializations or advanced skills).

Computers

The default skill used to hack something is the Computers skill (see the Technical Attribute module on [page 66](#)).

Firewall

Firewall simply refers to the Difficulty of the Computers roll. If a skill roll is successful against this difficulty, the hacker is said to have "bypassed the firewall." Sample firewalls are given on the table.

If the hacker fails the attempt to hack the firewall, there might be consequences! If the Computers roll to hack failed by a difference of five or more, the gamemaster should roll a d6. The gamemaster then adds the difference between the Computers roll and the Difficulty to the d6 roll and consults the outcome below.

Firewall Quality	Difficulty
Cheap	5
Basic	10
Consumer Grade	15
Basic Corporate	20
Advanced Corporate	25
Top-shelf Corporate	30
Cutting Edge Corporate	35
Firewall	Variable, see below

Example: A character fails to hack a firewall by 8 (they rolled a 12 against a 20). The gamemaster would roll a d6 and add +8 to it, then consult the outcome below.

- If the result is 10 or greater, the hacking attempt is noticed and the target of the hacking attempt will attempt to figure out who was behind the hacking attempt.
 - This usually involves an enemy hacker attempting to track the character down.
- If the result is 20 or greater, the identity of the attempted hacker is known, and the entity will take action against the would-be hacker.
 - Depending on where or what the target was, this might be light consequences or more severe ones (like a remote drone strike to kill the hacker).

Starting Firewalls

Generally everything has a firewall in a cyberpunk setting (usually a baseline of ten, though poor, cheap, or faulty equipment might be a five).

- For Robots, drones, or other autonomous entities, either assign a default firewall based on the narrative and who built or controls the drone and robot, or set their Firewall to their Knowledge or Technical attribute x5.
- For player characters, their default Firewall is their Technical attribute x5.

Player character firewalls functionally work like another passive defense. If you want to modify or change it to a different attribute or skill, it's easily enough to set something new!

Alternatively, if you are adding new skills, a Firewall skill might be an excellent choice. In this case, you might want to make all hacking rolls opposed, though you will have to consider how to handle cyberware in this situation (we recommend sticking to the default to reward those who invest in their cyberware).

Successful Hacks

Upon a successful hack, the hacker can usually choose one of the options below. The gamemaster is free to add new options based on the campaign at hand, and players should propose outcomes or effects they want. Generally an outcome of a hack is something that can be resolved in a single action.

- Operate a piece of equipment or technology (a door opens or closes, a lock engages or disengages, a security system loops or shuts down, etc).
- Fry a piece of equipment, ruining it. The higher quality the piece of equipment is, the less likely this option is to be available.
- Gain an insight or information they were looking for (data, code, hidden files, etc).
- Cause a misdirection or insert a bad piece of information into the target's system.



Hacking Cyberware

The Firewall of cyberware is the Rank of the cyberware (see below) times 5. On a success, the hacker can choose one of the three options below:

- Disable or turn off the cyberware for a number of turns equal to the hacker's Computers die code.
- Fry or explode the cyberware (this results in a 2D damage roll against the user of the cyberware)
- Gain insight or data (such as sensory data) from the cyberwear.

Defending Against Hacking

As an action, a character who is concerned they might be hacked can choose to harden their firewall. If they do, they add +5 to the Difficulty of hacking attempts targeted at them until the end of their next turn.

Cyberware

Cyberware requires the use of the Perks, Flaws, and Talents module, and is a modifier that adjusts those perks, talents and flaws. You can also include the superpower talents on [page 212](#) to add additional options for cyberware.

When selecting a talent, the character can declare it is cybernetic or cyberware. This makes the talent derive from an artificial limb or organ. As a cybernetic improvement is impossible to accidentally drop or remove, this modification to talents doesn't adjust their cost. The cyberware is generally "always on," though sometimes an action must be spent to activate or use it (simply follow the rules for the talent on that front).

In many cyberpunk and science fiction settings, mechanical implants exist as the most common means for a standard human (and possibly some other species of the gamemaster's devising) to gain Talents.

Characters may take multiple cyberware (each time they take a talent they may decide), but there are two limits to consider.

First, a character can only have a number of cybernetic talents equal to their Knowledge, or else the mental load of controlling and supporting that much technology overloads the character and they cease to function.

If you want to include bioware (flesh-based genetic augments), you can simply use cyberware and reskin the theme. If you do, tie the bioware to BRAWN rather than KNOWLEDGE.

Secondly, cyberware can be hacked (see above). While it has no inherent drawbacks, there are risky penalties when dealing with cyberware and hackers!

Installing Cyberware

Installing cyberware is both painful and expensive! It takes a successful **medicine** skill check to install cyberware into a character. The base difficulty of this medicine roll is 10, with an additional +5 applied to the difficulty for each previous piece of cyberware the character has (keep in mind the limit of cyberware/cybernetics when compared to Knowledge).

When cyberware is installed, a character must take at least an hour of downtime (+30 minutes per +5 applied to the installation difficulty).

Example: If Trav already has two pieces of cyberware and has a third installed, the difficulty of the medicine roll is 20 (10+5+5) and it would take two hours (1 hour + 30 minutes + 30 minutes).

Failure on the medicine roll to install has no drawbacks other than the lost time. However, if the Wild Die is a '1' on the roll, the character must make a Brawn roll to resist damage (the Damage TN is equal to the difficulty of the installation). Failure means they suffer effects as if they were just injured and the cyberware parts are wasted.

Cost of Cyberware

Because D6 System: Second Edition doesn't deal with currency it can be difficult to assess a cost for cyberware! We recommend two methods:

First, using the Profession roll rules ([page 80](#)) the difficulty of acquiring the cyberware is equal to the rank of the talent the cyberware imparts times five ($R\# \times 5$) + 5. This means a R3 benefit would be a Profession roll difficulty of 20.

Alternatively, if you are using a currency in your campaign, we recommend that a rough base of 1,000 "credits" (or whatever you name your currency) per rank of the cyberware be applied as a cost.

D6 System: Second Edition doesn't deal with the negative impacts of cyberware. We consider that a campaign specific concern based on the style of cyberpunk campaign the gamemaster is running. If you are intending to use rules like that, we recommend taking a look at Flaws as a potential outcome of overloading on cyberware!

Module: Scale

In many genres, but especially science fiction, vehicles, creatures, or other elements might be at a significantly varied scale in size to each other. The follow rules are there to allow for bonuses and hinderances in combat based on the relative scale of participants.

The table presumes that most humanoid beings are roughly comparative in size and scale where game rules might matter. As we implemented it, scale only starts to apply once you are significantly larger than a human. If you want to include steps for beings significantly smaller than human-sized, you can easily add your own.

Additionally, you can always add or insert new categories if you want more granularity into the game.

When dealing damage to a smaller target, or resisting the damage inflicted by a smaller target, the larger participant adds the scale bonuses to their damage die code and their Brawn role to resist damage.

When a smaller target is evading an attack or attacking a larger target, the scale bonuses is applied to their Dodge (not Parry) defense and their die codes used to attack.

The examples listed in the table are generalized to indicate the varied scales. The gamemaster will need to consider the various examples as guidelines based on the nature of their campaign.

Size	Attack, Damage, or Brawn Bonus	Dodge bonus	Scale Rank
Human	+0D	+0	0
Horse, speeder, car, small dragon, power armor	+1D	+3	1
Medium dragon, tank, bus, personal spacecraft	+2D	+6	2
Mecha, fighter, light freighter, large personnel carrier, large dragon, giant	+3D	+9	3
Heavy fighter, heavy freighter, giant personnel carrier, huge giant, large mecha, colossus, monolith	+4D	+12	4
Capital ship, space station, asteroids or small moons	+5D	+15	5
Super space station, carrier ships, larger moons	+6D	+18	6

The scale rank a tool communicate the scale differences in stat blocks, adventures rules, or anywhere else it can crop up. Scale rank has no rules effect, but we might say something like “this starship is scale rank 3” to indicate rough sizing and how the scale interacts with the game rules.



Module: Science Fiction Bestiary

Many of the enemies you might want in a science fiction world can be found in the Module: General Foes & Bestiary. Thieves, assassins, and more are all there, just waiting for you to adjust and tweak them to fit your setting.

What we present here is a limited selection of new creatures that will fit in a science fiction setting, though, enterprising gamemasters will find ways to use them for aliens in superhero or fantasy games and other settings.

Modifying these enemies is easy to do when using the Perks, Flaws, or Talents Module, or any additional Attributes the gamemaster might wish to apply. Oftentimes a Generic Character template or a creature from the bestiary with a few Perks, Flaws, or Talents, adjusted skills, or tweaked attributes will make enough a difference to establish their own identity.

One of the great benefits of the D6 system is how easily one can tweak all these details with minimal effort!

For significant or campaign level foes, we recommend you use the a la carte or template rules and create those bespoke foes yourself.

When crafting those enemies, for each player in your campaign, we'd recommend you consider adding +3D to attributes and +3D to skills (just to keep it even, or they'll be outnumbered)!

If you are crafting your own monsters, we recommended 1D-2D in attributes for creatures less powerful than players' characters, 2D-3D for as powerful, and 4D or more for more powerful; skills are generally 1D-4D above base attribute if you feel you need skills!

Hacker

Dodge 20 **Parry** 10

Agility Skills 2D

Brawn Skills 2D

Knowledge 4D

Perception 4D

Technical 4D

- Computers 3D

SPECIAL:

You might need to give the hacker a weapon or cyberware, though this profile does not include those, as it represents more of a computer technician than a combat hacker.

Killer Robot

Dodge 15 **Parry** 20

Agility Skills 4D

- Shooting 2D
- Melee 2D

Brawn Skills 3D

- Intimidation 3D
- Stamina 3D

Knowledge 2D

- Languages 1D

Perception 3D

- Driving (or Piloting) 1D
- Survival 1D

Damage: Choose one scifi ranged weapon and one scifi ranged weapon.

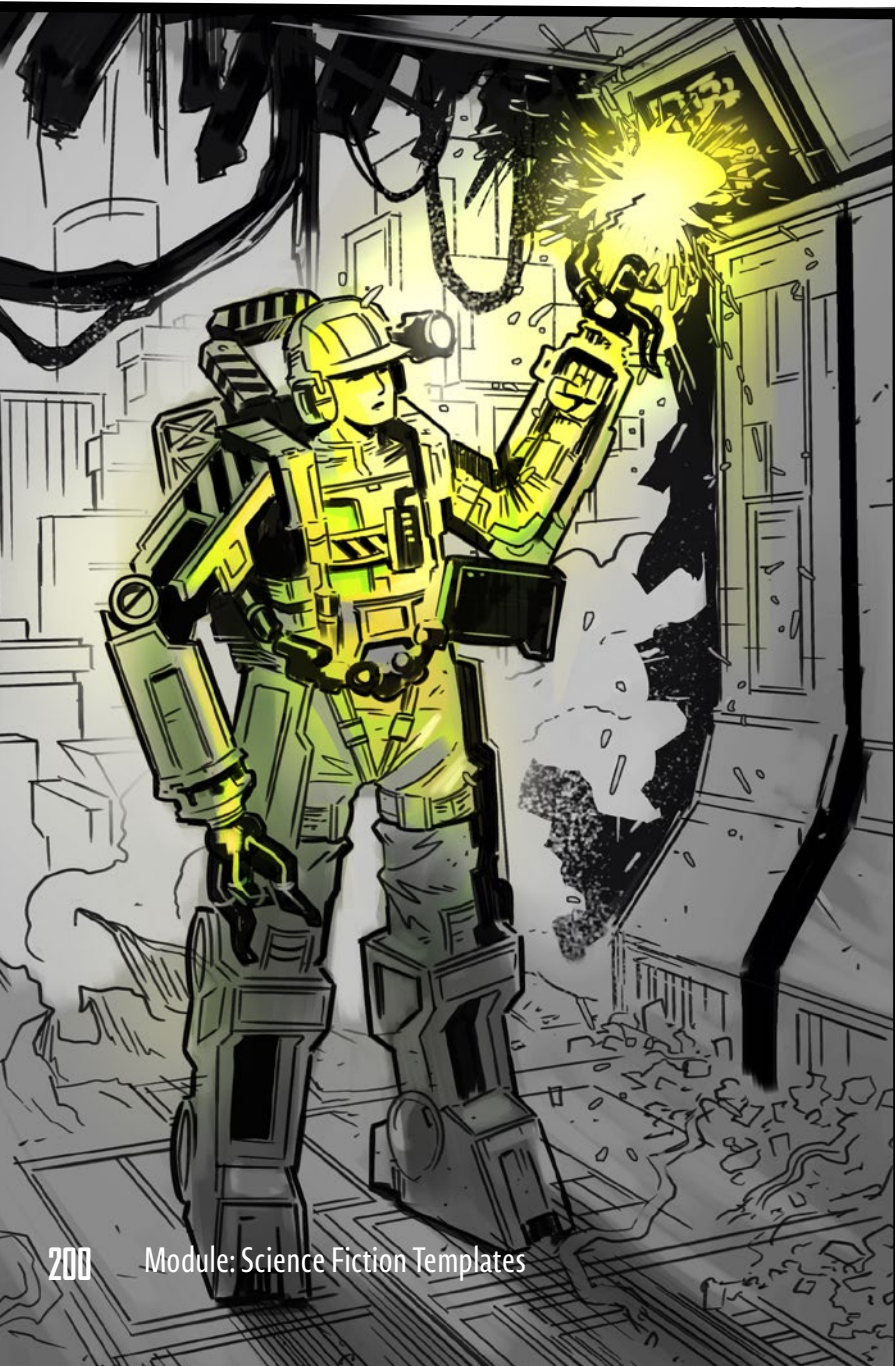
SPECIAL

Robot: A robot is not a living being, instead being a digital and mechanical marvel. It does not heal normally, instead requiring rolls to be made to repair it (Use/Repair Technical due to the complexity of the Robot). If you are using hacking rules, this robot has a Firewall of 10

Science Fiction Templates

The science fiction module templates make use of the Additional Attributes: Charm, Mechanical, and Technical.

To that end, we recommend you add +3D to the total starting dice you can assign to the skills of these templates (for a total of 10D). We've already added +6 bonus attribute dice to account for the three new attributes (for a total of 21D in attributes).



Engineer

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 2D

Knowledge: 4D

Mechanical: 5D

Perception: 3D

Technical: 2D

DEFENSES

• Dodge: 15

• Parry: 15

Recommended Skills:

Communications,
Navigation,
Piloting, Use/
Repair Mechanical

Gunslinger

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 5D

Brawn: 4D

Charm: 3D

Knowledge: 2D

Mechanical: 2D

Perception: 3D

Technical: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 25

Recommended Skills: Intimidation, Shooting, Sleight of Hand, Stealth

Hacker

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 2D

Knowledge: 5D

Mechanical: 1D

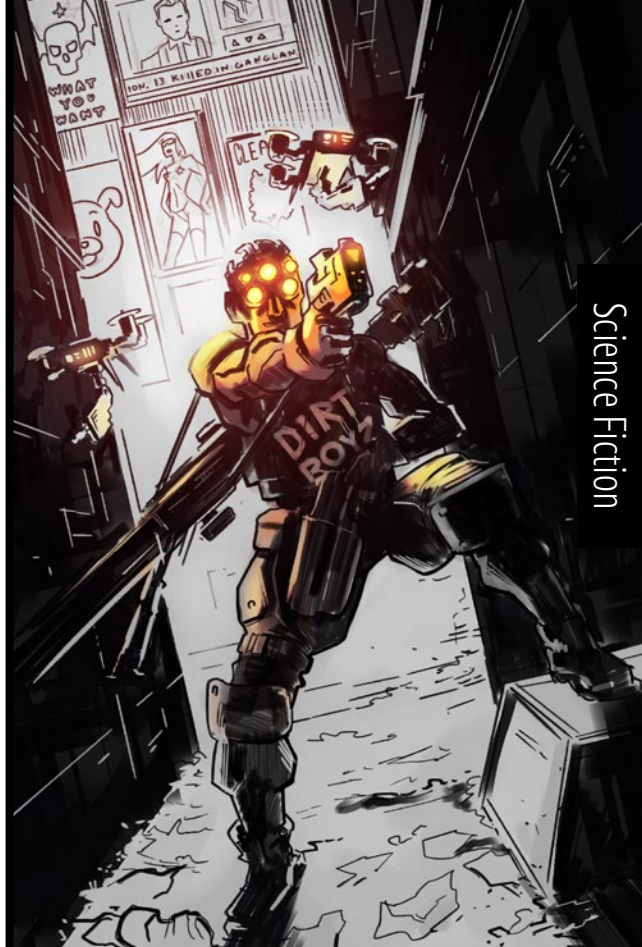
Perception: 3D

Technical: 5D

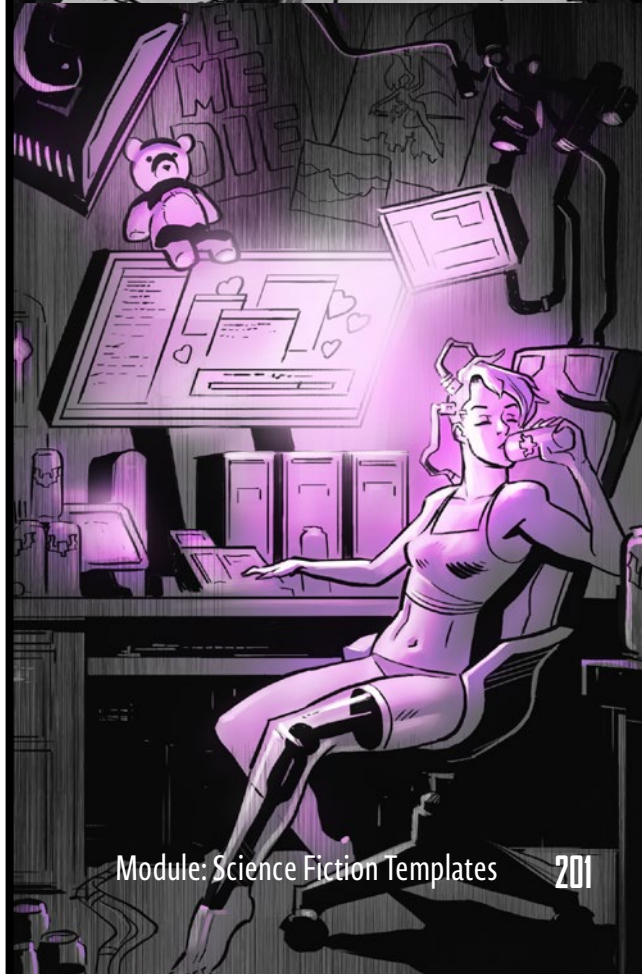
DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 15

Recommended Skills: Computers, Sciences, Use/Repair Technical, Upgrade



Science Fiction





Medic

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 2D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 4D

Knowledge: 5D

Mechanical: 3D

Perception: 2D

Technical: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 10

- Parry: 10

Recommended Skills: Medicine, Sciences, Use/Repair Mechanical, Use/Repair Technical



FIGHTER

Scale: 2

Maneuverability: 5

Engines: 5

Hull: 2

Defense:

- Crew: 1
- Weapons: Laser Cannons 3D
- Shields: Light Shields 2D

CARGO TRANSPORT

Scale: 3

Maneuverability: 3

Engines: 3

Hull: 6

Defense:

- Crew: 2
- Weapons: Light Laser Cannons 2D
- Shields: Heavy Shields 4D

SMUGGLER TRANSPORT

Scale: 4

Maneuverability: 4

Engines: 4

Hull: 4

Defense: 20

- Crew: 4
- Weapons: Light Laser Cannons 2D
- Shields: Heavy Shields 4D

CAPITAL SHIP

Scale: 5

Maneuverability: 1

Engines: 4

Hull: 7

Defense:

- Crew: 25
- Weapons: Heavy Laser Cannons 4D
- Shields: Heavy Shields 4D

Superheroes



These rules cover superheroes, from the classic four-color paragons of goodness to the grim and dark Iron Age heroes who were soaked in blood while wearing pouches galore.

Many stories, especially roleplaying game campaigns, are a mishmash of multiple genres, but no so more than superheroic stories. Fantasy, horror, science fiction, adventure, romance, and more genres all bleed into a melting pot of stories that are a mix of the various flavors.

Module: Superheroic Skills

You do not (and should not) need to apply all of them to your campaign, but instead, should select and choose a select number for each attribute to add.

When you add more skills to the game, be sure to decide if you are integrating the following modules:

- Skill Specializations and Advanced Skills
- Perks, Flaws, and Talents
- Additional Attributes

When adding skills, we recommend that you consider giving +1D for skills during character creation for every *three* skills you add to the game over the core skills. This is a loose benchmark, and you might find that a different ratio works better at your table.

Make sure you are familiar with the module you are adding, and decide how you will integrate any rules: for example, will any new skills be advanced skills or specializations? Do you need to add any skills to use particular talents or perks?

Limited Focus Skills & Adjusting Existing Skills

There will be times that you might want to create a new skill that is covered by another skill, because you want a particular focus in that skill for your game. A good example of this is swimming. Normally covered by the Athletics skill, if the gamemaster decides that in their piracy and sailing campaign, they'd like a greater emphasis on swimming, they could pull it out and create a new swimming skill that is divorced from the traditional Athletic skill.

Doing so allows the gamemaster to add some skill focus without leaning into the whole Skill Specializations and Advanced Skills Module (which they might feel are unsuitable).

We don't cover those particular use cases in this section, but be aware they do exist.



Agility Flying

Flying covers maneuvering under on one's own power (such as with wings) or in zero-gravity environments (such as drifting through space in an environmental suit). In science fiction settings, flying is an excellent pull-out as a new skill. Unless you have wings or a natural ability to fly (usually represented by the Flight Talent), you need technology to fly.

As a guideline, with Flying you can:

- Fly a number of meters equal to your Flying Die Code in one round.
- Hover for a number of rounds equal to your Flying Die Code (without a test).
- Perform other tasks as the Gamemaster and player agree upon!
- In combat, Flying can replace your Agility when calculating your Dodge defense (this calculation excludes the Agility die code from the total - no double-dipping.)

Flying generally takes an action to use.



Perception Gambling

The gambling skill covers the playing, teaching, learning, understanding, and cheating at games of strategy and luck, as well as assessing risk and reward in dangerous situations where loss can be significant. Successful gambling rolls can increase winnings, while failures can decrease winnings (as determined by the gamemaster based on the scope of the success or failure).

Gambling generally takes an action to use.

Streetwise

The streetwise skill covers finding information, goods, and contacts in large population centers and urban areas. It particularly covers thieves' guilds, organized crime cartels, and similar criminal organizations, black markets, and other illicit operations, as well as contacts. Streetwise can be useful by investigators for determining possible motives and methods of criminals.

Streetwise generally takes an action to use.

Module: “Superheroic” Hero Points

This modular option exists inside the superhero module collection. This module works with any of the Wild Die variants we include in the book.

It also works with Troubles and Assets, as well as some new Superheroic Troubles and Assets (secret identities and the like). This module allows you to spend Hero Points to trigger “kicker” effects on your superpowers (think of it like extra efforts).

If you want, it can also be combined with any of the previous Hero Point options (though that becomes powerful and can have a game-warping impact)!

Superheroic Hero Points

Superheroes begin with 3 hero points.

When using a Hero Point, the following rules and options apply when the hero point is spent:

- The character may take an additional action that does not apply the multi-action penalty.
- The character may count a used Talent or Superpower Talent as one Rank higher than it is.
- The character may give a hero point to an ally who has less than three hero points.
- The character may ignore a capped die code (if you are using the Capping Die Codes module). This allows them to roll more than the normal amount of dice.



Module: Capping Die Codes

In campaigns, characters can escalate quickly in terms of how they accumulate die code bonuses, either through perks, talents, experience, or other means. Gamemasters might wish to cap the maximum die code that a character can have (keep in mind that a cap exists during character creation, but otherwise, no cap exists).

The following guidelines exist to model various superheroic genres, but gamemasters can apply them however they wish. These are loose benchmarks, intended to apply more towards a general “practice” and the gamemaster should tweak or adjust. Clever players will often find ways to mitigate the limits on die codes (which is very in genre, and as such, not a problem)!

We use a term called “Total Die Code Cap,” which essentially means that “no matter what, a player cannot roll more than X dice as part of a single die code.” Regardless of where the bonus comes from, a player cannot roll more than the indicated dice as part of any single roll a character makes.

Power Level	Total Die Code Cap
Young Heroes	10D
Street Level	12D
Standard Hero	15D
National Heroic Team	18D
Worldwide Heroic Team	24D
Galactic & Cosmic Heroes	30D

Die code caps do not apply to enemies, monsters, foes, or gamemaster created villains or characters (though heroic or allied characters should use the same rules). Because these enemies often outstrip player characters in order to provide a challenge, the die code cap cannot be applied to them.

Module: Secret Identities

Alternate and secret identities play a very important role in superheroic stories. Due to ongoing efforts of heroes to stymie evil, there is a constant effort to identify and persecute those who stand up to oppression and fight corruption. However, it is exceedingly difficult to function properly to protect the people and stay ahead of your enemies without a way to move among them.

This is where secret identities come in. Many superheroes have some sort of secret identity. This may be a foppish version of one’s normal identity, like a playboy millionaire overcompensating to hide their nighttime vigilantism. Or a secret life, such as a librarian who is a mystical keeper and guardian of arcane knowledge... It may even be a duplicitous version of another identity! The exact

method and form this secret identity takes is up to the character's player, but the mechanics involving this remain the same.

Each secret identity is given a special resource that can be drawn from when acting in their “true” self. This takes the form of secrets, information, covertly gained support, or simply ample time to prepare and recuperate that the double life provides. These resources are recharged by acting in your “secret ID,” gathering information, allaying fears you’re actually a hero, or otherwise acting as a part of the status quo.

Defining Secret Identity

A character's secret identity should include a brief description of the character's identities and what they are known for. This helps determine when a character is acting according to their heroic or secret identities during play.

Using a Secret Identity

Characters seeming to be part of or supporting corrupt leaders and other enemies of the people often gain information and advantages their heroic personas can exploit and use. In addition, witnessing the oppression or abuse of others and being forced to play along until the time is right increases a hero's passion and drive when the time comes to strike. This group of advantages is represented by a pool of Hero Points tied to the character's secret identity they may use in play.

A secret identity begins with 1 Hero Point, which can be spent in any way that can be justified as somehow related to the character's secret identity and the benefits it provides. These points are gone once used, but they can be restored by reinforcing your secret identity through roleplaying.

Reinforcing Your Identity

Reinforcing a secret identity gives the hero resolve and also keeps their enemies off their trail. By acting according to one's secret identity, they provide new opportunities, gain useful information, and throw opponents off their game.

Each time a character acts in a scene to reinforce their secret identity, they gain 1 Hero Point for their identity. Up to 3 Hero Points may be banked in this fashion at one time. To gain a Hero Point in this fashion, the character must take a prominent and active role in convincing others they are how their secret identity presents them.

Often a character must act against their true nature, even to the point of praising or supporting their true enemies or acting unmoved by injustice. This may result in poor reactions toward their secret identity by other virtuous characters—this is the price paid for protecting one’s identity.

However, while reinforcing one’s identity is not meant to be easy, it should be entertaining. Gamemasters should avoid placing players in situations they won’t enjoy playing the fop, conspirator, apathetic observer, or corrupt accomplice.

Suspicion

Pushing an identity too far increases the risk of discovery and persecution, represented by a trait known as Suspicion. Suspicion is acquired through heroic but revealing actions **while in a secret identity**. Characters with low Suspicion are seen as safe and content members of society who can be trusted to support the abuse and corruption their heroic selves oppose.

Raising Suspicion

Outwardly heroic actions that undermine villains and their plans, benefit those oppressed or harmed by evil, and actively fight corruption all raise Suspicion.

Examples Include:

- Directly intervening to stop an abuse of power.
- Vocally criticizing those in power at society functions.
- Displaying your powers while in a secret identity.

Note that increasing Suspicion requires new actions. A character who raises suspicion by feeding the poor may be repeatedly criticized if they continue to do so, but it is accepted as a soft spot or quirk and won’t necessarily raise Suspicion further. It may even be praised in subtly condescending ways, though it surely alerts those in power the character might not be good to recruit for an evil society!

Suspicion is also raised by clues. When in need of a Hero Point, the character may acquire one by revealing a clue as to their true self. The character must explain what clue has been revealed and how and raise their Suspicion by 1.

Testing Suspicion

Each time Suspicion is gained, roll a d6. If the number rolled is equal to or less than the current Suspicion, the character is Exposed. An Exposed character is not immediately unmasked or uncovered, but they will be soon.

Being Exposed

Secret identities are great resources, at least until they are Exposed. If a character's double life is revealed, they will find themselves hunted and hounded by the authorities, driven out of society, and otherwise endangered. They lose access to their Secret Identity and its benefits and are seen as a suspected outlaw or enemy of the state. They may be locked up, questioned, or otherwise persecuted unless they flee or go into hiding.

However, all is not lost. When this occurs, there are two options: go public or clear your name.

Go Public

If a character is done with their secret identity, they may simply do away with it. This likely results on them being persecuted or targeted by some enemy of their heroic self, but this method has its advantages. For one, the people now know the character's secret and actively admire them openly. This raises their Reputation (see Reputation).

However, once a character truly goes public that's it. No more secret identities unless extreme care and methods are taken to build a new one later. This could be the product of an entire campaign arc, as a character may have to fake their own death, go underground, or otherwise fade from notice only to return later with a new secret identity.

Clear Your Name

A character may try to defuse or refute the evidence that exposes them. This involves an adventure or subplot to produce counter-evidence and convince those in power it is the truth. If this is successful, your Suspicion is reset to 0. The GM sets the terms of what needs to be done to clear your name, but it usually involves some ploy or deception that "proves" the character cannot be the masked hero, secret operative, or dissident sympathizer they are believed to be. Some examples include:

- Appearing in the same place at the same time as your other self (clones, disguises, holograms, robots, and more).
- Appearing in another place at the same time as your other self with the right witnesses.
- Acting or seeming to act against your true self's nature—this must be a drastic departure to be convincing.
- Producing evidence from a superior authority that clears your name.

Clearing one's name should always be a tense and active affair, worthy of its own scenes, adventures, and plots.

Allaying Suspicion

A character may also reduce Suspicion before they are Exposed. After each adventure a character completes without raising any Suspicion, roll a Wild Die. If a 6 is rolled, lower Suspicion by 1 and roll again. If another 6 is rolled, reduce Suspicion by an additional 1 and roll again. Continue this process until anything but a 6 is rolled.

ALTERNATE EXPOSURE

Being Exposed doesn't always mean a character's enemies have figured out everything about them; it simply means they are in danger of being charged with sedition, treason, having a villain target their secret lives, hunted for by government agents, or other drawbacks. A masked hero might be arrested because they are believed to be an accomplice to their heroic identity. A double agent might be targeted for being too compassionate or sentimental to be of further use. GMs and players are encouraged to bend and expand the concept of being Exposed to create new and interesting roleplaying scenarios.

Module: Superpowers

Superpowers are a form of talent that is more extreme in its realistic application. Rules-wise, superhero talents function like regular talents for most rules interactions (and can easily be treated like talents in a fantasy or science fiction game where you want to).

Power Level	Superpower Dice
Young Heroes	8D
Street Level	10D
Standard Hero	12D
National Heroic Team	16D
Worldwide Heroic Team	20D
Galactic & Cosmic Heroes	24D

In a superhero game, the gamemaster should set aside dice for superpower talents during character creation. Non-powered characters (whose without superpowers) can spend those bonus on regular Perks and Talents (or use Superpowers and represent them as “super-science” or

magic – see Superpower Talent Enhancements under Gadgets & Gear).

If characters wish to gain magic, psionics, or a different module, with gamemaster approval, they can use these superpower dice to purchase those as well!

It should be made absolutely clear that our intent is that these superpower talents are intended to be combined with various Magic modules, Psionics, and Cybernetics with the superpower selection creates a very robust selection of customizable powers that one can use or create!

These are just the talents that are “superpowers.” Magicians, cyborgs, aliens, and more all fit in, and these are part of the tool kit to create and craft them.

Before allowing players to create characters with Superpower Talents, the gamemaster may wish to peruse this list to see if there are any they would prefer not to appear in their games. They may also decide that certain superpowers require specific Limitations on them or Flaws on the character.

Any Talent that gives a bonus to the die roll or the skill total also allows the character to use that skill as if trained. Bonuses received from taking multiple ranks of the same Talent are added together.

Some Talents grant new skills that don’t exist anywhere else. Those skills gained with a Talent are not improved when that Talent is improved. Instead, they are increased as a normal skill.

Unless stated otherwise in the Talent, it does not count as an action for the character to get the bonus from a Talent. However, except for such automatic abilities like Combat Sense, the character must state that they are relying on the Talent or they do not receive the bonus.

At times, a Talent might seem applicable to the situation, but the rules don’t apply clearly or cleanly. In this case, the gamemaster will make the final decision (we encourage a wider narrative interpretation of Talents).

Some Talents can only be acquired once while some can be acquired multiple times. If a Talent can be acquired multiple times, their cost per rank is called out.

Many of these Talents are familiar (in name) to previous D6 System players. However, the rules have changed, and they are classified in D6 System: Second Edition as “Superpower Talents.” This decision was made because we felt that keeping the various modules similar mechanically would allow for the most flexible combinations for players and gamemasters as they use the toolkit to craft their own worlds.

For the most part, the difference between talents and superpower talents that of “genre” or “realism,” rather than mechanical, and as such, if you wish to use these talents in any other genre (for fantasy character archetypes, aliens, mutated horrors), you can!

Accelerated Healing (4)

When the character has the Medicine skill performed on them (with regards to healing or removing conditions), the Medicine die code gains +3D. If a roll is made without the medicine skill for whatever reason, the bonus still applies.

At the **end** of their turn, if the character is *incapacitated* or *wounded*, they can make a Brawn roll (with the +3D bonus) against a Difficulty of 20. If they are successful, they can downgrade their incapacitated to wounded, or their wounded to stunned.

If you are using Wild Die rules that might impose a penalty on a result of '1', the character also ignores results of '1' if those impose a further penalty when being healed or healing naturally.

Animal Control (3 per rank)

This gives the character the ability to control one particular species of animal, bird, or insect. The character gets a +3D bonus to their survival die code when rolling to handle that species. They must make a Survival roll versus the Knowledge of the animal (more than one animal can be targeted, although this is a multi-action).

If the character gets a high enough success (gamemaster's decision), the animal will follow reasonable orders and capabilities (for its species) for a number of minutes equal to the character's survival die code x10. A controlled animal serves its master faithfully, even sacrificing itself on

their behalf. This superpower talent has a range of sight or voice.

The character may gain one more species for each rank they take in this talent.

Note: A swarm of insects counts as one animal, as does a school of small fish. Any creature with a Knowledge die code of less than 2D could be considered an animal, unless the gamemaster says otherwise. This includes human (making this a mind control power) at the gamemaster discretion.

We recommend considering how you use mind control on sentient and living beings carefully. It's a complicated power fraught with ethical concerns, and heroes who use it will likely face questions and condemnations over it.

Armor Piercing Attack (2 per rank)

When a character with natural weapons (the character's fists, claws, teeth, etc.) attacks someone or something protected by armor, this ability negates the Armor's bonus to rolls to resist damage, up to negating +1D per rank of this Talent.

The character must specify how the attack negates the armor: an spit acid spray slips through any openings, nanotech claws punch directly to the flesh, and the like.

Additionally, the character should define at least one type of armor that is unaffected by this attack.

As an option, this talent can be combined with natural ranged weapons.

Atmospheric Tolerance (2)

The character can breathe one form of atmosphere (gas or liquid) that would be lethal to most other characters.

A character may not have more than one rank in this ability, but they may have different versions for different atmospheres.

Attack Resistance (2)

The character is highly resistant to a certain type of attack. They gain +1D per rank when rolling to resist damage against this type of attack. This bonus is not an armor die code, but rather a general bonus.

- **Energy Attacks:** Resistant to blasts of heat, fire, electricity, radiation, light, cold, and so on, but not the ability to survive in extremes of such environments.
- **Mystical Attack:** Resistant to damage from any magic or mysticism based attacks.
- **Mental Attacks:** Resistant to mental harm from any source. It does not provide protection against interaction attempts or normal social situations or manipulations.

Note that physical attacks are covered by armor (or the natural armor superpower talent), not this superpower talent.

Blur (3)

The character can appear indistinct to the naked eye or most standard technological or mechanical visual aids (binoculars, cameras, etc.). Commonly, a character with this Talent will only be spotted out of the corner of the eye.

On the character's turn, they may automatically become blurry, without taking an action, and remain so until they chooses otherwise. Blurring makes it difficult for the character to hold a conversation with others (they suffer a -1D penalty on all die codes in social situations while blurry).

While blurred, the character adds +1 to their Dodge and Parry defense totals, as well imposes a -1D penalty on Perception based die codes made against the character (while blurry).

Confusion (4 per rank)

The character can hamper the thoughts of those they comes into physical contact with, at will. They gain the confuse skill at +1D per rank (it is a Perception skill, described only here), which they can increase as normal based on the advancement module used.

As a multi-action with an unarmed or natural weapon attack, the character may also perform a confusion attack. This is opposed by the target's Knowledge (or Willpower if using the Charm Attribute module)

If the character's total is higher (not equal to), the target is confused.

Confused characters may not spend hero points, suffer a -1D penalty on all die codes, and cannot use abilities that grant rerolls for a number of rounds equal to two times the rank of this Talent or until they suffer the wounded or incapacitated condition (at which point the confusion fades as pain sets in).

Darkness (3 per rank)

As an action, the character can project a field of darkness around themselves, adding a -1D penalty per rank to the die code of any ranged attacks or Perception skills that rely on sight. The field roughly fills a room or extends in a half-sphere around the character with a radius equal to one meter per rank. The field can be maintained for a maximum of one minute per rank before dispersing. It remains stationary even if the character moves or leaves the area.

Elasticity (1 per rank)

The character can stretch, elongate, and compress their body, allowing them to expand his height or become so narrow they can pass through keyholes, cracks, or any other opening they could normally see through. It takes an action to shift the character's form, and requires no roll, just the action for movement (after shifting their form). It takes one round or more to slip through small openings, depending on their depth.

Additionally, the character gains +1 per rank to Dodge defense totals, as well as +1D to any die codes made to disguise

their own appearance. As an action, they can add +1 to the “range” of a melee weapon (see melee weapons on [page 82](#)), up to a maximum value equal to their ranks in Elasticity.

Energy Ranged Weapon (3)

The character has some sort of energy ranged weapon, using channeled energy to reach out and attack enemies at a distance.

Long range equals 20 times the number of ranks in this Talent times the character's Brawn, lift, or firearms (as appropriate) in meters.

The damage for these energy attacks is 3D Damage plus 1D per rank. The projection must have a visible effect and clearly defined energy type, and it may not do mental damage.

Note that, regardless of the nature of the projection, there are no additional effects from this type of Talent unless an Enhancement allows otherwise.

Extra Body Part (0)

The character has an extra limb or organ. If external, these may be secondary arms or legs, a tail, or some more exotic bodily addition, such as fins, tentacles, or antennae. If internal, the parts are organs such as extra eyes, hearts, or mysterious glands. Unless specified by a Flaw or Limitation, the extra parts are included in the hero's body tastefully. Additionally, except in cases where the character

has an Enhancement or another Talent that uses this one (for example, Extra Body Part: Tail and Natural Hand-to-Hand Weapon: Tail), the extra part is nonfunctional and provides no benefit.

A character may have only one rank in this Talent, but they may have multiple versions to represent multiple additional organs or limbs.

This talent exists to allow you to build other tweaks and adjustments on top of it. Think of it as a foundation for a new “branch” on your character.

Extra Sense (1 per rank)

The character can detect something that a normal Human cannot, such as changes in pressure, seismic activity, radiation fluctuations, and so on. They gains a+1D to their search rolls in attempting to detect the specific energy or environmental change and +1D to their investigation rolls in figuring out source or other relevant information.

The gamemaster may also allow a +1 skill total bonus to other activities that would benefit from whatever the extra sense can detect. All modifiers are per rank in this Talent.

Fear (2 per rank)

The character can provoke fear in those who can see or hear them. As an action, the character can channel that fear into any who can see and hear them and are within a number of meters equal to the rank of these power x 10.

All those affected by fear must make a Knowledge Test or suffer a -1 penalty per rank in this power (cumulative) to all results for a number of rounds equal to the ranks in this power.

The Knowledge difficulty to resist a Fear attack is 15.

Flight (6 per rank)

The character can fly, either by nature, mutation, technology, or by virtue of having wings. The character’s flying rate equals their base Move times 2 times the number of ranks.

When this Talent is taken, the character gains 1D in the Agility: Flying skill, which can thereafter be advanced as normal (depending on the module).

Glider Wings (3)

The character can fly by drifting with air currents, provided there is sufficient wind. The gamemaster decides how much wind there is available and how fast it moves the glider. When this Talent is taken, the character gains 1D in the Agility: Flying skill, which can thereafter be advanced as normal (depending on the advancement module).

A character may not have this ability more than once.

Immortality (7)

The character is immortal, though they will grow older, at a decreased pace compared to the rest of their species. If they are mortally wounded and would

die, they do not. The character will not go unconscious or bleed to death (as mortally wounded characters do), but they will not heal without mystical, medical, technological, or similar special aid or the Accelerated Healing Talent — their arms could be blown off, their abdomen gutted, or whatever. They simply exist in a state of pain, and require help to heal.

When mortally wounded, they may perform only minimal physical actions and some actions may be impossible. No Agility die code rolls may be made, other than for initiative purposes only.

There should be one particular set of circumstances whereby the character will die forever. These sets of circumstances should not be too unusual or impossible to fulfill, but rare enough they can't occur in every day happenstance. Good examples are conditions like: beheading, wounded with a particular element or weapon, being burned alive, etc.

A character may not have this ability more than once.

Infravision/Ultravision (1 per rank)

The character gains the ability to see in the dark using either infravision or ultravision. Infravision allows the character to see changes in heat, while ultra-vision enables the character to make the most of the available light. Each provides a +2 per rank in a single version of this Talent to sight-based

Perception rolls while in dim or dark conditions (or other applicable rolls that might benefit from this superpower, as per gamemaster discretion).

Obviously, extreme heat or bright light (including daylight) prevent this Talent from working.

Intangibility (5 per rank)

The character can reduce their physical density to virtually zero for one minute per rank. During that time, their damage resistance score against physical and energy attacks is +3D per rank, but their movement rate is halved.

An intangible character can pass through solid objects, providing they do not contain super-science protections, wards or other spells of protection designed to repel passage of this nature. They may not pass through energy or electrified barriers.

While intangible, the character cannot carry any object along (including clothing), nor can they attempt any physical attack. It takes a full round for a character to become intangible or solid, during which they can do nothing else. The character must spend at least one minute solid before attempting intangibility again.

Invisibility (3 per rank)

The character can become transparent. This adds 1 per rank to the character's dodge, sneak, and hide totals, as well as +1 per rank to all default search, investigation, and attack difficulties

against the character that the invisible character is not actively trying to defeat. Additionally, no character may take an action to “spot” the character unless the gamemaster feels there is sufficient provocation, such as brushing against others or removing something in a crowded area.

The invisibility covers the character’s basic clothes only — not any gear they are carrying, or anything they pick up. Also, remember that the character is transparent when invisible — they can’t hide things behind their back.

Life Drain (5)

This ability allows the character to drain attribute dice. The character must choose one set of attributes to target, either physical (Agility, Brawn) or mental (Knowledge, Perception).

For example, most vampires drink blood, and thus lower physical attributes, while succubi target the soul and so weaken mental attributes. The player must specify in what manner the character drains these attributes (biting the neck, hypnosis, or another means). It should involve some sort of successful attack result (either physical or mental).



When the character wishes to employ Life Drain, they make an attack on the target using the relevant skill. For every four points over the target’s defense, the character drains one pip per rank off each of the target’s relevant attributes. (While normally we don’t always use pips, this particular power requires considering pips! Remember that there are three pips in each die.)

If any of the target’s attributes reach zero, the target goes into a coma. The target may try once per day to wake up by making a successful Moderate Brawn roll. They regain one attribute point (to each attribute affected) every hour after the attack.

For every three attribute pips the character drains, they may add +1D to any attribute in their chosen category.

Life-Drained attributes recover at a rate of 1D per three hours.

A character may have as multiple versions of this talent (to allow targeting physical or mental attributes), but this power does not have ranks.

Mental Defense (3 per rank)

The character has mental wards, psychic protections, or an indomitable will power. These benefits protect their mind, and allow them to add +1D per rank to die codes made to resist mental manipulation, possession, mind control, or other similar effects. This bonus does not apply against social situations or standard interactions.

Mental Suggestion (3 per rank)

This gives the character the ability to suggest or influence others. The character gets a +3D bonus to their die codes when attempting social manipulation (deception, persuasion, intimidation, etc).

Multiple Abilities (1 per rank)

The character has multiple minor abilities that improve a few different tasks. All bonuses are added to the skill or attribute total when rolled, not to the die code. The bonuses should be fairly limited in their applications,

pertaining to specific uses of particular skills (like specializations do), but there can be several of them for each selection of this Talent. The maximum total bonus for each rank is +4.

Example: A character could have “eyestalks” that give them a +1 bonus to Perception or search totals that would negate surprise, the ability to focus their ears on particular types of noises (+1 bonus when listening for particular sounds), and fingers that are sensitive to subdermal motion (+1 bonus to sleight of hand against safes with moving tumblers).

Natural Armor (3 per rank)

The character has plates, toughened skin, scales, or something similar. Their own surface adds +1D per rank to damage resistance rolls to avoid harm from physical (not mental) attacks, as well as contact poisons, corrosives, or similar materials.

Natural Hand-to-Hand Weapon (2)

The character has some sort of natural weapon — such as claws, pincers, bone spikes, or stinger — that add 1D per rank to their Brawn Damage when determining their damage with the natural weapon. The character uses melee to attack, unless they can detach the weapon from themselves or (in the case of a super-scientific weapon) it exists separately.

In these latter cases, the character employs melee combat to wield it.

Natural Ranged Weapon (3)

The character has some sort of natural ranged weapon built into themselves (quills, shooting spines, acid spray, fire breath, etc).

Long range equals 20 times the number of ranks in this Talent times the character's Brawn, lift, or firearms (as appropriate) in meters.

The damage for physically enhanced projections is the character's Brawn Damage plus 1D per rank.

The projection must have a visible effect (such as bone shards) and it may not do mental damage.

Note that, regardless of the nature of the projection, there are no additional effects from this type of Talent unless an Enhancement allows otherwise.

For firearms, you can either use the weapon rules or see the super-science talent enhancement on [page 32](#) to create super-powered ranged weapons!

Omnivorous (2)

The character can gain nourishment from any organic substance (though they are not immune to poisons). They can also chew through just about any

organic substance with no adverse effects to their teeth or jaws (though time and energy can be a concern). A character may not have this ability more than once.

Paralyzing Touch (4)

The character can freeze their target with the merest touch.

When the character makes a brawling attack, they may, instead of doing damage, paralyze their victim, who remains that way until the target makes a successful Knowledge or willpower roll against the brawling skill total. They may attempt to do so once per round; the only other actions they may take are mental-based ones or Talents that do not require movement.

Note: Characters who are heavily armored or covered will be harder to hit. The gamemaster needs to decide how much skin is exposed and adjust the attack difficulty accordingly.

A character may not have this ability more than once.

Super-speed (1 per rank)

The character is extremely fast, adding +2 meters per round per rank to their base Move rate, which in turn affect all other types of movement (see [page 32](#) for movement).

The character adds +1 to their Dodge and Parry defenses per 3 ranks in this Talent (rounded down).



Transmutation (5 per rank)

The character can alter their substance to something else, while retaining their form (such as a man who turns to stone). Characters with this ability may only shift into one specific substance, which the player must specify when the character gets the Talent.

Generally, this substance gives the character distinct benefits. The player may select up to 4 points (not ranks) in other Talents that relate to the chosen form, per rank in this Talent. (Thus, two Transmutation ranks means 8 points in other Talents.) Natural Armor, Hardiness, and Environmental Resistance are common ones.

It takes an action to shift forms. The shapeshifting character can only remain in this altered form for a number of rounds equal to their ranks in this superpower.

This talent can be taken multiple times, though each time a character takes it, they must define which form the talent applies to.

Teleportation (3 per rank)

The character can move instantly to another place up to 10 meters per rank away. The character must see their destination clearly. In combat, this action takes an entire round. The character may take along whatever they can carry.

Water Breathing (2 per rank)

The character can breathe water and will not drown under water. They gain +1D per rank to all swim rolls because they don't need to worry about drowning.

Superpower Talent Enhancements

Superpower Talent Enhancements allow Talents to be somehow more than the typical version. Think of them as bonus dials you can turn to make the superpower or talent your own.

Each Enhancement may be taken more than once for each Talent, either altering the ability in similar though distinct ways or, for some, through stacking the effects. The cost of the Enhancement adds to the associated Talent's total cost (base cost plus the cost for additional ranks), which means that the Enhancement cost must be paid at each Rank of the Talent.

You can also apply these to non-superpower talents if you wish.

Additional Effect (1): The Talent produces a useful, though minor, side effect that is a natural extension of the power. The more useful the side effect, the greater the number of ranks. Some examples include a skill bonus when using the ability, a reduced cost or lifting of a minor requirement.

Bestow (varies): The character may share their Talent with a certain type of target: sentient living, non-sentient living, or nonliving.

The player must choose which group when including this Enhancement. The cost of this Enhancement equals one-half (rounded up) of the Talent total (base cost plus additional ranks cost plus Enhancement costs). They may use their Talent on themselves and on members of their target group with a multi-action penalty. The character may give their Talent to one person per action.

Some Talents will require better stories concerning how the character can manage sharing them than others (such as Youthful Appearance or

Ambidextrous), while others may not have this Enhancement (such as Longevity or Immortality). The target has control over the use of the Bestowed Talent for as long as the Bestowing character allows. A character may only have one rank in this Enhancement, but they may have multiple versions of it.

Extended Range (3): The factor used to determine the range of the character's Talent is increased. Every rank of this Enhancement allows the player to add one half of the ranks in the Talent (rounded up) to the factor when determining the range. Thus, to increase the range factor by half the ranks costs three, by the ranks in the ability costs six, by 1.5 times the ranks costs eight, and so on.

Multiple Targets (2): The character may use the Talent more than once per round without incurring a multi-action penalty. For each rank in this Enhancement, the character gains one additional use of the Talent. This adds to any other bonus actions provided by a power; it does not multiply it.

Superpower Talent Limitations

These Limitations can be associated with superpowers and talents, restricting their functionality and reducing their total cost (base cost plus the cost for additional ranks plus any Enhancements — not the per rank cost).

Limitations may not lower a Talent's total cost below one, and all Limitations must have some sort of effect on play — just like Flaws.

Each of a character's Talents may have more than one of each Limitation, as they can either describe similar but distinct negative situations or, in some cases, stack the effects.

You can also apply these to non-superpower talents if you wish.

Ability Loss (3 for 1 rank; 4 for 2 ranks): The character temporarily loses their Talent at regular intervals or, when the Talent is used, they lose the ability to use a common skill in which they have experience (that is, additional pips or dice). Examples include: a character who cannot shapeshift when the sun is out; a character who cannot use their natural weapons on a particular day of the month or during a certain phase of the moon.

The character is aware of what the circumstances are that will cause this.

For an additional point and additional rank, the character must undergo some sort of (fairly simple) procedure to regain their ability or skill use (a ritual, prayer, injection of super-serum, or other solution). A Talent may have up to two ranks in a single variation of this Limitation, but a character may have it multiple times for different Talents, circumstances, or combinations of Talents and skills.

Allergy (3 for 1 rank; 4 for 2 ranks):

The character has a somewhat minor allergy. Exposure to a substance (smoke, sunlight, particular food, etc.) or situation causes the character to lose all rerolls until the condition is removed.

For an additional point and additional rank, the effects are worse, and the character loses all actions, ability to use superpowers, due to coughing fits, watering eyes, energy drain, adverse reactions, or similar discomfort until they can get away from the allergen. A Talent may only have one rank in this Limitation, though it may have several different Allergies.

Allergy is excellent for representing the classic superhero weakness trope! It is normally bought per superpower or Talent.

Burnout (1): See the Flaw by this name for suggestions that could also be applied to a Talent. The more likely the Burnout, the greater the number

of ranks in this Limitation. A Talent may have multiple variations of this Limitation, representing different triggers for the Burnout.

Debt (3): Someone (or, more likely, some entity) gave the character the Talent, along with certain obligations and restrictions. The character must continually beg the giver to retain the Talent, or they must perform certain tasks at the giver's request in exchange for continued use of the Talent. A Talent may only have one rank in this Limitation.

Flaw (1): All difficulties associated with using the Talent are increased by +2 per rank. The greater the rank associated with this Flaw, the greater the difficulty modifier.

Minor Stigma (3): The character cannot use the Talent without performing the “proper rituals” before or after (someone with a natural weapon who must sketch an image of their intended victim before hunting them down; a shapeshifter who must be purified by their cult after killing someone). A Talent may only have one rank in this Limitation.

Others Only (2 for 1 rank; 3 for 2 ranks; 4 for 3 ranks): The character may not use the Talent themselves; they may only allow others to use it. The value of this Limitation depends on how many groups of “others” the character may use it on: For two points and one rank, the character may affect sentient living, nonsentient living, and nonliving targets. For three points and two ranks, the character can affect



only two of the three groups. For four points and three ranks, the character can affect only one of the three groups.

This Limitation may not be taken more than once per Talent. Additionally, like the Bestow Enhancement, some Talents may require valid reasons before the gamemaster allows the Limitation's inclusion. Some abilities, such as Immortality and Longevity, may not have this Limitation. The target who gets the Talent has control over its use as if they actually had the ability, for as long as the giving character allows.

Allowing another person access to the Talent counts as an action for its owner, while using the newfound Talent counts as an action for the one

who gets it (though gaining access to it does not). The Talent's owner may only give the Talent to one character per round, but the target may be different each round.

Price (1): The character must fulfill certain obligations in order to use the Talent. Perhaps when using Water Breathing, the character must remain in the water for at least 24 hours for every 24 hours out of it or suffer -1D penalty per rank in this Limitation to his damage resistance total for changing environments so quickly. Alternatively, depending on the modules in use, there could be a fee of three experience points per rank or one Hero Point per rank in the Limitation per adventure in which the character uses the Talent.

Restricted (1): The Talent is hindered in a way not covered by any other Limitation. The more restrictive the situation, the greater the number of ranks in this Limitation. For instance, a Natural Weapon (either kind) may only be useful against certain items. A Talent may have multiple variations of this Limitation, each representing a different restraint.

Side Effect (2): One of the character's Talents has some sort of annoying side effect that appears with its use, such as constant whistling, a continuous glow, or a terrible stench. Add 4 per rank to the difficulty of all sneak attempts when the Talent is in use, as everyone can figure out the character is coming. This will also affect interaction attempts, adding at least a +1 per rank to the difficulty.

Singularity (1 per Talent): The character may use only one of a group of two or more Talents each round. It does not take an action to switch Talents. They may change the Talent in use at the beginning of their turn in a round, and they may rely on the chosen Talent until the next time they change it.

For a second rank (and one additional point per Talent), it does take an action to switch Talents.

A Talent may not have more than two ranks in this Limitation and all Talents in the same group must have this Limitation at the same rank. Not all of a character's Talents need be in the same Singularity group.

Reskinning Superpower Talents

The superpower talents can be visually and narratively re-themed however the player or gamemaster wish. Natural armor might appear like scaly plating, quills, dense fur or moss growing on the character. Glider wings might be literal wings, grapple guns, small drones that hover under the character, wind or air control, or other similar effects.

The limits for what powers can represent is only the imagination of the gamemaster and player.

Module: Gadgets & Gear

Cool gadgets and gear are part and parcel of the superheroic genre, and the rules herein are leveraged to emulate that.

There are two types of equipment: gadgets or gear. Gear is the term we use to represent items and equipment that emulate superpowers. Gadgets are smaller pieces of equipment that aren't on the scale of gear. They don't have superpower level effects, but instead enhance what a character can do or attempt in small ways.

Gadgets

Gadgets can be built using the equipment on [pages 79-80](#) as an example. Generally they grant an option or tactical choice in play, the ability to use a skill in a different situation, or a single bonus die to a die code.

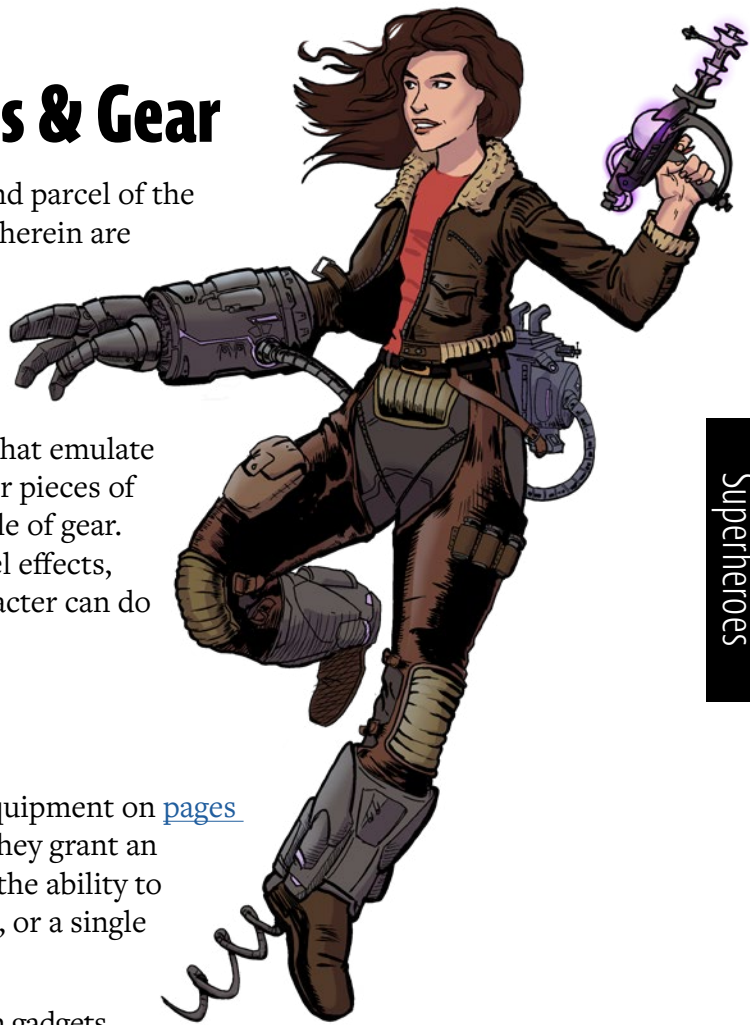
Gamemasters can create their own gadgets too! Generally speaking, just think of the skill the gadget benefits and have it provide a +1D to a particular use case of that skill (generally not all use cases though!)

The Super-Science Talent Enhancement

The most common way to create superhero gear is using the Super-science Talent Enhancement.

Super-science (2): The Talent is contained in a piece of equipment — such as a gun, a staff, or a ring — developed through a technological means not readily available and certainly experimental. If the character wishes, multiple superpower talents can be combined into one piece of gear by combining the cost of all associated superpowers.

The item could be lent to another character or taken away with a successful grab and used by someone else, though they suffer a -1D penalty on any rolls to use the item.



On a complication, the item malfunctions and requires repair.

Unless combined with the Burnout Limitation, a destroyed item may be recreated in a number of days equal to the total cost of the Talent (including all ranks, Enhancements, and Limitations).



Example: Utility Belt

As an example of a super-science piece of gear, let's consider the utility belt. A staple of superhero stories, the utility belt is perfect to explore how the super-science talent enhancement can work.

A utility belt holds multiple useful tools. The gamemaster works with the player to determine that the best use of utility belt is the Multiple Abilities superpower! But the player wants some back-up weapons in the belt, so the gamemaster and the character decide to include throwing stars (natural ranged weapons).

The player agrees, and invests 6D into their super-science multiple abilities power (the utility belt)! Two dice for the super-science enhancement, three dice for one rank of natural ranged weapons and one dice for one rank of multiple abilities.

The player decides to apply the Restricted (1) Superpower Talent Limitation to make it cost an action to gain the bonus from the utility belt, which lowers the total dice cost of the utility belt to 5D.

The player divides their four +1 bonuses as follows:

- +1 to Athletics for climbing (grapple gun)
- +1 to Investigation (forensic kit)
- +1 to Stealth (smoke bombs)
- +1 to Perception (binoculars)
- Rank 1 Natural Ranged Weapons (Throwing Stars hidden in the belt)

They could theoretically loan the utility belt out to someone else (who could benefit from the bonuses), and it might be subject to complications or drawbacks as the narrative unfolds, but they've got a super-science gadget!

Module: Hidden Bases & Hideouts

Despite their differences, many masked heroes have two things in common. First, they make up the majority of player character concepts for superheroic campaigns! Second, they tend to appreciate the value of a good hideout. Hideouts can be given by the gamemaster to all PCs, the group as a whole, or purchased as though they were a Talent.

These may be shared or individual, remote or hidden in plain sight.

This section discusses creating and defining such hideouts. Hideouts have three elements: Location, Description, and Features.

Location

Every hideout is located somewhere. When selecting a location, consider the competing qualities of convenience and safety. A hideout in the middle of town places its owner right in the center of the action, but it increases the risk of discovery, accidental or intentional. Remote hideouts are hard to discover, but it takes time and effort to get there. Many hideouts are somewhere in between, mixing convenient location with enough isolation to allow the character to come and go unseen.

Generally speaking, there are three types of Location:

- Urban locations are located in a town or city. They are great for travel, secret meetings, and quick escapes, but they invite a lot of attention.
- Country locations are near towns or cities but still outside urban limits. They are relatively easy to reach and use, but they are harder for the authorities to locate.
- Wild locations are far away from settlements and civilizations. They are hard to reach and difficult to supply, but they afford maximum secrecy, allowing for long periods of rest, study, training, or recovery with little fear of discovery.

Location has no direct mechanical effect in play, but is important nonetheless. Gamemasters threatening player characters with discovery, capture, and exposure by the authorities should consider how location drives and shapes the action. Generally, players who place their characters well away from enemies and risk aren't interested in perils and threats close to home. Characters who operate near population centers and enemy controlled areas want the excitement and risk of placing their hideouts in the middle of the action.

If the campaign uses maps, character hideouts should be placed on the map. This helps keep track of when a character has the resources and shelter of their hideouts available, and when home and safety is out of reach.

Description

A hideout needs a concise description of the construction, outward appearance, and other important details. The hideout's description provides insight into a character's personality and goals. A well-stocked private mansion with a secret technology base suggests a hero who enjoys the finer things and spends time in their secret identity as a noble or wealthy socialite. A cave deep in the wilds is ideal for a hunter or tracker, someone raised in or empowered by nature, or anyone who values secrecy above all.

Possible descriptions include:

- A cave deep within a remote valley. The cave contains a grotto and several exits.
- My family's ancestral estate, with a secret door in the study leading to a hidden underground chamber.
- A modest storefront with living quarters in back. Beneath this exterior is a secret cellar where I stage my actives out of.
- A permanent camp deep in the forests outside of town.
- An abandoned church or home the locals believe is haunted.

Like location, description has no mechanical effect but provides important details and information for scenes at or around a hideout. Description can also provide insight into a character's demeanor or nature. A brightly decorated mansion with a hidden room filled with trophies and costumes paints a different picture than a hidden cave lined with weapons and the barest essentials.

Features

Features are the mechanical meat of a hideout; they enable certain resources for their character. These can be things like an armory, collection of disguises, stables for the characters' mounts, and other useful features.

The following features are common to hideouts. players may use these or create their own. In addition to these features, a hideout is always considered to have living quarters and basic supplies such as food and normal clothing appropriate to their description.

Non-player characters connected to a location are always devoted followers. They will not betray the hideout owner except under the most extreme circumstances.

Armory

An area with numerous swords, guns, and other weapons. This includes ammunition and tools to maintain and repair weapons. In addition, the owner's weapons are always considered to be of high quality. Characters may use the armory to replenish or replace their weapons—guests may use the armory as well, with the owner's permission. Note there is enough gunpowder to cause a few sizable explosions, but using it for this purpose depletes the supply, requiring the owner to restock. By spending a Hero Point, the armory may include unique or powerful weapons.

Attendant

The hideout is maintained by a loyal attendant. This character is loyal to the hideout owner even unto death and possesses skills in three useful categories appropriate to their background and concept. For example, a former special operative turned valet might be skilled at stealth, close combat, and social graces.

Cells

Secure holding areas for prisoners. Can be used as uncomfortable guest quarters in a pinch. Does not include a jailer, though non-player characters can be used as guards for prisoners. If desired, this may include cages for wild animals.

Dock

Only of use if the hideout is near water, this feature provides a small boat and facilities for docking, repairing, and supplying small watercraft. A larger dock is possible and costs nothing extra, but is very hard to hide except for hideouts deep in the wild.

False Front

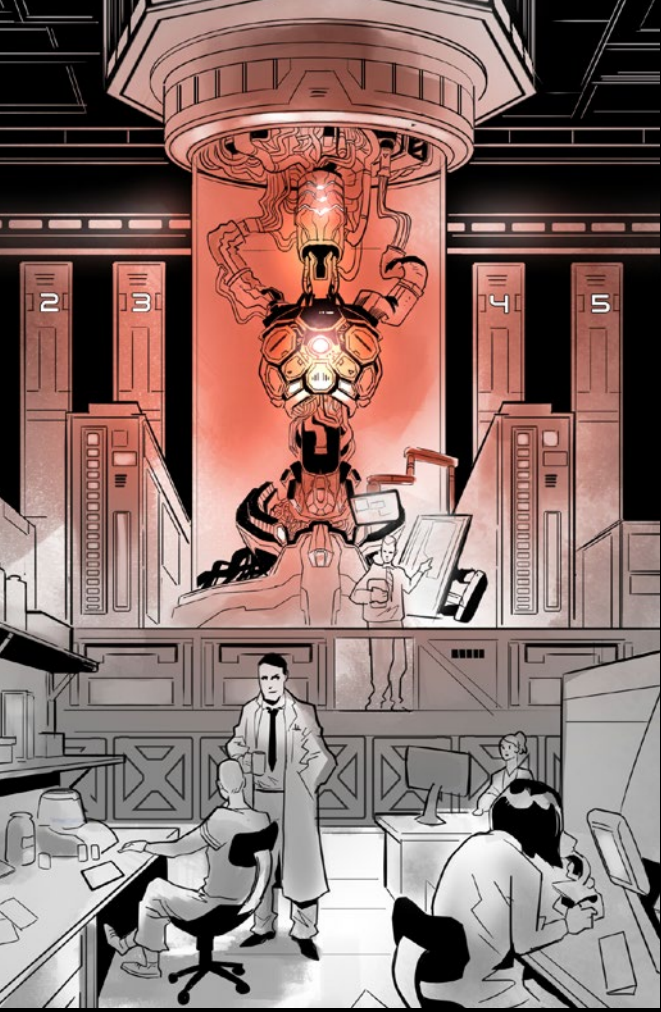
While all hideouts are hidden and secret, this one contains a false business or institution acting as a cover to further protect it from discovery. NPCs who work the false front may or may not be aware of the hideout's existence, at the owner's discretion.

Garage

A garage contains at least one reliable and discreet vehicle, as well as the materials to maintain and repair both. Additional selections of garage might allow for upgrades to the vehicle to make it a truly "super" (sorry!) ride.

Gymnasium

Area dedicated to exercise and physical training. Includes space to practice fencing, unarmed combat, acrobatics, and other similar pursuits.



Laboratory

Used for scientific analysis and research. Includes modern or near-future scientific equipment and materials. Also has a small collection of scientific treatises and texts in a small library, though nothing so grand as a full library.

Hospital

Requires Infirmary. Medical facilities to treat at least a dozen people. Includes an NPC nurse or local doctor who makes house calls.

Infirmary

Medicines and medical supplies to treat up to three wounded or sick individuals at a time. Doesn't come with a doctor or nurse.

Entourage

Requires Attendant. The hideout serves as the base for numerous lesser NPCs under the direction of the owner's chief attendant. Includes at least six individuals but no more than a dozen individuals adept at a single profession or particular set of skills. For example, an entourage might consist of a nurse, a computer whiz/hacker, a local law enforcement liaison and three household staff.

Library

A grand collection of books on numerous subjects. Pick three subjects the library has extensive volumes about. The collection also has lesser or single texts of numerous other topics. For a Hero Point, a particular vital text can be found here.

Sanctuary

The hideout is located in an embassy, corporate or diplomatic office, or other location considered holy or politically protected. The authorities are reluctant to search or scrutinize such locations.

Safehouse

In addition to the hideout, there are one or more smaller safehouses hidden nearby. These are usable as secondary hideouts or to keep important individuals or items secure. Pick one location for an established safehouse. By spending a Hero Point, the character may create a new safehouse in a location, provided it makes sense for such a place to exist in the area.

Stable

Facilities to maintain several horses. This comes with one exceptional horse and two standard mounts (horses, ponies, or donkeys) for guests and followers.

Transportation Network

A connection point from the hideout to various locations nearby. Pick two starting locations where a transportation entrance is located. At the GM's discretion, Hero Points may be expended to establish a new entrance in an area during play. This might be tunnels, abandoned subways, a limited teleportation network, or similar.

Vault

A large secure vault or other structure for storing valuables. The vault is nearly impregnable and can only be opened with a particular key or combination

possessed only by its owner, though they may share this with others if desired. Vaults can be environmentally sealed if desired, though this runs the risk of someone becoming trapped inside and eventually suffocating.

Wardrobe

An area equipped with numerous costumes and outfits, including the latest styles. While most of the clothing is in the owner's size, there is a smaller collection of outfits for various shapes and sizes. Wigs and makeup are included if desired.

Workshop

Provides tools and space for crafting and repairing all manner of items and objects. Includes ample supplies of common tools and gear such as ropes, wood, nails, etc.



Building Hideouts

Hideouts are simple to build. Individually, players decide a location and description for their own hideout and then select four features. GMs wanting PCs to have more or fewer resources and safe retreats in a campaign can increase or reduce the base number of features.

Group Hideouts

players can pool their resources to create a single hideout with more features, if desired. This is an effective way to get a large, well-appointed hideout. However, it also increases risk the hideout will be discovered by a character's enemies—so many people coming and going makes it harder to hide. For this reason, players are encouraged to create group hideouts either out in the country or the wild, or with features such as False Front or Sanctuary to help to escape close scrutiny by the authorities.

Relocating a Hideout

If a hideout is destroyed or otherwise compromised, it can be relocated. This takes several months of game time as resources are acquired and new structures built. It usually takes one month per feature to relocate and re-establish a hideout, though GMs might allow characters to undertake an adventure to more quickly acquire and establish a new hideout or reward a group with a suitable hideout location during play.

Multiple Hideouts

Characters may create additional hideouts by either assigning existing features to a different hideout or buying new features and defining them as part of a new hideout. Note that for small, disposable hideouts, there is the Safehouse feature.

Adding Features

New features may be added to a hideout as the GM and players feel is appropriate in the fiction.

Exceptional increases might require an expenditure of Hero Points to secure whatever is needed, and this should be worked out between the GM and players. The feature must still make sense to add or the hideout must be relocated or expanded.

Module: Nemesis, Companions, & Sidekicks

Nemesis

A nemesis is a step above even an R3 Enemy, a truly unique foe that is inextricably bound to the character (or group of characters) and reoccurs to menace them in ways that can only be dreamed of.

Nemeses generally organically unfold throughout play, but some players may wish for their character to begin with an established nemesis. Either way, the gamemaster has final say on if a character is a nemesis for a player character or not.

The rules for a nemesis are as follows:

- A nemesis is created using the normal character creation rules for the campaign. The gamemaster should add bonus dice based on the power level of the campaign and if the nemesis is for a single character or a group.
- A nemesis gets a pool of unique nemesis points to spend (treat them as hero points per the rules for your campaign).
 - They get $1d6+3$ Nemesis Points each time they encounter the player.
- Whenever a hero gains experience, the nemesis gains that much experience in the background (represented by time planning to defeat the hero).
- The nemesis counts as a Rank 3 enemy for the hero (or group).
- If a nemesis would be killed, and they still have nemesis points, the nemesis instead escapes through a suitably Machiavellian means.
- Whenever a player character drives away or defeats their nemesis (on their own, unless it's a group nemesis), the player gains a hero point!



Companions

Generally companions can be represented by Talents like Contacts or Patrons, being used in narrative senses to represent how superheroes work with their community and cities to achieve their goals.

More character important companions (loved ones, significant others, family) in superheroic stories can be significant emotional beats. If a character can spend some time with an significant companion who helps ground them and serves as a touchstone to the good in the world, that hero can recover one hero point.

This is an excellent tool to allow a character to take a brief break from a scene, or have some emotional roleplay with an NPC in the classic superhero comic vein.

Sidekicks

Sidekicks are relatively easy to handle in D6 System: Second Edition. Sidekicks tend to take two forms: those who are miniature emulations of the character and those who are starkly different to the character in some significant way. Whatever is decided upon should be weighted against the campaign and the overarching narrative.

A sidekick is generally acquired throughout the campaign

When a character would have a sidekick, they simply create a new character (following the normal character creation rules for the campaign), with the following changes and restrictions:

- The Sidekick character must halve any starting dice and any starting superpower dice when building the character.
- The Sidekick character must take the Age flaw (at a rank agreed upon with the gamemaster)
- The character who has the sidekick also must either the Debt or Hindrance flaw to represent the resources and effort required by the sidekick.
- The sidekick advances like a normal character, but there should be a point determined (both by narrative and by experience point gain) where the sidekick will decide to break free and forge their own path, out from the shadow of the character.

Sidekicks can complicate campaigns (creating a “bonus character” that one character has access to) and gamemasters should make sure the inclusion of a sidekick won’t disrupt the game or shift the spotlight too far from other characters. players who abuse the concept of a sidekick to shore up weaknesses in their characters can have their sidekicks removed.

Superhero comics and their arcs frequently feature sidekicks (often young kids) in danger. Make sure everyone in your group is ok with this! Child endangerment can be concerning for lots of folks (parents, foster care workers, and more), and if you are going to include it, remember to play in good faith and that the fun and comfort at the table is paramount!



Superhero Templates

The superhero module utilizes the Additional Attributes: Charm module, introduces the Flight skill under Agility, and introduces the Streetwise skill under Perception.

To that end, we've granted each character +1D to their assignable skill die (for a total of 8D), we've added +3D to their total attributes (for a total of 15), and we've also assigned 10D of superpower dice for each character.



Blaster

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 5D

Brawn: 2D

Charm: 3D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 25

Recommended Skills:

Acrobatics, Flying, Persuasion, Shooting

Superpowers: Energy Ranged Weapon (3); Infravision (1 rank); Teleportation (2 ranks)

Bruiser

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 4D

Brawn: 4D

Charm: 2D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 20

Recommended Skills:

Medicine, Melee, Stamina, Stealth

Superpowers: Accelerated Healing (4); Armor Piercing Attack (1 rank); Attack Resistance - Energy Attacks (1); Extra Sense - Undersea Sonar (2 ranks)



Paragon

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 4D

Brawn: 4D

Charm: 3D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 2D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 10
- Parry: 20

Recommended Skills: Acrobatics, Flying, Melee, Persuasion

Superpowers: Flight (1 rank); Natural Armor (2 ranks); Natural Hand-to-Hand Weapon (2), Super-Speed (1 rank)



Tank

ATTRIBUTES

Agility: 3D

Brawn: 5D

Charm: 2D

Knowledge: 2D

Perception: 3D

DEFENSES

- Dodge: 15
- Parry: 15

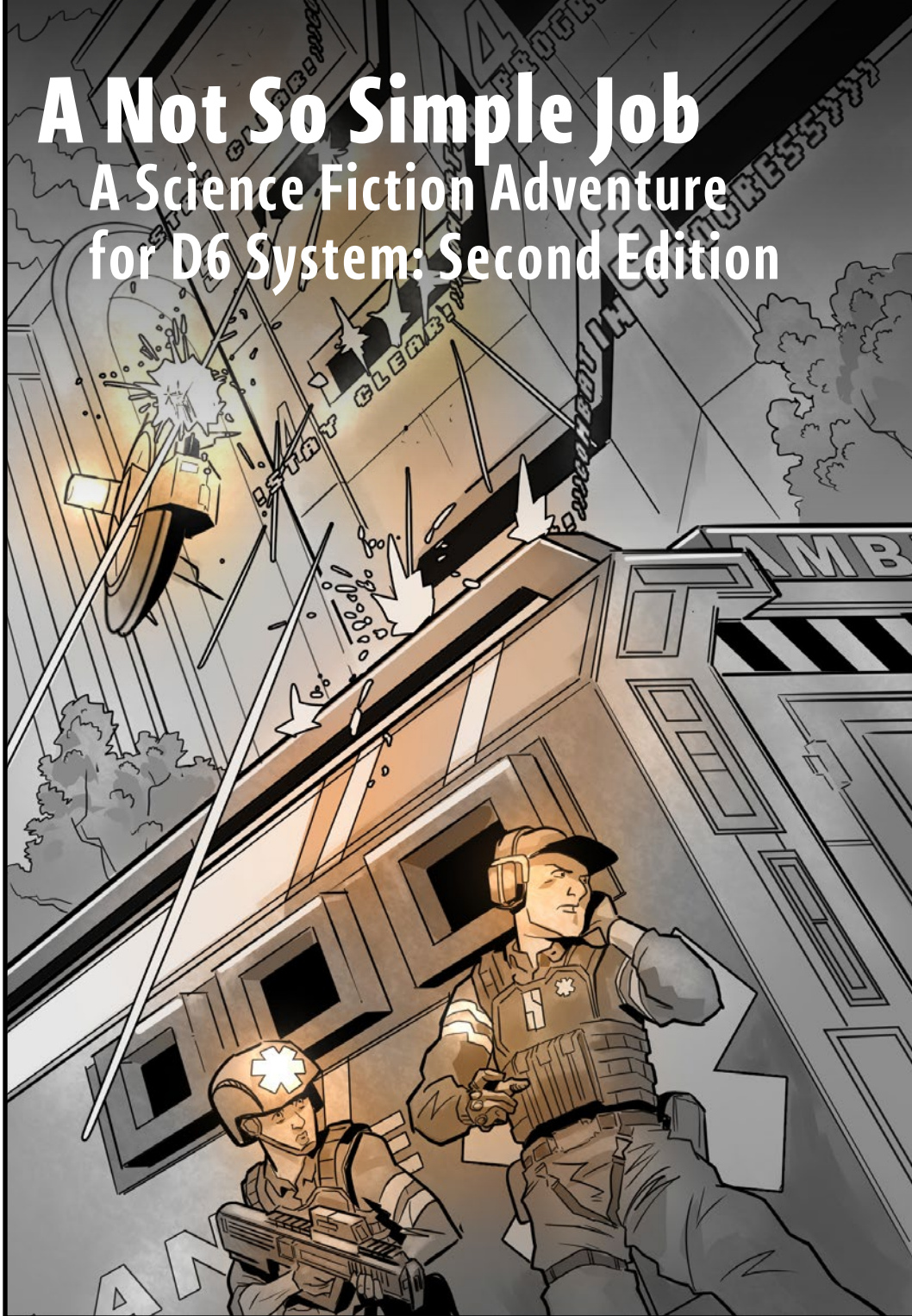
Recommended Skills: Melee, Intimidation, Stamina, Willpower

Superpowers: Attack Resistance - Energy Attacks (2), Extra Body Part - Trunk (0), Natural Armor (3 ranks); Natural Hand-to-Hand Weapon - Tusks (2)



A Not So Simple Job

A Science Fiction Adventure for D6 System: Second Edition



Prepping for “A Not So Simple Job”

This introduction adventure is designed to allow gamemasters and players to experience D6 System: Second Edition quickly and easily!

Gamemasters should read the adventure thoroughly and make notes based on what they expect their players to do.

Due to the toolkit nature of the game, you should confirm which modules you are using and make any necessary adjustments to the adventure (altering skills or difficulties). This game presumes you're using the Charm additional attribute, as well as several of the science fiction alternate skills ([page 173](#)).

If you are not, you'll need to adjust which skills are rolled at various stages during the adventure.

You will also need to be familiar with the chase rules ([page 73](#)).

If players need characters, the science fiction templates on [page 200](#) will work great for this adventure.

Introduction

The player characters have been employed by a powerful Crime Lord to pick up some cargo for him. Success could mean future business for the group, while failure could bring about grave consequences.

GM reads aloud:

The ship sets down in docking bay 92 on Gardulia IV, a remote planet in the Wild Zone. Known as a haven for smugglers, pirates, and rogues this could be a dicey venture. But you have seen worse.

Have the players read this script aloud:

(If there are more, or less, than four players take a moment to reassign the parts.)

player 1: *Well, we're here. Everyone, check your weapons before we head out. I want to make sure we're ready for anything. We do not want a repeat of what happened on Sundalla.*

player 2: *That wasn't my fault! It was supposed to be a peaceful outpost! Not like this scum hole!*

player 3: *Yeah, well The Slug isn't known for the pleasant company he keeps. He's paying us well for this job. All we need to do is meet the contact, transfer the credits, and get the cargo back to the ship. We should earn enough from this job to pay our debts and take a few easy jobs for a change.*

player 4: *This sounds like it could be more dangerous than our last few jobs, but it would be nice to take it easy for a bit.*

***player 2:** How come the cred stick has double what we're paying out? What's up with that?*

***player 4:** That's a stupid amount of money. We could just take it and disappear.*

***player 1:** It's in case we need extra to for 'unexpected' expenditures. And I wouldn't think about crossing The Slug. He'd put a bounty on us so high we wouldn't be able to find a safe place to sleep. Anywhere! Ever!*

***player 3:** I'd rather stick with the money The Slug is paying us, than be vaporized. Besides, it's a good deal. He's already set a price, and the pickup is in the middle of the market district. What could go wrong?*

***player 4:** We said that about Sundalla.*

***player 1:** Just don't lose focus. This cargo is supposed to be hot stuff. The Slug isn't the only party interested in it. I've got a feeling it may draw attention that we don't want.*

***player 2:** Wait...we don't know what the cargo is? Do we want to know what the cargo is?*

***player 4:** Probably not.*

***player 3:** Cool your jets, it's just a simple pick up and deliver. Meet the contact, make the exchange, and drive away. Heck, it's already loaded up for us. I hope one of you knows how to drive a hovervan.*

***player 1:** If we're careful, we will be in and out without much trouble. Let's do this.*

GM reads aloud:

The streets of Gardulia IV's capitol city Mezopan are crowded with all manner of life forms. Most of them armed and watchful of their surroundings. You head to The Marketplace after covering your docking bay costs.

Episode One: The Deal is Made

Staging Tips

In this episode, the players will make their way from the spaceport to meet their contact at The Marketplace. He will try to make the players pay more for the cargo, making a series of excuses to drive up the final price. The players will be able to use some skills including *Barter*, *Intimidation* and *Streetwise*.

The Spaceport is located at the outer edge of the city, while The Marketplace is located more towards the center. The players will need to secure transport to the meetup. They may walk (1 hour), use public transport (30 minutes) or acquire a vehicle (15 minutes). Rental companies, taxis, and the public rail system are all easily accessible at the spaceport.

The Marketplace is bustling when the players arrive. It's midday and residents and visitors are moving about, making deals, and getting drunk in the local taverns. Law enforcement is nowhere to be seen and is regularly paid off by interested parties to avoid the busy area where shady deals are made.

GM reads aloud:

The cafe where you are meeting your contact is in the heart of The Marketplace. It is a small unremarkable shop on a very busy street corner. It specializes in local cuisine, and exotic coffees. There are a few tables sitting outside and you spot your contact Rooman Saz, a known black-market fence. He is a tall, gangly Gardulian with leathery, spotted pale blue skin. His triangular shaped head has large golden eyes set on either side. He is sipping on a steaming tar-like beverage, trying to look nondescript.

He welcomes the players with an air of recognition, and motions with his head for them to approach. His body language relays his suspicions of the surrounding crowd. The players should take the hint and try to avoid drawing attention to themselves. As they settle in any player may make an Investigation roll (Difficulty 10). If they succeed, they spot that Saz has two bodyguards standing nearby at the cafe entrance.

The players can now discuss the deal with Rooman Saz. Saz knows that he has agreed to a tentative price but argues that the cost of the cargo has nearly doubled and provides excuses such as excessive shipping cost, additional handling fees, and pay-offs to customs inspectors. He also notes that others have since inquired about the cargo with higher bids and he is not happy with what The Slug has offered him.

If the players insist on seeing the cargo for themselves, he will offer to take one, and only one, to confirm its existence. He escorts the one player to a small shop a short distance from the cafe and brings them around to an alley between buildings. The cargo, in three large footlockers, is stacked neatly in the back of a gray unmarked van. The sealed crates bear the markings of what you were sent for. If the player opens a crate read the following:

When the seal is broken and the lid is removed, the hovervan is flooded with a glowing orange light. Torigan fire Gems! A rare type of crystal that reportedly store immense energy reserves. You heard rumors that there was a supply being shopped about.

Once they return to the cafe, the players elect the player who make one final roll for the price of the cargo. However, all the other players may contribute to the final roll by trying to earn modifiers. They may (but don't have to) choose one skill roll each to add modifiers to the final Bargain roll:

- *Streetwise* (Difficulty 15) to determine the validity of possible competition.
- *Intimidation* (vs Saz's Willpower 4D) to cower Saz from bargaining frivolously.
- *Barter* (Difficulty 5) to determine if any of his excuses for higher price are warranted.
- *Persuasion* (vs Saz's Willpower 4D) to convince them that it's in their best interest to set a fair price.

There is no penalty for failure – but once a skill roll has succeeded, no one else can attempt that skill roll. Add +3 for each success to the final Barter roll.

Now the elected player may roll their Barter skill (plus appropriate earned modifiers) against *Saz's Barter* skill of 3D:

- **Failure**- they will pay double the original price and drain the cred stick account.
- **Success**- by up to 5, then they pay Saz only 25% more.
- **Success**- by more than 5, then they pay Saz only the original price.

Once a deal is struck and credits paid, Saz will hand over the keys to the hovervan. He thanks them and gets up, the bodyguards tailing behind.

Episode Two: That's Our Hovervan

Staging Tips

In this episode, the players meet up with street thugs who are in the process of hijacking the cargo that they just bought. This should involve a combat encounter in a crowded marketplace. The players will have the opportunity to use all their combat skills, and the rules for cover and movement, as well as action rolls for running, climbing/jumping and dodge.

GM reads aloud:

As you exit the cafe, you are shocked to see four armed thugs, standing around the hovervan. Their jackets are adorned with a stylized four fingered hand with a burning red eye in the palm, ablaze with flames. The Hands of Flame!

The marketplace is busy, packed with people and vehicles bustling up and down the street. The thug's lookout sounds an alarm just as the players sight them. They will draw their weapons and take cover once combat begins. There are four outside the hovervan, and two more hidden inside. The two hidden thugs will not initially participate in the fight unless its apparent that the players are about to capture the hovervan.

GM reads aloud:

Time for your first battle! Roll initiative!

The fight takes place on a busy street with vehicles, stalls, doorways, and buildings to duck in and out of and provide cover! Encourage the players to use their surroundings to their advantage, taking cover, etc. Remember though, this is a busy street, there will be some innocent bystanders. Even though the players are working for The Slug, they are still heroes and should try and prevent as much harm to the bystanders as possible.

The four visible thugs will immediately engage the players in battle. All of them will work to conceal the two working inside the hovervan. After three rounds or if it starts looking bad for the thugs, the hidden two thugs will reveal themselves and join the fight. Unbeknownst to the players, the thugs hiding inside the hovervan have been installing a remote-control device that overrides the hovervan's simple security system and control computer. The thugs will fight until three of them are left.

STREET THUG

Dodge 15 Parry 15

Agility Skills 3D

- Acrobatics 1D
- Shooting 1D
- Sleight of Hand 1D

Brawn Skills 4D

- Athletics 1D
- Intimidation 2D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 3D

- Survival 1D

Damage: 4D (ranged energy pistol)

Staging Tips

The players will be unable to cover the distance between them and the cargo hovervan before it pulls away, as the remote-control does its job. So even if the players eliminate all the bad guys during the encounter - the hovervan still pulls out before the players reach it.

GM reads aloud:

One of the thugs slaps the side of the hovervan and yells “Go! Go! Go!” The hovervan starts, and lurches forward. All the thugs still capable of action try to jump into the hovervan as it flees the marketplace. Momentarily stunned, you watch the hovervan speed away, nearly crashing into startled pedestrians headed towards the less crowded backstreets and alleyway.

Episode Three: The Chase

Staging Tips

In this episode, the players will need a quick introduction of the chase/pursuit rolls. This does not have to be a complicated chase. Keep the rules simple if the players are new or inexperienced. In any case the players will need to secure a new vehicle and chase the hovervan. They can use one of these methods:

- The players have their own vehicle.
- The players may commandeer or steal a vehicle or even hire a taxi (follow that hovervan).
- The players realize that they can track the hovervan because they have the key fob, which they can turn into a tracking device. This requires a computer or data pad and some common tools. An Difficulty 10 Repair Mechanical roll and Difficulty 5 Computer roll are needed to create a tracking device.

The chase involves rolls based on how close they want to get to the vehicle. Too close and the possibility of combat (and damage to the cargo) will occur. Too far back and they may lose the hovervan.

The hovervan may still have a bad guy or two (if the players did not take them all down in the previous encounter). Combat may involve shooting from the vehicles, ramming the vehicles, and even jumping from vehicle to vehicle. If

there are no thugs left to fight the combat will consist of chasing the empty hovervan which will try to ram the players vehicle and trying to resist boarding (it is being controlled remotely). Either way the players need to force the hovervan to stop.

Use the Chase rules on [page 73](#) for this chase!

Note: No Combat

If no combat occurs, because the players hesitated to get a vehicle or chose to follow cautiously, then they will catch up to the hovervan in a small, abandoned warehouse not far from the spaceport. Proceed to Episode Four.

Episode Four: Warehouse fight

Staging Tips

In this final episode of the adventure the players will have to defeat the final collection of thugs standing between them and the cargo they came for. If the players are in bad shape reduce the final opposition to no greater than the number of player characters still in play. Show the players the warehouse map and allow them a short amount of time to get their bearings and develop a quick strategy.

GM reads aloud:

After traversing a maze of narrow alleyways, the hovervan has come to a stop in what appears to be an abandoned warehouse. The dimly lit building is littered with stacks of broken storage containers and rusting equipment. Two more thugs and four lightly armed security bots stand guard. You notice another hovervan parked nearby with a cargo bot standing by to transfer the cargo boxes.

If the players chose to follow the hovervan from a distance, then the thugs will be caught off guard. Add any thugs that were in the hijacked hovervan into the final fight scene. However, they will have caught the thugs by surprise! Give the players time to create a real plan of action and allow them one full round of surprise combat where the thugs cannot react.

If the players chased the hovervan then the bad guys know they are coming and neither side will have surprise. Allow the players to bail out of their vehicle and positions near their vehicle as indicated on the map.

GM reads aloud:

As both sides seek cover and take up firing positions in the warehouse, the final battle for possession of the Torigan fire Gems begins! Roll for initiative.

Staging Tips

The players strategy may include using their vehicle to plow thru the opposition.

SECURITY BOT

Dodge 10 Parry 15

Agility Skills 3D

- Shooting 1D

Brawn Skills 4D

- Athletics 2D

Knowledge 1D

Perception 2D

- Survival 1D

Damage: 3D (energy pistol)

Allow only one chance for the players to plow over the four security bots (the Thugs will be protected by machinery or other cover). Use the *Driving* skill vs Difficulty:

- 5 for 1 bot
- 10 for 2 bots
- 15 for 3 bots
- 20 for 4 bots

If successful, each bot receives 6D of damage (the bots profile is below).

The thugs fight with a simple strategy, try to attack head on with overwhelming numbers. If possible, they will rush the players and engage in melee combat, otherwise they may

be forced to just shoot it out from behind cover. If they are clearly losing and reduced in number, they will try to flee when there are only two left. If, however, the thugs win they will simply gather the cargo and depart. The player characters will be left to tend to themselves.

Episode Five: Epilogue

Staging Tips

If the GM decides to use this adventure only as a one shot, then congratulate the players and thank them for playing.

Rewards

If the GM wants to use this as a kickoff to a campaign, or the players want to keep their characters to use in other adventures, then award each character (to be determined), as well as the remaining funds on the cred stick.

Module Worksheet

Core Rules

Additional Attributes	☐
Alternative Initiative	☐
Alternate Wild Die	☐
Chases	☐
Hero Points	☐
Enviornments	☐
Equipment by Genre/Era	☐
Experience Points	☐
Hyper-lethal Combat	☐
Pips	☐
Milestone Character Advancement	☐
Narrative Advancement	☐
Skill Specializations & Advanced Skills	☐
No Dodge Defense	☐
Perks, Flaws, & Talents	☐
Troubles & Assets	☐

Fantasy

Fantasy Skills	☐
Magic Points Casting	☐
Freeform Skill-Based Magic	☐
Active & Responsive Combat	☐

Science Fiction

Science Fiction Skills	☐
Starships & Starship Combat	☐
Driving & Vehicles	☐
Psionics	☐
Cyberpunk	☐

Superheroic

Superheroic Skills	☐
Superpowers	☐
Gadgets & Gear	☐
Hideouts & Strongholds	☐
Nemesis, Companions, & Sidekicks	☐

Notes

Module Worksheet

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Cyberpunk	☐

Superheroic

Superheroic Skills	☐
Superpowers	☐
Gadgets & Gear	☐
Hideouts & Strongholds	☐
Nemesis, Companions, & Sidekicks	☐

Notes

Player: _____

Template: _____

Bio:

Name: _____

Details: _____

DEFENSE

MOVE

• Dodge: _____

• Parry: _____

HERO POINTS:

AGILITY

BRAWN

KNOWLEDGE

PERCEPTION

Weapon

Damage

Range S/M/L

Ammo

Armor

Armor Bonus

Inventory

NOTES

Appendix: Enemy Talents

Gamemasters who wish to increase the challenge, threat, or difficulty of enemies will find a list of Talents that can be appended to the enemy attributes in this book. These enemy talents adjust and modify enemies to provide more engaging or dynamic foes, as well as to provide differentiation between various types of enemies that player characters might encounter.

In order to make these enemy talents easy for gamemasters to use, they are quick and dirty “brute force” rules, designed to require minimum mental workload for the GM to use. As such, these talents are not suitable for players.

Fast: This character ignores the first multi-action die penalty they suffer.

Stubborn: This character ignores die penalties from being Staggered. Additionally, it must be staggered a number of times equal to its Brawn die code before it is stunned.

Sturdy: This character cannot be knocked prone.

Indomitable: This character ignores die penalties from being Staggered and cannot be stunned.

Weak: This character is defeated when stunned or staggered.



Die Code Simplification

Sometimes the D6 System: Second Edition can really escalate and massive die codes might need to be rolled. Now, various die rolling digital tools can easily handle that, but rolling 40d6 (while fun) can often become daunting and excessively time-consuming.

In order to address that, this chart provides two ways of reducing the amount of dice needed: the fast way and the even faster way!

The fast way is to roll five dice, including the Wild Die, add the results, and then add the die code's pips and a bonus number. To determine the bonus number, find the die code (ignoring the pips if you are using that module) of the original attribute, skill, weapon, or other value in the "Die Code" column. Then read across to the "5D" column to get the bonus number..

Example: Alan wants to make a roll with a total pool of 10D. He rolls five dice (5D), sums them up for a result of 13. Then, Alan looks at the 5D column and cross references it with his initial die code of 10D. He then adds the +18 to the rolled 13 for a total of 31.

Another method that's even faster is to only roll the wild die. When using only the Wild Die, a result of '1' only indicates a complication or funny thing happening; it does not affect the total rolled.

Example: Alan makes the same roll as above, but only rolls the Wild Die. He goes to the 10D column, and goes all the way over to the Wild Die column. He adds +32 to the result on his Wild Die.

Die Code	5D	Wild Die
1D	0	0
2D	0	+4
3D	0	+7
4D	0	+11
5D	0	+14
6D	+4	+18
7D	+7	+21
8D	+11	+25
9D	+14	+28
10D	+18	+32
11D	+21	+35
12D	+25	+39
13D	+28	+42
14D	+32	+46
15D	+35	+49
16D	+39	+53
17D	+42	+56
18D	+46	+60
19D	+49	+63
20D	+53	+67
21D	+56	+70
22D	+60	+74
23D	+63	+77
24D	+67	+81
25D	+70	+84
+1D	Previous+3	Previous+3

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